

Ottawa to bar MAID for mental illness

Liberals will table legislation this fall to block access to group indefinitely while adding measures to allow for advance requests

STEPHANIE LEVITZ
KRISTY KIRKUP OTTAWA

The Liberal government plans to reshape Canada’s medical assistance in dying regime to close the door to those whose sole underlying condition is mental illness. At the same time, it would provide an opening for those already eligible for MAID to request it in advance.

Justice Minister Sean Fraser announced Wednesday that Ottawa intends to legally bar access to MAID for mental illness. The fed-

eral government has twice paused access for that cohort of Canadians over concerns about the readiness of the health care system.

Mr. Fraser also said the forthcoming bill will include measures allowing medical practitioners to assist in ending the lives of people who have made an advance request for MAID. Those are patients who have indicated that they want the procedure at a later date, when they no longer have the cognitive capacity to consent to it.

“These are not easy decisions, but we believe that they are the

correct ones,” Mr. Fraser told reporters at a news conference Wednesday.

The debate over who should be able to request a medical practitioner’s help to end their lives is one of the most fractious in Canada. Those divisions were on full display in response to Mr. Fraser’s two announcements.

The advocacy group Dying With Dignity Canada has spent more than two years suing Ottawa for barring MAID access to patients whose sole underlying condition is mental illness. The case remains before the courts.

In a statement, it called Wednesday’s announcement a “profoundly disappointing day for medical assistance in dying legislation.”

Chief executive officer Helen Long said that preventing those with mental illness from having the same access to a legal medical procedure, simply because of their diagnosis, is a violation of Charter rights.

Conversely, Inclusion Canada, a national group advocating for the rights of people with intellectual disabilities, thanked Mr. Fraser for listening to concerns about

MAID access for patients with mental illness.

However, the organization said that the government’s plans on advance requests raise concerns. Patients may not understand what is happening to them when the procedure is being administered, it stated.

“An advance request is written by someone who cannot know what their future will hold,” Inclusion Canada CEO Krista Carr said in a statement.

“Consent at the time is the most basic protection a person has.” ■ MAID, A6

[MIDDLE EAST]



THE LONG SHADOW OF OCT. 7

Israelis grieve those lost on third anniversary of attack that set off devastating war in Gaza and beyond ■ A5

Mourners carry Israeli flags through an installation on the beachfront in Tel Aviv on Wednesday to mark the anniversary of the Hamas-led attacks of Oct. 7, 2023. ODED BALIUTY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Accusations of sexual assault were a complete fabrication, Galloway tells defamation trial

MIKE HAGER VANCOUVER

Bestselling author Steven Galloway told court Wednesday allegations that he sexually assaulted a former student three times were pure fiction and that he didn’t learn of the details until after he was suspended as head of the creative writing program at the University of British Columbia.

After nearly 11 years, Mr. Galloway testified in open court about the allegations as part of a defamation case he brought against the woman, with whom he had a two-year affair, and three others he accuses of defaming him. He called the allegations “absolutely” false.

“I was shocked to find she was saying that,” he testified.

Mr. Galloway was suspended by UBC in November, 2015, and the university’s public announcement of the “serious allegations” against him were highly publicized. It roiled the Canadian literary community for years, and the author maintains it cost

him his reputation and his livelihood.

His defamation suit originally included almost two dozen defendants, most of whom settled. The woman who made the allegations, known as A.B. because of a publication ban on her name, is joined as a defendant by three others.

The trial will not hear testimony from A.B. Her lawyer, Arden Beddoes, has told court she withdraws her defences of truth and fair comment, but does not admit to spreading lies about her former romantic partner. Mr. Beddoes has said A.B. has twice tried to kill herself in recent months because of the stress of the lawsuit.

Court heard Wednesday about three instances in which A.B. alleged that she was sexually assaulted.

In the first, she said Mr. Galloway invited her to play a daytime game of cards on his 30-foot sailboat at his False Creek marina in the spring of 2011.

■ GALLOWAY, A6

Do big cities’ shrinking neighbourhoods hide untapped potential?

ALEX BOZIKOVIC
YANG SUN

Kerrisdale looks much the same as ever. In this affluent pocket of Vancouver’s west side, gable-roofed houses stand behind tall hedges and shelter under mature maples.

Yet a subtle change has occurred: In many corners of the neighbourhood, there are fewer people.

On the side streets of Kerrisdale, many blocks have lost between 10 and 30 per cent of their population since the 1970s. One section near the Marine Drive Golf Club fell from 1,010 residents to 630 – down 380 people, or 38 per cent.

This is not an anomaly. Over the past half-century, both the Vancouver and Toronto regions have doubled in population.

But a Globe and Mail analysis of census data shows that within these growing metropolises, there are shrinking cities: established areas where populations have fallen as much as 40 per cent.

This trend of local population declines has been largely overlooked, even as Canadian governments work to create more homes and build the infrastructure – pipes, roads, community facilities – to serve the people who will occupy them.

In last year’s federal budget, the government promised \$50-billion toward such projects.

■ CITIES, A7

Government eyes Vancouver airport as first for private investment

ANDREW WILLIS
JAMES BRADSHAW
BILL CURRY

Vancouver International Airport is poised to become the first of the country’s large airports privatized by the federal government, as Ottawa’s advisers offer British Columbia Indigenous groups an opportunity to be minority investors, four sources say.

Three weeks after Prime Minister Mark Carney announced plans to open up four of the country’s biggest airports to private investment, the bankers and lawyers advising Ottawa have decided Vancouver’s airport, known in the industry as YVR, should be the first facility where a long-term lease on its ground operations is sold to outside investors, according to the sources, who are involved in the process.

YVR earned first spot in line because the government and its advisers expect to land First Nations investment, the sources said. The Globe and Mail is not naming the sources because they are not permitted to speak for their employers.

Mr. Carney made the privatization pitch during September’s investment summit in downtown Toronto, where he gathered executives with the goal of drawing new capital to Canada and reframing the country’s approach to investment. But the plan has raised concerns about the potential for increased prices for travellers and higher fees for airlines.

Along with YVR, the federal government plans to sell leases to run all or part of Calgary, Toronto and Montreal’s airports.

■ AIRPORT, A6

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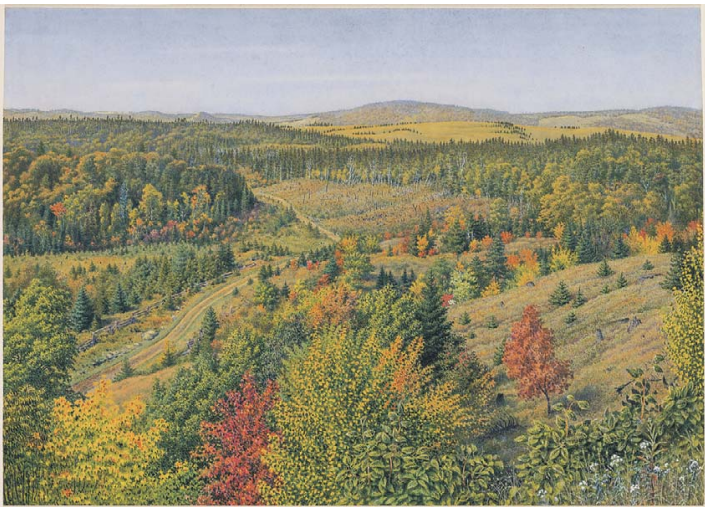
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WILLIAM G.R. HIND'S NEW BRUNSWICK LANDSCAPE



WILLIAM G.R. HIND, NEW BRUNSWICK LANDSCAPE, C. 1879-1889, WATERCOLOUR AND GOUACHE WITH GUM ARABIC ON WOVE PAPER, 24.8 × 34.8 CM. NATIONAL GALLERY OF CANADA, OTTAWA. TRANSFER FROM THE NATIONAL MUSEUMS OF CANADA, OTTAWA, 1989 (REPATRIATED THROUGH THE NATIONAL MUSEUMS OF CANADA EMERGENCY PURCHASE FUND 1974). PHOTO: NGC

For October, we are featuring works from the National Gallery of Canada, one of the world's most respected art institutions. Founded in 1880, the Ottawa-based gallery has played a key role in Canadian culture for more than a century. The NGC works to develop, preserve and present more than 90,000 pieces, representing one of the most comprehensive collections of Indigenous and Canadian art, major works from the 14th to 21st centuries, as well as extensive library and archival holdings. www.gallery.ca

In 1851, 18-year-old William G.R. Hind immigrated to Toronto, joining his geologist brother on sweeping expeditions across Indigenous lands on the cusp of Confederation. While illustrating scientific reports, Hind also quietly recorded his personal experiences. His distinctive style mirrored photographic precision with a vital difference: vivid, untamed colour. In this view of early autumn, he captures a dense forest – omitting the industrialization occurring all around. Hind spent his final years in New Brunswick.

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The Globe and Mail is committed to maintaining the highest ethical, legal and editorial standards. SANDRA E. MARTIN, STANDARDS EDITOR, standardseditor@globeandmail.com

Nobel Prize in Chemistry awarded to mirror molecule explorers Henri Kagan, Kenso Soai

IVAN SEMENIUK
SCIENCE REPORTER

Two scientists who studied the properties and production of molecules that are mirror images of one another have been awarded the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.

On Wednesday, members of the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences announced that Henri Kagan of Université Paris-Sud, Orsay, and Kenso Soai of the Tokyo University of Science will share this year's chemistry Nobel.

Both made key contributions to the understanding of "chirality," a property that means some molecules can have left- and right-handed versions.

Their discoveries have proved important for the development of pharmaceuticals, many of which require the production of only one version of a molecule and not its mirror twin.

For example, in some cases, the mirror version of a molecule is not only ineffective but harmful. When the drug thalidomide was marketed as a morning sickness pill starting in the 1950s, the consequences were tragic: The mirror image of the active drug turned out to cause severe birth defects.

"How can a reaction be designed to spontaneously create only one of the two mirror images without involving any other chiral molecule? It is this puzzle that this year's laureates have solved," Heiner Linke, chair of the Nobel Committee for Chemistry, said during Wednesday's announcement.

The work also helps to illuminate why life on Earth is based only on left-handed versions of certain key organic molecules.

Dr. Kagan was born in 1930 in Boulogne-Billancourt, France, and received his PhD from the College of France in Paris in 1960.

Through the 1970s and 80s, he developed reactions in which catalysts enhanced the production of one version of a mirror molecule relative to the other.

The work was recognized as a breakthrough for its practical applications, including for the development of flavour and



Japanese chemist Kenso Soai, right, receives a bouquet of flowers at Tokyo University of Science on Wednesday. Dr. Soai received his PhD from the university in 1979. HIRO KOMAE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

scents, in which only one version of a chiral molecule can be sensed.

Dr. Kagan was awarded the prestigious Wolf Prize in Chemistry in 2001. Now 95, he is among the oldest winners of a chemistry Nobel.

Their discoveries have proved important for the development of pharmaceuticals, many of which require the production of only one version of a molecule and not its mirror twin.

Dr. Soai was born in 1950 in Hiroshima, Japan, and received his PhD from the University of Tokyo in 1979.

In the 1990s, he discovered a chiral substance known as 5-pyrimidyl alkanol, which acts as an autocatalyst, a molecule that can create itself.

By 2003, he had developed a chemical reaction in which chiral molecules formed from non-chiral precursors. He then showed how a very small excess of one version of the mirror molecule would eventually grow in proportion to take over the reaction,

until it was the sole version remaining.

Apart from the origin of life more than four billion years ago, which produced a biology with exclusively left-handed chemistry, no other such examples are currently known.

At Wednesday's announcement, Peter Somfai, a member of the Nobel Committee, said Dr. Soai's discovery is "probably the coolest experiment in organic chemistry."

Each year the Chemistry prize marks the third in a series of Nobel Prize announcements.

On Monday, Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann and Georg Nagel were awarded the Nobel Prize in physiology or medicine for creating the field of optogenetics, a method of genetically modifying neurons to react to light that has transformed brain research.

On Tuesday, Francis Halzen, who leads a giant neutrino detection experiment in Antarctica, was named this year's winner of the Nobel Prize in physics.

Recipients of the Nobel Prize in literature and the Nobel Peace Prize are scheduled to be announced on Thursday and Friday, respectively. The winner of this year's Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences will be announced on Oct. 12.

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Canada drops sponsorship of Disinfo2026

Conference has panels that treat U.S. as source of foreign interference

STEVEN CHASE
SENIOR PARLIAMENTARY REPORTER

The federal government has withdrawn its sponsorship of an anti-disinformation conference in Lithuania that features panels talking about the United States as a foreign-interference threat.

Global Affairs spokesperson Samantha Lafleur said Ottawa wasn't comfortable with the framing of some of the panels and that Canadian officials will still take part in the conference but will not chair any discussions.

"Following changes to the framing of several panel discussions, Global Affairs decided to revise its participation in those sessions at the EU DisinfoLab 2026 conference," Ms. Lafleur said in an e-mailed statement.

The U.S. State Department criticized the conference for proposing that the United States is a source of foreign interference and manipulated information.

"The organizers appear to put the United States in the same bucket as foreign adversaries," the department said in an e-mailed statement. "This false

equivalence is antithetical to the goals these individuals claim to promote and obscures the scale and nature of adversarial interference."

Asked if Washington raised concerns about Disinfo2026 with Canada and European countries, it declined to say.

"The Department does not discuss details of private diplomatic conversations, but we regularly and candidly engage our European and Canadian partners on concerns and avenues for collaboration regarding censorship, free expression, and countering adversaries," the State Department said.

An annual conference on countering disinformation, the 2026 event is taking place in Vilnius this week. The conference attracts researchers, people who work in counter-disinformation, journalists, think tanks, academics and government officials. It is organized by EU DisinfoLab, a non-profit based in Brussels.

One of the featured attendees this year was Kimberly Prost, the Canadian jurist hit by sanctions from U.S. President Donald Trump for her work on an International Criminal Court case involving American troops in Afghanistan.

She was one of five judges who decided unanimously in 2020 to authorize an investigation into war crimes allegedly committed

in Afghanistan by the Taliban, Afghan forces and members of the U.S. military and Central Intelligence Agency, which operated secret detention facilities.

At Disinfo2026, more than one panel discusses the U.S. as a source of foreign-information manipulation and interference (FIMI), in which state-backed actors conduct co-ordinated and deceptive behaviour to sway public debate and undermine elections and institutions.

The conference program frames one session, slated for Thursday, as a provocative discussion on "growing evidence that the United States has, in specific Arctic contexts, operated as a FIMI actor."

Saliou Babou, the director of a Global Affairs Canada unit that was set up years ago to counter foreign state-sponsored disinformation, was slated to chair a session on disinformation in the Arctic.

The Lithuanian government also said it withdrew its sponsorship. "Lithuania has cancelled its participation in 'Disinfo 2026' as several parts of the conference programme differ from the official position of the Government," the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Lithuania said in an e-mailed statement.

In addition, participants told The Globe and Mail that the European External Action Service,

the EU's diplomatic service, withdrew its sponsorship.

The Disinfo2026 conference organizers declined to comment.

The Global Affairs spokesperson said Canada remains committed to combatting disinformation.

"We respect the right of the organizers to frame discussions as they see fit and recognize the independence of civil society actors and speakers at the conference," Ms. Lafleur said.

Benjamin Shultz, a lead researcher at the American Sunlight Project and a conference participant, said posters at the conference listing sponsors now feature white stickers covering the logos for Canada, Lithuania and the EU.

Mr. Shultz disputed the Canadian government's statement that panel subjects had been "re-framed," saying the description of the panels is unchanged from a June, 2026, version.

One of the conference sessions was titled "USA as a FIMI threat: acknowledge, adapt, push back," referring to foreign-information manipulation and interference. The description said the discussion would address: "one of the most uncomfortable questions in the counter-disinformation field today: how did the United States become a FIMI threat for Europe?"

Another panel titled "Under

attack: How the counter-disinformation community is dealing with US government pressure," talked about how Washington imposed visa restrictions on five Europeans, among them former EU commissioner Thierry Breton and four leaders of groups that combat online disinformation and hate, accusing them of putting pressure on U.S. social-media platforms to censor American speech.

"The United States Government's attacks to intimidate individuals and organisations are an unprecedented escalation in defense of U.S. corporations seeking to avoid regulation and criticism," the panel description said.

The U.S. State Department in its statement rejected the idea that it's a source of foreign-information manipulation and interference.

"For too long, governments have exploited the pretext of combatting 'misinformation' and 'disinformation' for politically motivated reasons," the department said. "We continue to counter malign foreign propaganda; we also recognize the importance of distinguishing adversarial campaigns from the political opinions and positions of our domestic speakers and allied countries."

With a report from Nathan VanderKlippe

Musk calls on Quebec, Alberta and Saskatchewan to separate from Canada

NATHAN VANDERKLIPPE
INTERNATIONAL CORRESPONDENT

The richest man on Earth wants Canada to break apart, calling for three provinces to leave Confederation in the wake of an election in Quebec that brought separatists back to power.

Trillionaire Elon Musk, who attended university in Ontario, has fathered children with multiple Canadian women and has called himself "half Canadian," said Wednesday that he supports those who want their provinces to be independent.

"Quebec should separate," he wrote on X, the social-media platform he owns and has used to share his views with hundreds of millions of people around the world.

Quebec "would be better off" as its own country, he added. "Alberta and Saskatchewan should separate too."

On Monday, the Parti Québécois won a minority government after promising a third referendum on independence. In less than two weeks, Albertans will vote on whether that province should remain in Canada or begin the process of holding a legally binding referendum on separation. In Saskatchewan, meanwhile, some polls have shown increased support for secession.

On Wednesday, Saskatchewan Premier Scott Moe responded to Mr. Musk with a single word, posted to X: "No."

"Our government, our Caucus, and our party support Alberta remaining in Canada," added Alberta Premier Danielle Smith in a statement.

But Alberta separatists welcomed support from the man who built electric automaker Tesla into a global operation, turned rocket company SpaceX into a major player and has maintained ownership of one of the world's most powerful social-media networks.

He is "somebody that's done really well and looks at our situation, business-wise, and says we'd be better off on our own. It just gives it some credibility for him to actually think that," said Mitch Sylvestre, chief executive officer of the Alberta Prosperity Project.

The argument that Alberta, Saskatchewan and Quebec would be better off outside Canada – "I agree with all of that," Mr. Sylvestre said. "We've made the case over and over again."

Mr. Musk's intervention arrives in the wake of a series of pro-secession statements from prominent American political and religious leaders.

In January, U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent called Alberta a "natural partner" for his country. U.S. President Donald Trump has repeatedly threatened the annexation of Canada. Influential conservative pastors and podcasters in the U.S. have openly supported Alberta secession.

Mr. Musk has cultivated close ties with the Trump administration, most recently being chosen as a leader of Project Meridian, a Pentagon effort to examine the future of warfare.

"The foreign interference in this cam-

paign is unprecedented," said Thomas Lukaszuk, a former deputy premier of Alberta who has led Forever Canadian, an initiative that has campaigned for Alberta to remain in Canada.

He called Mr. Musk's comments "offensive."

"I hope that Canadians in their shopping practices keep in mind whom we are supporting as consumers in Canada," he said.

Tesla sells tens of thousands of vehicles a year in Canada, and Canada is the fifth-largest market for satellite internet services provided by Starlink, a division of SpaceX, network diagnostics company Ookla reported last year. In 2024, Mr. Musk said Starlink was in 3 per cent of Canadian homes.

But Canadian political leaders have also worked to counter the influence of some of Mr. Musk's businesses in the country.

Last year, Ontario said it had scrapped a \$92-million contract with SpaceX for its Starlink service, fulfilling a vow by Premier Doug Ford to retaliate against U.S. tariffs. Prime Minister Mark Carney has said publicly that he intends to work with partners in Europe and Asia to "diversify away" from Starlink.

Last year, a petition backed by Charlie Angus, then an NDP MP, called on the Prime Minister to revoke Mr. Musk's Canadian passport.

Mr. Musk moved to Canada from South Africa in 1989 and attended Queen's University in Kingston for two years. He also worked on a cousin's farm in Saskatchewan, once posting a photo of himself holding a hammer and wearing a white cowboy hat.

"I love Canada! I'm half Canadian," he wrote in 2017.

"My Mom was born in Regina. My grandfather (her Dad) was American, born in Minnesota."

He has since soured on the place, his condemnation growing more strident during the years Justin Trudeau was prime minister.

"Canada is not a real country," he wrote in one message, then deleted, in response to the petition against his citizenship.

He accused Mr. Trudeau of "trying to crush free speech in Canada," calling it "shameful." He criticized Canada's bilingual laws, which he called "extremely hypocritical and unfair!" He publicly sided with Mr. Trump when the U.S. President suggested Canada treats American banks unfairly.

In 2024, he said it was "high time" Mr. Trudeau was voted out of office.

Early last year, he sneered at a statement from Mr. Trudeau that said "there isn't a snowball's chance in hell that Canada would become part of the United States."

Mr. Musk responded on the day after Mr. Trudeau said he would resign, using a title Mr. Trump often used to troll the prime minister: "Girl, you're not the governor of Canada anymore, so doesn't matter what you say."

With a file from Matthew Scace



Emergency services work to rescue people at the site of an apartment building hit by a Russian missile strike in Pryluky, Ukraine, on Wednesday. VALENTYN OGIRENKO/REUTERS

At least 28 killed in massive Russian strike against Ukraine

OLENA HARMASH
VLADYSLAV SMILIANETS KYIV

Russia pounded Ukraine with waves of missiles and drones in one of its most "vile strikes" on Wednesday, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said, killing at least 28 people, including children, and damaging industrial facilities and energy infrastructure.

Interior Minister Ivan Vyhivskiy put the countrywide death toll at 28.

The heaviest losses were in Pryluky in Ukraine's northern Chernihiv region, where a Russian missile obliterated a five-storey residential building.

Regional Governor Vyacheslav Chaus said 20 people died in the attack, including five children.

On Wednesday evening, prosecutors in the capital Kyiv said falling debris from a drone killed two people in a suburb.

Mr. Zelensky said that 100 people had been injured throughout the country.

The president noted that the attacks coincided with Russian President Vladimir Putin's birthday.

"This is the kind of birthday present that Putin gave himself: the killing of children, the killing of people," Mr. Zelensky said in his nightly video address.

In earlier online comments, Mr. Zelensky said civilians had also been killed in the capital Kyiv and in the central cities of Oleksandria and Kremenchuk during the massive attack.

In total, Russia fired 70 missiles at Ukraine overnight – many of them high-velocity ballistic munitions – and dozens of Shahed attack drones, he said.

"The Russians wanted to strike painfully and demonstratively. This was one of the most vile strikes."

In Pryluky, an excavator and dozens of rescuers with shovels sifted through rubble at the site where several sections of the apartment block had collapsed.

Emergency workers used ladders to get to the upper floors of what remained of the building, and brought out 15 survivors as they worked their way down through the rubble. Around 55 people were wounded in the town, regional officials said.

"There's a lot of destruction, especially in the town centre," said Danylo Savenko, deputy mayor of Pryluky, who said he had run to an air raid shelter with his wife as soon as he heard the missiles flying.

Russia's Defence Ministry said its forces had carried out a "massive strike" on military-industrial facilities in Kyiv and other Ukrainian regions, using high-precision land-, sea- and air-launched weapons, as well as drones.

Ukraine's air force said it had downed more than 80 per cent of the 46 jet-powered drones launched by Russia – an increase from recent weeks when air defences took down 50 per cent to 60 per cent.

Since the summer, Russia has used increasing numbers of the new high-velocity drones in round-the-clock attacks on Kyiv and other cities, with Ukraine's air defences struggling to cope.

The air force did not explain the jump in the interception rate and did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Mr. Zelensky said the Russian ballistic missiles remained the major challenge for Ukraine, adding that he and his team were "every day looking for Patriot (missile interception) systems that can and must protect people's lives."

Ukraine received a new €1.2-billion (US\$1.34-billion) tranche from the European Union on Wednesday and will channel the funds towards defence needs, Prime Minister Sergii Korotshuk said.

The U.S.-made Patriot system is the only weapon in Ukraine's arsenal capable of stopping high-velocity ballistic missiles. Global supplies have been drained by the Iran war and the Ukraine conflict.

Russia's Defence Ministry said its targets included sites where Ukrainian defence company Fire Point manufactures and stores its Flamingo cruise missiles and medium- and long-range drones in Kyiv as well as regions of Kyiv, Chernihiv, Kirovohrad, Dnipropetrovsk, Poltava and Kharkiv.

Last week, Mr. Zelensky said Ukraine had fired its first domestically made ballistic missile in combat, produced by Fire Point. In an interview with Reuters, he said he expected the company to have a longer-range FP-9 missile ready by the autumn. Fire Point has said that weapon will be able to reach Moscow.

Mr. Zelensky said Ukrainian troops hit four targets in Russia over the past 24 hours, including two Russian oil facilities and a training ground in the Perm, Samara and Astrakhan regions.

REUTERS

Israelis mourn on the anniversary of the Oct. 7 attack

Third year highlights startling transformation in region, where retaliatory war in Gaza has left tens of thousands dead

MELANIE LIDMAN REIM, ISRAEL

On a field where music festival revellers were gunned down by Hamas-led militants three years ago, Israelis on Wednesday embraced and wept for those lost in an attack that plunged the Middle East into war.

Israelis mourned at the site of the Nova Music Festival, as well as at bomb shelters, intersections and in communities targeted on Oct. 7, 2023. Tens of thousands gathered in Tel Aviv for the main ceremony organized by bereaved families, separate from the official government ceremonies.

On that day – the deadliest in the country’s history – militants killed 1,200 people and took 251 hostage. Israel’s retaliatory offensive killed tens of thousands of Palestinians, destroyed much of Gaza and drove most of its two million residents from their homes.

This is the first anniversary since all the hostages, living and dead, were returned. Signs calling for their return are mostly gone, but reminders of those who were killed are ubiquitous in a country still reckoning with the trauma of that day.

For Palestinians, the anniversary brings another day of fear and misery. Most Gaza residents live in squalid tent camps, with large parts of cities bombed to rubble. More than half the territory remains in the hands of the Israeli military. Despite a ceasefire deal reached nearly a year ago, Israeli strikes continue almost daily.

Israeli troops occupy a large chunk of southern Lebanon in their conflict with Hezbollah militants, who began firing on Israel in 2023 in support of Hamas. Iran, the United States and their allies are locked in a confrontation that has seen attacks across the region and has shaken the global economy – a conflict that Israel helped launch and that the war in Gaza paved the way for, even if the two conflicts weren’t directly connected.

Hundreds of people paid their respects to the more than 350 people killed in and around the festival site. Videos from that day showed militants gunning down fleeing revellers, shooting the wounded at point-blank range and ambushing those



Raz Zarfati, the sister of Ron Zarfati, who was killed in the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led attack on Israel, attends a memorial marking the third anniversary of the event at the Nova music festival site near Kibbutz Reim in southern Israel on Wednesday. OHAD ZWIGENBERG/AP

seeking refuge in bomb shelters.

On Wednesday, survivors’ relatives hugged at 6:29 a.m. – the exact time the first rockets were launched three years ago – as explosions boomed in nearby Gaza.

Anya Davitashili, who lost her 25-year-old son, Sean, said she visits the site every Saturday. It’s where she feels closest to him.

“I have a video of him dancing here that ends at 6:29 in the morning. It’s in front of my eyes all the time,” she said. “Every morning, you wake up, and there is just endless missing.”

Larger ceremonies took place in the evening at the Nova site and in Tel Aviv, which paid tribute to both the people who were killed as well as those who responded and were forever changed, including doctors who helped identify bodies at the main forensics facility and a bus driver who took his own life after the attack, overcome by the devastation he had seen.

“We will bear witness and tell the story of the day the sky fell upon us,” said Eli Sharabi, who was held captive in Gaza for 16 months and lost his wife, two daughters, and brothers.

Elkana Bohbot, 37, is marking the anniversary in Israel for the first time since his release after 738 days of captivity. For

most of that time, he said, he was held underground in a dark, damp tunnel.

Mr. Bohbot, who was abducted from the festival, was kept in a small cell with other hostages, given little food and allowed to bathe only every few weeks, he said. His captors forced him to take part in propaganda videos, including one where he acted out a fake call to his family.

In the year since his release, Mr. Bohbot has undergone physical and emotional rehabilitation. In August, his wife, Rivka, gave birth to a daughter, fulfilling his promise to himself in the tunnels to give his five-year-old son, Reem, a sibling.

The newborn Michele is “not a symbol for my people, she is more of a symbol for the enemy,” Mr. Bohbot told the Associated Press. “This child is the message for you that we were here and we will always be here forever.”

No events are expected Wednesday in Gaza, but Hamas in a statement defended their deadly Oct. 7 attack, saying it had returned the Palestinian cause to the world’s attention.

“The conflict with the enemy did not begin on that day, [and] its final chapters are not written yet,” it said.

Palestinians in the territory said their suffering over the past three years had previously been unimaginable.

“We witnessed death, destruction and

bombardment that we had never known before,” said Walid Akram, a Gaza City resident who, like most in Gaza, has been displaced by the war.

Raed Khozeiq’s coastal neighbourhood in Tel al-Hawa was largely flattened. Nothing about his life now is the same, he said.

“No country in the world has gone through what we have experienced here,” he said. “A war of extermination, starvation, the absence of schools and universities – nothing remains.”

More than 74,000 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza, according to the territory’s Health Ministry, which does not distinguish between civilians and militants in its figures but says around half were women and children.

The numbers from the ministry, part of the Hamas-run government, are seen as generally reliable by UN agencies and independent experts.

While a ceasefire that took effect Oct. 10, 2025, halted the heaviest fighting, Israeli strikes have continued, targeting what Israel says are Hamas militants.

Since the ceasefire, 1,460 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza, according to the ministry. Five Israeli soldiers have been killed in attacks in that period. Restrictions on the entry of goods and aid have contributed to a hunger crisis, food-security experts say.

A contentious election at the end of the month hangs over this year’s anniversary in Israel. Voters are bitterly divided over Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s leadership, his role in the security failures surrounding the attack and his refusal to launch an official inquiry into them.

The attack set in motion a cascade of events that led to wars across the Middle East as Israel confronted Hamas, Hezbollah and their backer, Iran. Israel has seized swaths of territory in Syria and Lebanon, where more than 300,000 Lebanese remain displaced.

The United States joined Israel in attacking Iran’s military and nuclear program in two rounds, battering Iran and upending global markets far from the battlefield.

Violence has also risen across the Israeli-occupied West Bank, where Israel’s far-right government has heightened restrictions on Palestinians while emboldening extremist settlers who have attacked them and destroyed their property.

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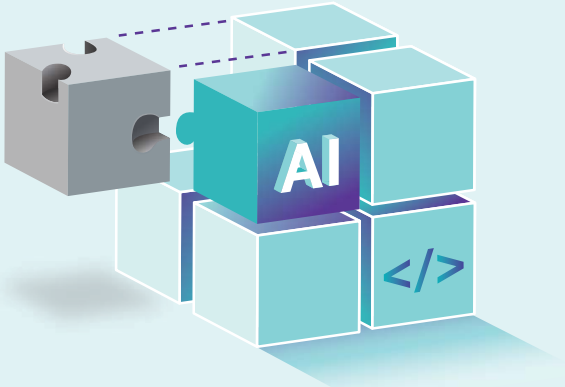
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MAID: More details on advance requests component to come when bill is tabled

■ FROM A1

It is unusual for governments to provide overviews of coming legislation well before a bill has been tabled. Mr. Fraser gave no date for when the bill will land. But the Liberals were under pressure to make a decision on MAID for mental illness on two fronts: The law that bars access to that cohort expires on March 17, 2027. Secondly, a Conservative private member's bill on MAID for mental illness was up for a vote in the House of Commons, and Mr. Fraser said the government felt it important to declare its position in advance of that vote.

MP Tamara Jansen's bill proposed amending the Criminal Code to bar those with mental disorders from accessing MAID, functionally the same approach the government will take.

Mr. Fraser said the government's opposition to Ms. Jansen's bill related to its terminology, and the broader decision to bar access to MAID for mental illness reflects concerns over inadequate access to mental-health services.

Earlier this year, a joint House of Commons and Senate committee studying MAID for mental health had also recommended that the system not be expanded.

Conservative MPs said it was frustrating to see the Liberals take an issue that has consensus and tie it with measures on advance requests, which have not been as extensively studied in Parliament.

Because the mental-health provisions must pass by March 17, that means the whole bill must pass by then, and the issue of advance requests is far more divisive, said Conservative MP Andrew Lawton.

"The Liberals are playing politics with people's lives," Mr. Lawton said.

Mr. Fraser was asked Wednesday whether he would consider splitting the bill but did not appear open to that idea.

"Although it's nice to collaborate and take the perspectives of different parties, democracy doesn't demand unanimity," he said.



Justice Minister Sean Fraser speaks to media alongside Health Minister Marjorie Michel about the federal government's medical assistance in dying laws in the foyer of the House of Commons on Wednesday. JUSTIN TANG/THE CANADIAN PRESS

Quebec has allowed for advance directives since October, 2024 for patients with serious, incurable illnesses that lead to incapacity, such as Alzheimer's. The federal government has not challenged Quebec but has also not amended the Criminal Code to reflect advance requests.

It is unclear how many MAID procedures involving advance requests have been performed since then. The requests allow for patients to formalize their wishes ahead of when they no longer have the capacity to consent.

From November, 2024 to February, 2025, Ottawa held national consultations on the issue, which found that the majority of Canadians were broadly support-

ive of the idea.

The coming federal legislation would amend the Criminal Code so that if provinces choose to allow advance requests, medical practitioners wouldn't be charged with a crime for carrying them out.

Mr. Fraser said there would be more details on the advance request system when the bill is tabled but it would still be up to the provinces to decide whether to allow advance requests.

He said he expects this to spur a conversation at the provincial level on whether they will.

Pamela Wallin, an Independent senator who has long advocated for advance requests, said she is pleased to see the government announce its plans in this

area.

She said it means patients with "diseases like Alzheimer's and dementia will have finally the right to make an advance request and to have some chance at a dignified departure and end to their life."

But Ms. Wallin, who disagrees with expanding access to MAID for mental illness, said she thinks that issue is far from settled.

"I do think that will be dealt with in the courts because the fundamental question there is, can you exclude some groups from having the same rights as other Canadians?" she said. "It'll be a slower process, and I think it eventually will come."

Canada's current MAID re-

gime is the product of a cascading series of court decisions.

The Supreme Court decision in *Carter v. Canada* led to MAID first becoming legal in June, 2016 for Canadians whose deaths were deemed "reasonably foreseeable."

In 2021, the law was updated after a Quebec court decision allowed patients with incurable conditions to seek to end their lives. At that time, it was determined that people whose sole underlying medical condition is mental illness would not be immediately eligible.

The government placed a two-year pause to allow more time to study the delivery of MAID in this area. Since then, Ottawa has twice delayed implementation.

Airport: Indigenous investors expected to take minority stake of up to 20% in YVR

■ FROM A1

The federal government will retain ownership of the underlying land and assets, a structure that is common in Europe and Australia.

Indigenous investors are expected to take a minority stake of up to 20 per cent in YVR, two of the sources said, with majority control sold to institutional investors experienced in operating these complex facilities. Leading candidates for this role are large domestic pension plans such as the Public Sector Pension Investment Board, known as PSP Investments, which already operates airports in Europe and Puerto Rico.

The federal government and its advisers want Indigenous investment in YVR and other airports as part of a strategy to promote reconciliation and address concerns that privatizing operations will mean handing control to faceless asset managers, or foreign airport operators.

The government's airport privatization process is in its early stages, and the timing and structure of investments could change, according to the four sources.

Indigenous investors listening to pitches for stakes in YVR include the Musqueam First Nation, two of the sources said. The airport, located in the Vancouver suburb of Richmond, is on the Musqueam's unceded territory.

Last year, the First Nation struck a revenue-sharing agreement with the federal government on YVR, the country's second-busiest airport.

On Wednesday, Musqueam chief administrative officer Robyn McVicker said the First Nation wants a role in YVR's future.

"Following the Prime Minister's announcement at the Canada Investment Summit, Musqueam indicated to government that any discussion and plans about the future of YVR must include meaningful participation by Musqueam Indian Band," said Ms. McVicker in an e-mail. She said: "At this time, it would be premature to discuss any negotiations."

Ottawa's advisers have also reached out to MST Development Corp., a Vancouver-based real estate company backed by three First Nations – the Musqueam, Squamish and Tsleil-Waututh, – according to one of the sources.

MST owns a \$3-billion proper-

ty portfolio. CEO David Negrin has attended two fundraisers for Mr. Carney over the past two years. MST did not respond to a request for comment.

The Prime Minister also said Canada intends to draw on the experience of other countries throughout the process – and learn from the pension funds and others who already own airports.

On Wednesday, Ministry of Transport spokesperson Marie-Justine Torres said the government is working on plans to bring private investment into airports "in partnership with Indigenous groups."

"There are more important steps ahead, and details will be developed in the coming months working with the airport authorities," Ms. Torres said.

Canada's airports are run by non-profit companies that pay rent to the government and fund operations through a host of fees

charged to users, including passengers, airlines, restaurants and shops.

YVR spokesperson Stephen Smart said in an e-mail that "YVR will continue to engage with the Government of Canada, as well as with Musqueam, given our unique relationship."

At the Canada Investment Summit in September, Mr. Carney made signing operational contracts for airports a key part of his pitch to many of the world's largest asset managers.

"We, as a government, will be able to get tens of billions of dollars of proceeds from this process," Mr. Carney said at the time.

The Prime Minister also said Canada intends to draw on the experience of other countries throughout the process – and learn from the pension funds and others who already own airports.

After Mr. Carney's announcement, Transport Minister Steven MacKinnon said the government would partially regulate airport fares and fees after privatization. He did not rule out costs rising for travellers.

An executive at the International Air Transport Association told The Globe last month that

major airlines oppose the plan, warning it would drive up fees paid by the airlines, which would be forced to pass on the higher costs to travellers.

On Wednesday, a report from the University of Calgary's economics department said the government needs to set the rules on airport operations before inviting offers from institutional investors.

The country's four largest airports could fetch between \$12-billion and \$29-billion, according to the report's author, economist Aidan Hollis. In the report, he said: "That range is not a fact about airports, it is a bet on how they will be regulated."

Putting passenger-friendly regulations in place "will determine both what users pay and what the airports are worth," Dr. Hollis said.

Canada's airport authorities have long pushed for the federal government to reinvest the rent it receives from airports. Since the 1990s, the airports have paid a cumulative total of \$8.4-billion in rent to the government, including \$556-million in 2025, while spending more than \$30-billion in infrastructure and improvements.

Galloway: Author testifies he became program chair after relationship ended in 2013

■ FROM A1

She alleged he grabbed her by the throat, kissed her and threw her up against the bed in the bow when she tried to escape. She said she later managed to leave the vessel.

The woman alleged he said to her: "See, that wasn't so bad."

Mr. Galloway said this incident was a fabrication.

"That never happened, there was never a day in March of 2011 that we went to that boat," he testified. "It's hard to know how to dismantle it because the entire story is just fictional there aren't facts to dispute."

He told the court that if he had thrown the woman through the small opening to the berth, he would have injured her badly.

He also testified that later in their affair she asked him to stay on his boat because her husband's violent relative was com-



Author Steven Galloway is seen through a window as he leaves B.C. Supreme Court during a lunch break at his defamation lawsuit, in Vancouver, on Tuesday. DARRYL DYCK/THE CANADIAN PRESS

ing to stay at their house.

"It's inconceivable that a person who reported thinking she was going to be murdered and thrown overboard would speak

of the boat in subsequent years as a safe space," he said.

In the second incident, the court heard that A.B. said she got drunk on tequila shots bought by

Mr. Galloway at a creative writing program party. He then offered her a ride home but first said he wanted to go to his office to change out of his party clothes.

The court also heard A.B. told Mary Ellen Boyd, the retired judge hired by UBC to look into the matter, that she remembers him straddling over her with his penis exposed and after she objected, he backed off.

Mr. Galloway testified that he didn't think he offered to drive her home as they lived in opposite directions, but he did recall going back to his office where they had sex "with full consent from both parties."

In a third incident, A.B. alleged that prior to a scheduled reading on campus by the author Miriam Toews in May, 2011, she found herself naked and hunched on the floor in Mr. Galloway's office. He had had sex with her and was watching a hockey game on his

computer, she told Ms. Boyd.

But Mr. Galloway testified he was not in the room and text messages shown in court indicated that at that time he was watching the game at a campus pub.

Court heard Ms. Boyd found Mr. Galloway had sexually harassed A.B. because of the power differential between the two of them and A.B.'s belief that opportunities in the creative writing program were tied to their sexual relationship.

But Mr. Galloway testified he became program chair after their relationship ended in 2013 and that any power imbalance between them was "extremely minor."

He said that during his 10-hour interview with Ms. Boyd, only about 10 minutes was spent on the sexual harassment allegation. He said his main focus was refuting the sexual assault allegations.

Cities: Fewer people in same number of places



■ FROM A1

In March, Prime Minister Mark Carney pledged \$4.4-billion to “housing-related infrastructure” in Ontario, and in June, the government pledged \$1.6-billion over 10 years for such projects in British Columbia.

But experts suggest some of this spending could be put to better use, or avoided entirely.

That is because governments rarely ask a fundamental question: Where do we have unused capacity? Many urban neighbourhoods have water systems, roads, parks and schools that were built for larger populations than today’s.

As new houses have been built across the Lower Mainland and the Greater Toronto and Hamilton Area, as apartment towers have swelled the populations of formerly desolate industrial districts, each city has maintained an archipelago of neighbourhoods where neighbours have become increasingly scarce.

The Globe compared figures from the 1971 and 2021 censuses for both Toronto and Vancouver, examining the population of “dissemination areas” — each one an area of a few blocks, typically home to about 500 people.

In the Vancouver region, 21 per cent of those areas declined in population over those 50 years, losing 76,424 people in total. Many other areas failed to keep up with the quick growth of the region.

In the Toronto region, the pattern is much more stark: Almost three-quarters of those established areas had declined by 2021, shedding a total of 540,789 people.

This pattern is hard to discern on the streetscape; these prosperous cities generally do not have crumbling, empty buildings or vacant lots. But the declines are subtly reflected in empty public-school classrooms, a lack of foot traffic and the closing of neighbourhood retailers.

The history of growth and shrinkage is shaped by a combination of demographic changes and specific urban planning policies. But nothing is set in stone: Experts say these places could yet absorb more residents, often at a lower cost than building entirely new communities.

Cyclists and pedestrians use the Arbutus corridor in Vancouver’s Kerrisdale neighbourhood in May. Many blocks in the area have lost between 10 and 30 per cent of their population since the 1970s.

JENNIFER GAUTHIER/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

SHIFTING DEMOGRAPHICS

Several demographic trends contribute to the pattern of the shrinking city. Canadians today are living longer, having fewer children and occupying more square footage than previous generations.

Roland Haebler is a case in point. A general contractor, he was raised on the west side of Vancouver. He and his wife raised their two sons in a 3,400-square-foot house in Kerrisdale; they remain there as empty nesters, though their son’s dog Hershy is often around the house.

“We live in the same space as when we had two boys who walked to school,” said Mr. Haebler, 65. Their pandemic project was to convert their coach house into a music studio. “And now we have a spare bedroom, and I’ve moved my study from the basement into one of the other bedrooms.”

Professor Maxwell Hartt, a geographer at Queen’s University who studies population decline, says that this story is quite typical. In the shrinking zones of Toronto and Vancouver, “there aren’t a lot of vacant homes,” he said. “It is fewer people in the same amount of places.”

Canadians are having fewer children. Young parents often choose to move from cities to suburbs. And seniors — whose lifespan has increased from an average of about 75 to 82 in the past four decades — are largely remaining in place, by choice or by necessity.

The COVID-19 pandemic prompted thousands of people to migrate out of large cities, particularly Toronto and its adjacent communities. However, that pattern was outweighed until 2025 by high levels of international migration; both the Toronto and Vancouver metro areas have continued to grow in each year of the past decade except for last year.

“There are, I’m sure, many retired people who would be happy to move down,” Dr. Hartt said, “but there isn’t a condo or an apartment nearby to move into in their community.”

Mr. Haebler was surprised to learn that most blocks in his neighbourhood have lost people. Some of his neighbours have divided up their lots to make room for new apartments, often for their children. “Everybody’s got a laneway suite now, and everybody’s got a basement suite,” he remarked.

“There’s multiple generations living in homes where there was only one before.”

Such small-scale additions to the neighbourhood, which planners describe as “gentle density,” don’t trouble Mr. Haebler. But these building projects are outnumbered by changes in the other direction. Empty nesters are more numerous; families are often smaller; and buildings are being converted from rooming houses or apartments into single-family homes. To reverse the current trend in Kerrisdale would require big, visible change, with mid-rise or even tall buildings permitted across a wider area.

“In Burnaby, there are high-rises going up everywhere,” Mr. Haebler mused. If such large buildings were permitted in Kerrisdale, “I don’t think I would like that very much.”

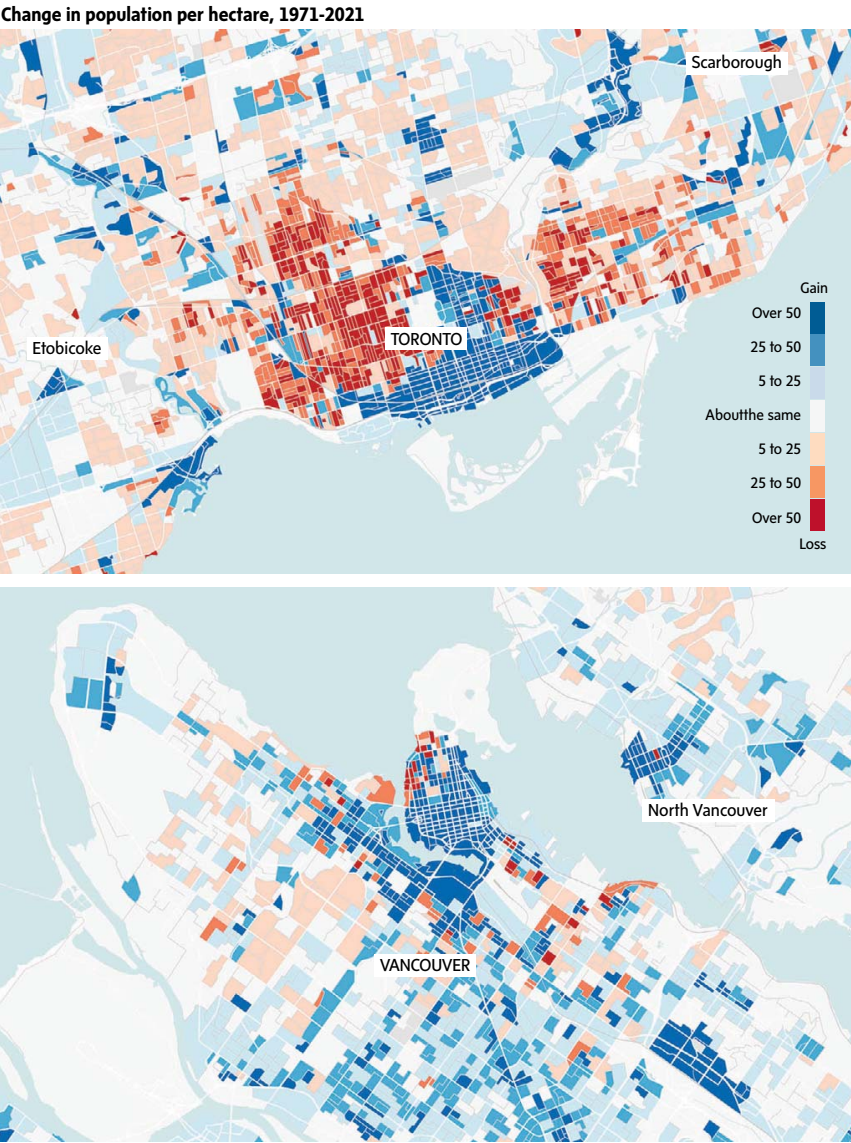
Mr. Haebler has no interest in selling his house to a developer, and would not support larger buildings on his block.

Such attitudes are common. And while new buildings generate political friction, nobody really notices when existing buildings shed some of their occupants.

The latter trend is common enough in Vancouver, but far more pronounced in Toronto. A large zone of the old City of Toronto, running along Bathurst Street westward to High Park and north to Eglinton Avenue, has seen declines of up to 40 per cent.

Through the 19th century, houses here were home to larger families, and it was common for homeowners to take in tenants. The crowding increased as immigrants arrived in large numbers following the Second World War: Among them were Italians, Portuguese, Poles and Ukrainians, who each settled the west side of the city and then in many cases became homeowners, often raising large families.

As these latter groups became wealthier and more established, they largely moved to the new suburbs of Metro Toronto and beyond. The side streets near the core continued to hold two- and three-storey houses, but those houses gradually became emptier.



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: STATISTICS CANADA

Cities: Growth plans often face political headwinds



■ FROM A7

“In house neighbourhoods, the population had declined dramatically from seven people in a house to two or three,” he said. “So the housing stock itself could accommodate lots of new people.”

And with the addition of new buildings, he added, “these zones could accommodate a lot more.” They had “soft infrastructure” such as parks and schools, and they were close to downtown jobs, particularly in Toronto.

But in each case, there was a catch. New residents moved into existing cities – but regional and provincial planning generally didn’t dictate where they should go within those cities.

So, as in many other North American cities, a grand bargain was struck: New housing was pushed into the places where few people lived, principally industrial districts near downtown, while house neighbourhoods remained unchanged. In Toronto, the King-Spadina and Liberty Village districts rapidly transformed from industrial uses to high-density neighbourhoods with tens of thousands of residents.

“We protected certain neighbourhoods, so a lot of the geography of the city was insulated from change,” said Josh White, the City of Vancouver’s chief planner. “Those weren’t just geographic realities; those were geographic realities combined with political choices that we made.”

This has generated an uneven pattern of growth sometimes described as “tall and sprawl.” In Vancouver, that has meant high-rise residential buildings within the city’s downtown peninsula, and clusters in the suburban downtowns of Surrey and Burnaby. It has also meant mid-rise buildings focused on particular major streets, but not on the streets next to them.

As an example, Mr. White cited the Cambie Corridor Plan that added new housing when the Canada Line transit route was completed in 2009.

Development “is heavily concentrated physically on Cambie Street, to the exclusion of a lot of density even blocks away,” Mr. White explained. “That’s been the typical pattern of growth in Vancouver for

the last couple generations. And that’s one of the patterns we’re trying to shift now.”

The city’s new Official Development Plan, which took effect in March, opened up the potential for new middle-density housing across a much larger swath of the city, organized into 17 new “villages.” The goal was to permit townhouses and small apartment buildings in areas that have seen little construction for decades, and to even out the city’s peaks and valleys in population.

However, Vancouver City Council decisively rejected the villages idea in July. Councillor Sarah Kirby-Yung described the public response as “a landslide of opposition.”

Reversing the patterns of the past 50 years will be difficult, and there are serious political headwinds. Questions around new housing – how much should be added, where and in what form – have dominated Vancouver politics for a generation. Housing has not dominated Toronto’s politics to the same degree, but change remains unpopular.

Still, intensification could pay fiscal and social benefits.

EMPTY SCHOOLS, EMPTY PIPES

In central Toronto, Darlene Varaleau remembers when the schoolyard at Bickford Park High School was full of action.

“This place used to be busy,” recalled Ms. Varaleau, gesturing at the high school and community centre across the street from her house near Bloor and Christie Streets. “All the children used to go to after-school programs and have swimming lessons here. And then the kids grew up, and most of them left.”

The high school sat in the public park of the same name. Now called Bickford Centre, the building opened in 1965 to serve a growing population of immigrants and local baby boomers alongside a city-run public facility called Bob Abate Community Recreation Centre.

It rises five storeys high and includes a gym, swimming pool and auditorium. But the school

A man walks his dogs through Bickford Park in Toronto in May. The nearby Bob Abate Community Recreation Centre opened in 1965 alongside a school, now called Bickford Centre. Both remain open, but the school is mostly empty.
LAURA PROCTOR/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

that once served 1,000 students is largely quiet. In the previous academic year, according to a Toronto District School Board spokesperson, Bickford Centre housed four small specialty high schools with a total of 77 students, while 386 adult students attended short-term programs.

At any given time, this facility is mostly empty. Ms. Varaleau, 74, is advocating for new community programs to make use of the building.

The school board offers one visible example of underused infrastructure in our big cities. For two decades, TDSB and Ontario’s Ministry of Education have argued over funding of its facilities.

This tension is connected to the city’s pattern of growth and shrinkage. In a few places, TDSB schools are oversubscribed. But the board has 301,366 classroom spaces and only 234,514 students, leaving nearly 69,000 empty seats. These are largely located in areas whose population has been declining for years.

Ms. Varaleau’s block, steps from the Christie subway station, had about 750 people in 1971. As of 2021, it had roughly 500, and that number is shrinking.

“There was a migration out of this area,” Ms. Varaleau explained. “You know, these were big families. There were a lot of people in these houses. And now, this is a desirable place to live, so you’ve got two people where there were five or more.”

Indeed, the average household size across Canada has shrunk significantly over the past two generations, from 3.5 in 1971 to 2.4 in 2021. In Toronto, and particularly in older districts such as Ms. Varaleau’s, the change is still more pronounced.

Children in Toronto today are heavily concentrated in a few places – largely the zones where many new homes have been built in condominium apartments. When young couples in those areas have children, many of them will stay in place or else move to the suburbs in search of more space. Houses in the central city, which remain more expensive, can be financially out of reach.

A similar phenomenon is occurring in Vancouver. The downtown Olympic Village neighbourhood, which has many young families, has seen calls for a



Questions around housing have dominated politics in Vancouver for a generation.
JENNIFER GAUTHIER/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

Right: Roland Haebler and his wife raised their two sons in a 3,400-square-foot house in Kerrisdale; they remain there as empty nesters
JENNIFER GAUTHIER/THE GLOBE AND MAIL





Because today's families are smaller than those of past generations, houses will likely need to be replaced by apartments.

LAURA PROCTOR/THE GLOBE AND MAIL



new school for a decade. A new elementary school is now slated to open in 2029. At the same time, the Vancouver School Board's buildings in many other downtown areas are below capacity. Meanwhile, suburban boards are booming. Last year, the Surrey Board of Education approved a \$5.7-billion, five-year capital plan including 27 new schools.

In both cities, particularly in Toronto, schools are maintaining empty space while new school buildings are being constructed from scratch.

New suburban development generally requires all-new infrastructure. And the cost of building it, in places where homes are spread out, is high.

A 2021 study by Hemson Consulting for the City of Ottawa found that when low-density suburban houses are built, they create a deficit: Their property taxes do not cover the cost of the public infrastructure such as water mains, each home leaving the city worse off by \$465 a year. Conversely, infill growth generated a surplus of \$606 per home – property taxes cover all the costs of infrastructure, and then some.

That holds true even in places where water infrastructure is aging and under strain, said Kerry Black, an associate professor and Canada Research Chair in the Department of Civil Engineering at the University of Calgary.

Calgary has coped with two water-main failures – on the same pipe, the 50-year-old Bears paw South Feeder Main – in the past two years. But Dr. Black said such failures are about aging infrastructure, not heavy use. “In many cases we’re not using these systems to their full capacity,” she said. “But they are at their end of life and will need major repairs anyway.”

Expanding cities out into new territory does not reduce that cost, she says; it simply adds new infrastructure that is costly and that will also need to be maintained and repaired.

“Imagine it in the context of a house,” she said. “I’ve got an old house, and now I’m going to buy a new one because it seems like it needs less maintenance.” But government, in this metaphor, keeps the old place and takes care of both.

The better solution, she suggested, is “to fix the existing house, to get the value for our money that we put into it at the outset.” Repairs or replacements to existing water infrastructure, she added, can also add more capacity in any places where it is needed.

Constructing all sorts of infrastructure “is far less expensive” in urban areas than it is in newly built neighbourhoods, said Shoshanna Saxe, associate professor of civil and mineral engineering at the University of Toronto.

Dr. Saxe argued that intensification could focus on neighbourhoods built after 1950. Many of these have similar patterns of population decline to those in older neighbourhoods.

And generally, Dr. Saxe said, these postwar suburbs have “overbuilt” networks of roads and water infrastructure. “It’s not just that there used to be more people there,” she said.

“It’s that we have capacity within our networks to add more people because of things like fire requirements.”

Water supply systems are designed to deliver pressure to meet peak demand – which is determined by requirements for fire trucks pumping water to fight a fire, typically 10 times the pressure required for normal demand. “In almost all suburban neighbourhoods you have more water capacity than you need to serve the people there,” Dr. Saxe explains. “You could add lots of people before you needed more water pipes.”

Their roads, meanwhile, “are hugely overbuilt” relative to the populations they support, Dr. Saxe said.

These road networks can accommodate more people if certain streets were consolidated and if

Darlene Varaleau, above, is advocating for new community programs to make use of the Bickford Centre building.

LAURA PROCTOR/THE GLOBE AND MAIL

more road space was shifted from driving to mass transit, such as bus lanes and cycling.

In short, use what you have.

NO MORE SPRAWL?

To back up the idea that more compact cities are more cost-effective, Canadians would need to take stock of existing infrastructure. How do we do that? “We don’t,” Dr. Saxe said. “If there are comprehensive studies, I’m not aware of them.”

Generally, Canadian governments build infrastructure in response to population growth; they do not count their existing assets.

But there is one exception, an existing model in Canada for directing growth to where the capacity is: transit-oriented development. Ontario’s 2024 provincial planning statement directs new housing to transit stations. British Columbia has an analogous transit-oriented development policy, introduced in 2023.

Transit-oriented development is a well-established policy across the country – although it has not been widely implemented outside the Vancouver

region. Now, there are signs that this tool could start to open the door to change in existing house neighbourhoods.

Jason Thorne, the City of Toronto’s chief planner, pointed to recent planning changes that favour small “multiplex” apartments, and newly updated zoning that would open up broader zones around transit stations.

“We are starting to see more housing permissions in neighbourhoods than has ever been the case” since the beginnings of land-use planning 80 years ago, he said. This will make the decisions “about where we put infrastructure much more complex and complicated,” he said, because growth patterns may be less focused and less predictable.

Complicated – but possible. Could we simply redirect much of the new housing, and new people, across existing neighbourhoods? Dr. Saxe suggested yes, with a caveat.

“The infrastructure could take it,” she said, “but the buildings will look different.”

Because today’s families are smaller than those of past generations, houses will need to be replaced by apartments. “There will be different types of units, different types of living, which will require construction.”

What might this look like? For specific examples, we can look back to how Canadian central cities grew in the 1950s and 60s – with clusters of mid-rise and high-rise apartment buildings.

The City of Vancouver allowed the intensification of the West End; there, more than 220 high-rise apartment towers were added between 1962 and 1975, adding about 10,000 people. Toronto saw a similar but more dispersed pattern: Several central neighbourhoods, including the Annex, saw substantial apartment construction between 1954 and 1972.

Individual houses were replaced, often one or two at a time, by buildings containing many more homes. (Across the Toronto region, more than 1,000 mid-rise and high-rise apartment towers were built in that postwar period, and they now house a total of a million people.) In both the Toronto and Vancouver cases, the street networks and public spaces remained largely intact as the housing stock changed.

Repeating this model on a larger scale could mean designating particular urban areas for redevelopment, as Vancouver tried to do with its rejeeted Villages initiative.

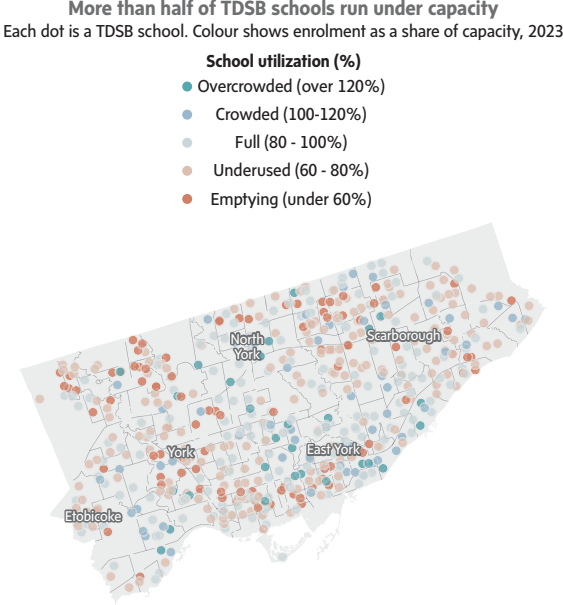
Or it could mean a more widespread adoption of density – altering regulations for big cities, or their most central neighbourhoods, rather than making new rules block-by-block. Instead of focusing around transit stations, a central-city policy would emphasize the general presence of amenities and transit.

This would represent a rethink in planning and in municipal politics. The generational compromise of “tall-and-sprawl,” block-by-block planning would be replaced by a different pattern, one that would allow growth across urban centres.

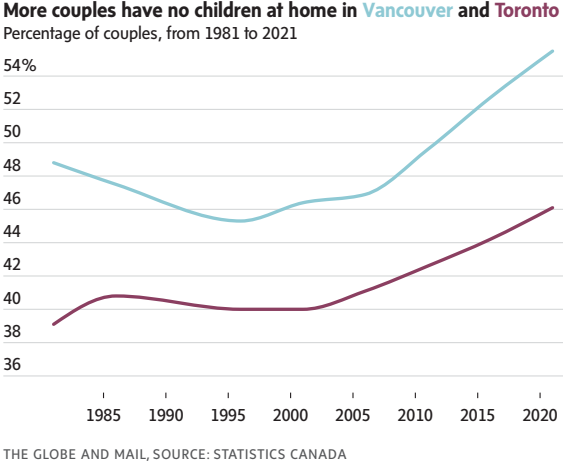
Within those chosen zones, large new buildings and houses would stand alongside one another. Allowing private builders, and non-profit housing developers, to construct apartments across a much wider territory would shake up the markets for development land and for housing.

Politically, this would be very difficult – as evidenced by Mr. Haebler’s reaction to seeing apartments in his neighbourhood, and the public outcry that led Vancouver politicians to pause the city’s plan.

Still, Dr. Saxe suggested that some form of more focused metropolitan growth would generate serious benefits through building on the cities we already have. “We can take advantage,” she said, “of a massive, expensive, underused infrastructure.”



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: TORONTO DISTRICT SCHOOL BOARD



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: STATISTICS CANADA

EDITORIAL

ANDREW SAUNDERS
PRESIDENT AND CEO

DAVID WALMSLEY
EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

The subject who is truly loyal to the chief magistrate will neither advise nor submit to arbitrary measures - Junius

The real reason for the return of the PQ

The election of a minority Parti Québécois government in Quebec on Monday is not just any political event. The PQ has vowed to hold a referendum on independence during its four-year mandate, adding itself to the short list of provinces, Alberta being the other, that is flirting with separation.

All of this is happening as Canada fights a trade war with the United States and is standing up to President Donald Trump’s repeated threats to annex its neighbour. Unity is what the country needs and suddenly it has more disunity than ever. Or so it might appear.

The fact is that, while the PQ’s victory is disturbing on the surface, it is in no way an enthusiastic endorsement of the party’s referendum dreams. If the election reveals anything at all, it is that Quebec voters are ready to support parties that are right of centre and focused on improving the province’s economy.

On the 50th anniversary of the PQ’s historic first election to power in 1976, PQ leader Paul St-Pierre Plamondon has delivered the party’s weakest victory ever.

At its peak in the 1970s, 80s and 90s, social-democratic PQ governments would win over 40 per cent of the popular vote and hold solid majorities in the National Assembly.

Since then, the party first led by René Lévesque has had little success as Quebecers’ desire for independence has waned.

It last formed a minority government in 2012 with 31.95 per cent of the popular vote.

Mr. St-Pierre Plamondon took the PQ to a new low Monday. His party received just 27.9 per cent of the popular vote, the lowest of any party forming government in the province’s history, let alone the PQ’s. He won 59 seats, five short of a majority.

While this is a step forward for the PQ, which held seven seats going into the election, it cannot reasonably be called a mandate to hold something as consequential as another referendum.

Nearly six out of 10 Quebecers (58.2 per cent) cast votes for the three parties explicitly opposed to another referendum: the Liberals, the Conservatives and Coalition Avenir Québec.

Even Mr. St-Pierre Plamondon knew that independence wasn’t top-of-mind for voters. He softened his position just prior to the campaign to say he would only call a referendum after Mr. Trump leaves office in January, 2029.

If voters were hungry for anything, it was change. The incumbent CAQ, which formed two majority governments in a row, didn’t win a single seat.

Voters instead spread their ballots across four parties, including the left-wing, pro-independence Québec Solidaire. That party saw its seat count drop by two and its share of the popular vote fall three points.

The Conservatives, meanwhile, went from one seat to 19, while the business-oriented and avowedly federalist Liberals went from 18 to 40.

The parties that benefited most from the collapse of the CAQ can be said to be right of centre, albeit to different degrees, the (formerly left-leaning) PQ included.

All three promised to restrain government spending, balance budgets, shrink the bureaucracy, cut regulatory red tape and lower taxes – especially business taxes. The Liberals and PQ targeted small and medium-sized businesses, while the Conservatives pitched a whopping across-the-board corporate tax cut of 59 per cent.

All three parties also promised to reduce permanent and temporary immigration to the extent that the province can do that. And two of them – the PQ and Conservatives – pushed hard on crime and public safety, promising to hire more police officers and prosecutors.

The real take-away from the election is that the vast majority Quebecers put their faith in parties that will address the province’s economy and other issues from the right of centre. Less than one-third of them also put their faith in a party that wants to hold another referendum – a figure that aligns with polling that shows support for independence is perennially mired at about 30 per cent.

Mr. St-Pierre Plamondon is stuck with his promise to hold a referendum some time in 2029. Most Quebecers, with more pressing issues on their minds, would seem to prefer it if he didn’t bother.



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

OUT WITH THE OLD

Re “The PQ is back in office without a lot of people power behind the next premier” (Oct. 7): I’m not too excited by the Parti Québécois getting the most seats in Quebec.

While they campaigned on holding yet another referendum on separation from Canada, they only have a minority government with the provincial Liberals and Conservatives vowing to block any such vote in the National Assembly.

More significantly, the Coalition Avenir Québec government of the past eight years went to zero seats. I suspect voters badly wanted the CAQ gone and the PQ was the best vehicle to achieve that.

This is nothing new. Voters of ten cast ballots against a party, not for one.

■ **Bryan McConachy** West Vancouver

MARKET FORCES

Re “Whose interest?” and “Head in the sand” (Letters, Oct. 6): An interesting juxtaposition of commentary about energy resources highlights the dynamics of how our society views technology and the environment.

The oil industry certainly appears to be tipping the scales in favour of oil sands consolidation (“Cenovus bulks up on oil sands with \$5.7-billion Athabasca buy” – Report on Business, Oct. 6). Yet we also learn that innovations will enable solar panels to convert more sunlight into usable electricity (“U.S. solar producers say they are close to breakthrough” – Report on Business, Oct. 6).

I remain optimistic that the marketplace will determine winners and losers and which energy assets end up stranded. After all, a pipeline “approved” does not necessarily translate into a pipeline built.

■ **Chris Gates** Cobourg, Ont.

Too bad that Cenovus, though headquartered in Calgary, isn’t really a Canadian company with only 18.1 per cent of shareholders located in Canada, according to available information. Shareholders located in the United States own 36.5 per cent of the company, while the rest are mostly located in other foreign countries and 11.2 per cent are of unknown geographic location.

Even Canadian Natural Resources is 59.7 per cent owned by U.S. shareholders, while Imperial Oil is 68 per cent owned by Exxon-Mobil.

Too much of Canada’s natural resources are foreign-owned.

■ **Mike Priaro** Calgary

ON MURDER

Re “Does Canada punish murder too harshly? B.C.’s top court wades into the debate” (Oct. 5): In a

classic episode of *The Simpsons*, Fat Tony explains his criminal enterprise to Bart. He resorts convincingly to a series of reasonable hypotheticals which starts by asking, “Bart, um, is it wrong to steal a loaf of bread to feed your starving family?” I laugh even now at the satirical cartoon.

But it’s less amusing when this same “logic” is inverted and advanced to persuade us that a 25-year mandatory minimum for first-degree murder is unconstitutional. This absurdity is compounded by alternative attacks: for example, that the number is arbitrary, as if the proffered 15 years somehow isn’t, or statistical comparisons to other supposedly more enlightened and invariably lenient jurisdictions. The logic is circular and, I believe, specious.

Twenty-five years at least staves off the prospect of repeated parole hearings for the surviving family of murder victims. They are real people suffering real harm. They are not hypothetical.

■ **Ron Beram** Gabriola, B.C.

I don’t think “faint hope” is the right term for the clause which gives convicted murderers the right to a parole hearing after 15 years of their 25-year sentence.

The article shows that fully 72.5 per cent of applicants were granted earlier parole.

■ **Jim Duholke** North Vancouver

UP AND DOWN

Re “As international student numbers tumble, domestic post-secondary enrolment rebounds” (Report on Business, Oct. 2): Finally some positive news in this sorry saga.

Let’s call a spade a spade: It seems many of the so-called students coming to Canada were not here for education, but for a shortcut to landed immigrant status. It has been reported on numerous occasions about schools set up to milk the system and reap tuition fees.

The only people wringing their hands now are the immigration consultants who earned income on student placement, the colleges and universities who lined their pockets with higher tuition fees and the employers who padded their profit using cheap labour instead of hiring Canadians.

Now we’re educating more of our own youth and creating a more qualified Canadian work force, instead of having to attract educated workers from other countries. It seems to me that is what our education system was supposed to do in the first place.

■ **Graham Farrell** Toronto

LESSON PLAN

Re “The education system’s failing report card” (The Sunday Editorial, Oct. 4): While Canadians should be concerned about academic declines on scores from the

Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development’s Program for International Student Assessment in reading, mathematics and science, it’s also critical to consider what the more granular results suggest: that standardized testing was never the simple answer for educational attainment.

Saskatchewan’s inconvenient truth shouldn’t be ignored as the only province without a standardized testing program in high school during the scoring period. It bucked a trend: Provincial scores went up in science and mathematics; in reading, scores dropped the least of all the provinces.

Follow the data. Rather than more failed testing, we should redirect the millions that fund testing programs back into classrooms, teachers, educational assistants, specialists and the more general fight against poverty.

■ **Marc Spooner** Regina

Thank you for shining a light on the complex headwinds facing Canadian education.

For literacy in Ontario, things are shifting with an updated curriculum and the introduction of early literacy screeners. But even when a student is screened, what happens if they are behind?

Many students, especially those who are older, continue to flounder in a system that gives them accommodations, modified grades and laptops instead of literacy assessments, appropriate interventions and progress monitoring. Added to this challenge, there is little consistency across schools within a board, let alone across boards within the province.

How do we know this? We live it every day. Our kids floundered and we had to find solutions outside the system. Not everyone can. No one should.

We need both more investment from the government and accountability from our school boards. There is no time to waste. All kids deserve to learn how to read.

■ **Jackie Wyld** VP, International Dyslexia Association Ontario; Toronto

■ **Alison Bing** Director, International Dyslexia Association Ontario; Mississauga

FEEL SEEN

Re “I thought aging had made me invisible, when really I had become camouflaged” (First Person, Oct. 5): Invisible by 60? There is hope. In 30 years’ time, you would be 90 and not believing the attention you receive.

Nobody can believe you’re still alive, walking around unaided, talking intelligently. If I had known I was going to be this visible at 90, I would have gotten here sooner.

■ **Elizabeth Thompson** Oakville, Ont.

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 OPINION

Why Canada needs warning labels on alcohol

Legislation currently before the Senate would make that a reality

MONTY GHOSH
ERIC YOSHIDA
ROBERT STRANG

OPINION

Monty Ghosh is an associate professor in the University of Alberta's Faculty of Medicine and Dentistry.

Eric Yoshida is a professor in the University of British Columbia's Department of Medicine.

Robert Strang is the chair of the Council of Chief Medical Officers of Health.

When Canadians reach for beer, wine, or spirits, most think about taste, price, or occasion. Few think about cancer. In Canada, this may be about to change. Bill S-202 is now at third reading in the Senate and is expected to move to the House of Commons this month.

If passed, it would become the first alcohol labelling bill to clear a chamber of Parliament. The bill would require alcohol products to carry a clear health warning, including about alcohol's direct link to cancer, cirrhosis, mental-health concerns and addiction. Canadians have a right to straightforward, evidence-based information about the health risks of the products we consume – including alcohol. Alcoholic beverages are classified as a Group 1 carcinogen, a designation reserved for exposures conclusively shown to cause cancer. Among consumable products sold in Canadian grocery stores, only two fall into this category: alcoholic beverages and processed meats. Alcohol's cancer risk is not speculative, indirect or disputed. The burden is substantial. A study in *Nature* examining 30 modifiable risk factors ranked alcohol as the third-leading cause of new cancer cases worldwide, after tobacco smoking and infections. In Canada, it was estimated nearly 9,500 cancer cases and 3,900 deaths would not have occurred without alcohol in 2022. Alcohol has also become one of the leading causes for liver trans-

plantation in Canada. Yet public awareness of alcohol's serious health risks remains low. Only one in three Canadian adults who drink alcohol know that it causes seven different types of cancer, including breast, liver and colon cancer. Even fewer know that risk rises even at "moderate" levels of one to two drinks daily. At this level the estimated lifetime cancer risk increases by 1 to 3 per cent for men and 2 to 5 per cent for women. Put plainly, out of every 100 women who drink at this level, two to five will develop cancer because of alcohol. Those numbers may look small, but across a population they add up to thousands of preventable cancers. Critics call this fear-mongering. The science says otherwise. Alcohol is associated with injuries, impaired driving, family violence and other social harms. Alcohol is ranked the top substance to cause harm in Canada. The risks to individuals are real and the damage at the population level is profound. The economic costs are equally stark. Alcohol is conservatively estimated to impose nearly \$20-billion annually in societal costs in Canada, including health care

and criminal justice costs, far exceeding government revenues from alcohol sales. Canadians already expect products that pose health risks to carry clear warnings. Medications disclose side effects and contraindications. Tobacco and cannabis products display prominent health warnings. Foods high in sodium, sugars or saturated fat must now carry front-of-package warning symbols. Even energy drinks now require "cautionary labels." Yet alcohol remains one of the few consumer products sold in Canada that is not required to communicate this risk on its label. Bill S-202 would bring alcohol labelling in line with the consumer right-to-know standards that already apply across Canada's regulatory system. Do warning labels work? Their purpose is to communicate risk and support informed choice, not to eliminate drinking. An analysis of decades of research, led by Canadian researchers Erin Hobin and Tim Stockwell and published in *The Lancet Public Health*, found that alcohol labels effectively communicate health risks and support safer alcohol decisions. In real-world settings,

such labels are also associated with modest but meaningful behaviour change, including a 6-per-cent reduction in per capita alcohol sales. In a Canadian survey of nearly 10,000 adults, 72 per cent said a label stating the alcohol-cancer link would make them think about cutting back. That is informed decision-making, not fear. Momentum is building. In Canada, a joint statement from the chief medical officers of health from all 13 provinces and territories calls for nationally mandated alcohol warning labels. A growing number of Canadian organizations endorse labels, including the Canadian Cancer Society, the Canadian Medical Association, and others. Governments have long recognized their responsibility to inform Canadians about product risks through health labelling. Clear risk communication is not about prohibition or moral judgment. It is about transparency, consistency and informed choice. Bill S-202 offers a low-cost way to close the gap between what people know and what science has long established.

A Nobel for Mark Carney? Premature. Person of the Year award? Thumbs-up

LAWRENCE MARTIN

OPINION



The Nobel Peace Prize is being announced Friday and Prime Minister Mark Carney is considered a contender. Can we imagine if it's the Canadian who takes the award and not the man in the White House who has hardly let a week go by without sounding desperate for the honour? Donald Trump claims he has ended no fewer than eight wars. If you adjust the definition of war to include skirmishes, vigorous tussles and dust-ups, it's true. Instead of him for the prize, how about the Canadian who he helped bring to fame with his attacks, and who is in the process of building a middle-power coalition against Mr. Trump's hegemonic bullying? Mr. Trump would be catatonic. His belligerence toward lifelong neighbour and friend Canada would be seen to have backfired even more than it already has. Since his landmark speech at the World Economic Forum at Davos in January, Mr. Carney has been praised widely for his poise and eloquence in articulating the case against Mr. Trump, who is an intellectual flyweight by comparison. The possibility of the Prime Minister winning the Nobel is enhanced by the fact that there is no clear favourite this year. But Mr. Carney has been in power only a year and half. He hasn't negotiated a peace treaty or an arms accord or ended a war.



Prime Minister Mark Carney participates in a joint news conference with President of the European Parliament Roberta Metsola, not shown, at the European Parliament in Strasbourg, France, in September. JUSTIN TANG/CP

He has been hesitant in addressing the sudden and alarming threat to world peace that is artificial intelligence. To give him the Nobel honour this year would be premature. We need see how his campaign of resistance to Mr. Trump develops, if progress is made on an international order to counter the U.S. President. Were Mr. Carney to win the Nobel Prize, it would bring to mind Barack Obama winning it in 2009, less than eight months into his presidency. The choice was criticized because though his speechmaking was inspirational and his multilateral ideals laudatory, Mr. Obama had no tangible achievement in international di-

plomacy at the time. He expressed doubts himself whether he was worthy of the honour. Mr. Carney might feel the same way were he to get it. Other possible winners include Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, child rights advocate Mykola Kuleba, Pope Leo XIV and a non-person, the International Space Station. Pope Leo's work should be noted not only for his speaking out against international conflicts but for his *AI* encyclical, *Magnifica Humanitas*, a clarion call to prevent the human race from succumbing to technology. But oddly, curiously, no pope has won the Nobel Peace Prize since its inception in 1901. Canada's Nobel winning record

for individuals can be embarrassingly counted on one finger, Lester Pearson being the sole winner in 1957. (The Pugwash Conferences on Science and World Affairs was a joint winner in 1995.) The U.S. has had 23 winners, Britain 12, France nine, and Switzerland, home to many peace organizations, six. Mr. Carney has a considerably better chance of winning another prestigious prize: *Time* Magazine's Person of the Year honour. Canada's record is even more dismal for this distinction than for the Nobel. It's been awarded since 1927. We've not won it once. The Time designation is not a peace prize but is based rather on global influence and news im-

pact. Prediction markets see Mr. Carney as a leading contender. As an international newsmaker, he has eclipsed European and other leaders in becoming the standard bearer for an alternative geopolitical vision to the dictates of the megapowers. Mr. Carney hasn't always resisted Mr. Trump at home or abroad. Oftentimes he has given in, but the foreign press coverage has focused on his Davos speech and his being the leader bold enough to retaliate against the Trump tariffs. With the exception of Fox News and far-right media taking their cue from Mr. Trump's White House minions and attacking him regularly, Mr. Carney has gained widespread respect. In an interview with *The Guardian* this week, Canada's national soccer team coach, Jesse Marsch, who is an American, compared the Canadian leader's calm, intelligent air to that of Mr. Obama. The Wisconsin-born Mr. Marsch stoked controversy in saying Americans are "inundated with propaganda" from a young age and "feel like we deserve to be treated differently because we're Americans." Multi-ethnic Canada is so refreshingly different, he said, praising Mr. Carney for his diversification strategies, in particular his outreach to Europe. The Person of the Year honour has gone to Mr. Trump twice for his election victories in 2016 and 2024. This year, Mr. Carney would be a worthy recipient. It would enrage the Oval Office demagogue, maybe enough to bring on more tariffs or to have him rename another lake, thus enhancing the Canadian's stature all the more.

For many fraternities, entitlement is a feature, not a bug

LISA WADE

OPINION

Author of *Exposed: A College in Crisis Puts Science to the Test and American Hookup: The New Culture of Sex on Campus*

During a lull in what Jane Doe has alleged was a seven-hour sexual assault, a Cornell University Chi Phi brother sent a vulgar but audacious text to his fraternity group chat. It stated that a woman's body was "free" for the taking upstairs. Another member later responded: "Shop still open?" These do not appear to be the words of men who fear consequences for their behaviour. And in fairness, fraternity men commit crimes with little consequence all the time. On any given campus with Greek life, fraternity houses are sites where alcohol is served to minors. Many are also places where hazing, illegal drug use, assault and battery, and, yes, sexual violence occur. Yet U.S. colleges and universities have an abysmal

record of holding brothers accountable. As a sociologist who's studied U.S. college life for more than 15 years, I've learned that risk-taking – and more perniciously, risk-making – is not incidental, but rather long constitutive of the power and pleasure of membership in historically white fraternities with generational wealth. The first social fraternity was founded in 1825 by a group of men at Union College in Schenectady, N.Y., 170 miles south of the Canadian border. An invite-only organization, Kappa Alpha gave its wealthy members the opportunity to segregate themselves from peers they considered lesser. They then endeavoured to do things the administration did not want them to do – including the pursuit of sex with women. "I did get one of the nicest pieces of ass some day or two ago," wrote one fraternity man to another in 1857. "Fraternities constituted a rebellion against authority," wrote Nicholas Syrett in *The Company He Keeps*, his history of white college fraternities. They openly disobeyed college authorities, asserted a previously disallowed inde-

pendence, and engaged in "forbidden" activities. "[T]he thrill derived," wrote Mr. Syrett, "not just from the activities themselves but also from the fact of their illegality." The idea of an exclusive, decadent, nose-thumbing secret society spread like wildfire. New organizations were formed with regularity. By 1861, there were nearly 300 chapters in the eastern and southern U.S. states, where higher education was gaining ground. College and university presidents were mortified by this development. A survey of these leaders, reported by the president of Amherst College in 1863, found them flabbergasted about how to rid themselves of the infestation. They described fraternities as "injurious," a "plague," and "evil." "They have led to greater unkindness and ill feeling than almost any thing [sic.] else in college," said one. Many presidents vowed to eliminate fraternities but failed. The power of fraternities escalated throughout the next 100 years, but 1984 was a turning point. That year, the U.S. govern-

ment informed its 50 states that federal transportation funding would soon be contingent on raising the legal drinking age from 18 to 21. By 1987, the only place an underage student could reliably get free alcohol was a frat house. The decision by authorities of all kinds to allow fraternities to persist in serving underage drinkers sent a clear message to members: You are allowed to do illegal things. Fraternity brothers also face few consequences for hazing, which is illegal in 44 states and the District of Columbia; for the shocking amount of assault and battery reported on many of their properties; for the illegal drug use and dealing ubiquitous in these organizations; or for the death-defying parties they threw during the height of the COVID-19 pandemic in violation of public health orders. If many fraternities aren't so much a social club as a criminal club, why do colleges and universities treat them with kid gloves? In part, it's because a thriving Greek life is a huge asset. With billions in real estate, fraternities and sororities house a quarter-million students each year. In fun-

nelling money toward partying, fraternities provide students the raucous good time adults promise when they insist college will be "the best time of your life." Because they often operate on private property, fraternities shield their host institutions from some liability. And it's a windfall financially. Party-oriented students are more likely to apply and pay full tuition and Greek-affiliated alumni contribute an outsized portion of donations. These broader networks are also valuable for securing high-status jobs in elite occupations, which also boosts a school's reputation. Every blue moon, after a scandal, there is genuine accountability. But even the truly grotesque controversies have thus far done little to undermine old-line fraternity men's power. We shouldn't expect otherwise. The sense of entitlement so often cultivated by fraternities, and the broader institutional deference to them, is why we both love and hate them. And this latest scandal alleges how brazenly bad the boys really can be.

KONRAD YAKABUSKI will return.

How to maximize small living spaces like an expert



Small spaces are trending in a big way. Statistics Canada’s New Housing Report finds that condominium apartments have become the most prominent dwelling type in Canada. In 2024, 45.1 per cent of completed homes in Canada excluding rentals were condos, according to the report – an increase from 38.6 per cent a decade prior. A smaller physical footprint doesn’t mean you have to skimp on style. But maximizing the impact of each piece you bring into the space requires a thoughtful approach. “The most common mistakes [people make when furnishing a small space] are overcrowding the space, choosing furniture that is too large, neglecting storage and lighting or prioritizing aesthetics at the expense of comfort and ease of movement,” says Gilles Gagnon, general manager, furniture department at Tanguay, a Quebec-based furniture store.

Here are five expert tips for maximizing your living space to its full potential.



Domus Collection
Genuine Leather
Condo Sofa

TIP #1

FIND FURNITURE THAT FITS THE SPACE

This may seem like a no-brainer, but it can be more complicated than you think. A misconception many people have is that bigger furniture means more comfort, which couldn’t be further from the truth.

Let’s say you’re furnishing a smaller dining room space, for example. Emmanuelle Turcotte, a dining room buyer in Tanguay’s furniture division, recommends looking for dining chairs that can be neatly tucked into your table.

“You can have a very comfortable chair without an arm, which is a bit smaller and makes it easier to circulate around the table,” Turcotte says. “That’s the mistake people can make. They buy a bigger chair because they think it will be more comfortable. But the space will look very small that way, especially if [it’s a small table] with a big chair – it will shrink.”

Bulky furniture leaves you less room to move around, making a space less comfortable.

TIP #2

EMBRACE TRANSPARENCY AND VISUAL LIGHTNESS

The colour and material of your furniture are just as important as the size. For small spaces, opting for transparent furniture – made of glass, clear acrylic or with slim metal legs – and light colours can help to create the image of space. “Allow light and sightlines to flow freely throughout the space,”

Gagnon says. “Furniture that can be seen through instantly creates the illusion of a larger room.”

For example, when it comes to your living room couch, Gagnon advises choosing a compact model with narrow armrests and raised legs, which allow light to pass underneath and can create the visual illusion of more floor space. Consider Tanguay’s 5-Piece Dining Room Set that features a glass table and arm-less chairs.



Carol Dining Table

TIP #4

CONSIDER FLOW

When it comes to your living space, you’ll want to take into account the flow of the space and your ability to move through it seamlessly.

“Every inch counts,” Gagnon says. “Furniture placement can easily obstruct main walkways, block the opening of doors, windows or closet doors and hinder access to electrical outlets.”

For dining and living room spaces Turcotte recommends round or circular tables, which help people naturally circulate around the table without blocking off walkways and shrinking the room.



Round Dining Table

TIP #3

DEFINE ZONES – EVEN IF THERE AREN’T TECHNICALLY ANY

Living in a small apartment often means that your living and dining rooms are really one room. Furniture and accessories can be artfully used to create the feeling of separation and distinct zones.

A key tool? A great rug. “If the living room is open to another area,

such as the entryway or kitchen, use a large rug to clearly define the living space,” Gagnon advises.

If you’re looking to separate functions without blocking natural light, the back of a low-profile sofa or a sideboard can also work as a subtle room divider.



Series 8207 Rounded Media Console 63'

TIP #5

GO FOR MULTIPURPOSE PIECES

Anyone who has lived in a small home knows that storage is sparse, meaning your furniture has to work even harder. Gagnon recommends opting for dual-purpose pieces that reduce the overall number of furniture pieces in your space.

“A rectangular or round ottoman placed in the center of the living room or beneath a window can serve as a footrest, an extra seat and a hidden storage solution for blankets, cushions or toys,” Gagnon says.

Your larger pieces can be equally functional, comfortable and

nice to look at. Tanguay’s Nuvola Sectional with Storage and Built-In Bed, for example, acts as both built-in storage and additional sleeping options for overnight guests.

Additional tips and tricks include using nesting tables, which can be easily stacked or extended as needed, or a lift-top coffee table in the living room, which can be raised to a comfortable height for dining or working on a laptop, turning your living room into both a dining room and in-home office.

For Turcotte, these expert tips reinforce that the design quality of a room comes down to styling and strategic decision-making – not size. “[Size] doesn’t affect the look or the quality of the product, or your living space,” she says.



Nuvola Sectional with Storage and Built-In Bed



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Where TIFF’s big-bet market goes from here

Market head Charles Tremblay sits down with The Globe to discuss what the numbers say

BARRY HERTZ
SCREEN TIME

Last month, organizers behind the inaugural edition of the Toronto International Film Festival’s official market proclaimed that the event was a success across the board, with organizers hailing “strong attendance, sold-out sessions and marquee sales.” Yet the numbers behind the market, which gathered buyers and sellers of film, television and interactive content for seven days of hopeful deal-making inside the Metro Toronto Convention Centre (MTCC) – and which was made possible by \$23-million in federal funding – tell a different story. And that’s a story that TIFF’s market head Charles Tremblay wants to clarify. Sitting down with The Globe last week for a wide-ranging interview, Tremblay discussed the highs and lows of the organization’s biggest bet since the 2010 opening of its Lightbox headquarters.

What were the main takeaways you heard from attendees?

Will you allow me to shed light on a few things you said in your article the other week?

Last December, TIFF said it’d provide 650 market screening slots, but the release said just 196 were booked, suggesting a lack of appetite compared with inventory.

The 650 number included the combined press and market screenings that every festival title gets, but the total number got cut down to 450 around March. The reason for that is we had planned on building three theatres inside the MTCC, and those plans were dropped because it was too heavy a lift for our first year, logistically and operationally. So that brought our inventory down. The actual number is 196 paid market screenings, and then 255 press and market screenings for a total around 450. That’s how we get to those numbers, but I get that it requires an explanation.

The other number was market delegates. You said there were 7,010 this year, a 40-per-cent increase compared with TIFF’s ‘informal, previous offering, which typically drew 5,000 people to the city.’ But materials published by TIFF last year noted 6,000 industry delegates at the 2025 festival, making the attendance jump this year just 16 per cent.

What I can say is that ever since I started, we’ve always worked with 5,000. Not to dismiss it, but the number that matters to me



TIFF chief programming officer Anita Lee, from left, TIFF market head Charles Tremblay, TIFF CEO Cameron Bailey, Culture Minister Marc Miller, Telefilm Canada director and CEO Julie Roy and former Toronto mayor and incoming TIFF board chair John Tory attend the ribbon-cutting ceremony for the market on Sept. 12 in Toronto. BRIAN DE RIVERA SIMON/GETTY IMAGES

is 7,000. That’s a very solid number for the first year, and an increase regardless. From an operational point of view, we met our revenue target as far as badge sales go.

Are you confident you’ll get to the previously stated target of 12,000 delegates by 2030?

Hard to say – I think those were projections from way back. It’s conceivable. For me, the important thing for the market is to become what it needs to be for the industry. I know that sounds vague, but it feels like as long as it’s useful for the people who are interested and need it, then we’re good. It’s not growth for the sake of growth. The market could be a very good service to the industry even if it’s 10,000 or 9,500. It needs to be for the Canadian industry first, and then whatever the international industry needs it to be.

In terms of that service, what have you been hearing from Canadians, and the international side, on what they need?

There are two components to market attendance. The core of it is sellers and buyers, who represent about a third of the delegates. The other part, the vast majority, are there for the programming. They attend the market to network, go to talks, et cetera. Those two contingents have quite different objectives. The availability of market screenings and the quality of the venues are of no concern to the vast majority of the people there for the programming. The people mostly there for the programming, the feedback is

overwhelmingly positive. We doubled the number of sessions, 40 to 85. The number of speakers doubled. Attendance almost tripled from around 6,000 to 16,000.

In terms of being a place where business gets done, we only saw two sales of note: Universal paying US\$10-million to acquire River, which was kind of a buy-back situation, and Sony securing key markets for The Surgeon, which we don’t have a number for. Do you have an update on how much other business was sparked from market activity?

I don’t. To be honest, sales agents don’t call us every time they make a sale. You have those big splashy deals that make it into the trade publications, and then smaller things. What I can say is that a lot of sales agents I talked to were surprisingly pleased by the number of good meetings that they had, the number of them and the quality. As for the volume of business, we’re sending out a survey in the next couple of days, and we’ll see how much they’re willing to share. As you know, the American Film Market is upcoming, so some of the discussions started here will maybe close in L.A.

We’re talking a lot about the film side, but this was launched with the intention of being a content market, with a focus on TV and interactive projects, too. But we haven’t heard much about business on that side.

I would say it’s the first year and markets in general are geared toward films. In programming, we had a good chunk of TV

projects. Is there room to grow that sector? I think so. I’m pleased with the immersive hub we had. But yes, I won’t deny the larger part was film. That’s bound to change over the years.

A big reason that this market exists is because of federal money. What kind of return on investment was Ottawa looking for, and do you think that they found it in the inaugural edition?

I believe they did. It was in terms of quality and substance. There wasn’t a set target that they needed in terms of revenue. What they wanted was a content market that would deliver for the Canadian industry and bring the world here. We haven’t had an official review with them, but I’m fairly confident that they would be quite happy. I know Telefilm was thrilled with the activity they had at their stand. And the labs, the IP exchange, the project market, all these programs had majority Canadian participation.

If Ottawa doesn’t renew its investment, which expires in March, can the market be self-sustaining?

The earned revenue component is pretty substantial, but I don’t know of many similar markets that are completely without public funding. It can be successful with probably a lower share of investment. Without any? I think it would be difficult.

This interview has been condensed and edited.

CBC’s new doc on Kenneth Law makes a strong case for a public inquiry

J. KELLY NESTRUCK
TELEVISION

The tragic power of *Romeo and Juliet* comes from the way Shakespeare sequences its final dramatic events. Romeo buys lethal poison from an apothecary while a letter is on the way that would stop him from taking his life. The message’s arrival is delayed just a moment too long to reach him because of an outbreak of pestilence. *The Poison Seller*, a new documentary about the chilling case of Kenneth Law that has its broadcast premiere on CBC’s *The Passionate Eye* on Wednesday night, is powerful for similar reasons. Over the course of its 45-minute running time, the documentary outlines the tragic lost opportunities to have stopped Law, a Canadian former cook whose pandemic pivot was to sell suicide kits and lethal substances online. Public-policy failings and law-enforcement gaps meant that Law allegedly shipped 1,200 packages to 41 countries around the world before he was arrested. The messages that society missed haunt the family members of Stephen Mitchell Jr., a young man who was the last of Law’s 14 victims from Ontario. *The Poison Seller*, written and directed by Rebecca Snow, repeatedly shows a graphic of the timeline leading up to Mitchell’s death – and adds more and more red dots indicating moments at



The son of Latha and Stephen Mitchell Sr., Stephen Mitchell Jr., died by suicide after purchasing poison from Kenneth Law. They appear in CBC’s new documentary *The Poison Seller*. CBC/BLUE ANT STUDIOS

which authorities could have taken action before he died. Much of what happened took place in the open. Globe and Mail reporter Mike Hager interviewed Law over the phone days before his arrest in 2023. “They were very ill and they need some solution to their problem,” Law is heard saying in Hager’s recording of the interview. “I’m just being compassionate.” On-screen text underlines the dissonance in this statement: His 14 Ontario victims were all between the ages of 16 and 36. Hager’s recording is made public for the first time in *The Poison Seller*. It’s all we get to hear from Law himself, who had multiple degrees and, in 2009, was profiled in Canadian Business magazine

for inventing a device called escMode – “escape mode” – that could help wheelchair users leave buildings quickly in an emergency. Later, Law’s escMode domain was used for darker purposes, hosting one of two websites he used to sell poison to those experiencing suicidal ideation. Hager and his reporting are prominently featured in *The Poison Seller*. Instead of a narrator, he and his colleague Colin Freeze tell the facts that form the spine of the story, and testimony from families of the victims fill in the emotional impact of the crimes. Is murder the right word for what Law did? Ethan Mitchell, Stephen’s brother, sits with the question before responding. “I

don’t want to take my brother’s autonomy out of this question,” he says in the documentary. “But to me, Kenneth Law was a monster sitting on pro-suicide forums looking to sell a product to people who were so vulnerable. I can’t see it as anything other than digital mass murder.” The Crown stayed first-degree murder charges against Law when he pleaded guilty to 14 counts of the lesser crime of aiding suicide. “What we see here is a very 21st-century crime trying to be jammed into a 20th-century legal system,” Freeze says in the documentary. “We don’t have laws that can deal with a suspect who is causing mass death globally, through

online internet sales.” The challenges of investigating crime online don’t seem overly daunting in the documentary. Freeze is central to a sequence demonstrating a technique that allegedly connects Law to a username that slipped into direct messages on suicide forums to advertise his deadly wares. *The Poison Seller* doesn’t have time to delve into larger issues of laissez-faire internet policies – and all the forces that push back hard against moves toward regulation, for ideological or profit-seeking reasons. The sister of one man who took his own life notes how the forum where he was encouraged to do so is at the top of certain Google search results. Freeze and Hager continue to follow the story. Late last month, The Globe was in Newmarket, Ont., reporting on victim-impact statements as part of the first phase of Law’s sentencing hearing. The court heard about a 44-year-old British man who died only this January. He had been visited by police in 2023 for a wellness check and told them he had disposed of the substance that Law sold him, but he hadn’t. “Oh, true apothecary, thy drugs are quick,” Romeo says as he takes his dram of poison. Law’s poison, by contrast, is as slow as justice. The case for a public inquiry, which the Mitchell family is calling for, is strong. *The Poison Seller* premieres on CBC TV at 9 p.m. local time on Wednesday as part of *The Passionate Eye*, and is also available to stream now on CBC Gem.

One thousand records and countless memories

FIRST PERSON

I am reminded of everything my brother and I shared, even though our lives were different, writes
Donna Elaine Williams

I inherit a thousand records when my brother dies. The albums aren't left to me per se, rather simply left behind in his garage, a den made cozy in the winter by an overhead propane heater, wallpapered in Kokanee beer cartons and corniced by snapback hats. Industrial shelves held an entertainment centre: an old PC wired to a 1980s-era television where he claimed he watched blockbusters using a foreign IP address; nearby was a turntable on a carpeted shelf above a decaled mini fridge. Two substantial speakers sat sentry on rows of hundreds of albums – his collection beginning as a teen in the 1970s, when albums were coveted and came with liner notes and lyrics, where every song was listened to.

My brother died after the death of his wife. She was the love of his life and when multiple sclerosis took her independence, they agonized over the move to long-term care. Then he was laid off. Lovingly, for the next decade, she became his world. Slowly, unchecked and unnurtured, his own world deteriorated. Their home, even the garage-den, disintegrated into disrepair, neglected as his own health. Still, he'd phone me in his usual jokey-way, "It's your older and much better-looking brother calling."

With his death, his two grown sons made fast work disposing of their childhood home. What remained were the albums. Neither son wanted them and they agreed their dad would want them to go to someone who did.

My own record collection was sold in a garage sale decades ago. Gone were Grace Jones, UB40, Boz Scaggs's *Silk Degrees*. When my parents died, I kept their handful of albums as mementos – Kristofferson and Cash, Jones and Belafonte.

My brother's den-garage is stripped bare when my nephews pack my car with boxes holding the albums. They tell me the spines are facing up so I can easily read the artists. "Be careful when you lift one – the record might slip from its cover." This advice reminds me so much of my brother's voice.

I hug both my nephews and we talk for a bit. I drive home impressed with the industriousness of the boys in the aftershock of losing their dad, and really, both parents so close together. I am al-

It's true, my brother and I were very different. ... But I discover quickly that losing a sibling means losing a person who was with you from the beginning, present in your most innocent and foundational years.



ILLUSTRATION BY DREW SHANNON

so awed at the speed in which my brother's life of overwhelm could be disposed. I unload the boxes onto pallets in my garage and slit one open to count 75 albums. I know Sade and Willie Nelson, but who is Ray Griff? Some mental math: there's a thousand records. How am I ever going to do this justice?

My brother would have a fair bit of advice on what to do with all his records. It feels impossible that I will never speak to him again. His voice was like late-night radio, as calm and articulate as he was funny. His death has hit me harder than I imagined, it's like a piece of me stripped away and gone forever. "But you weren't close," a friend points out.

It's true, my brother and I were very different. We raised our children differently, lived in different circles, had differing values. But I discover quickly that losing a sibling means losing a person who was with you from the beginning, present in your most innocent and foundational years. Who sat across from you for so many family dinners. Every time we had spaghetti, my brother pulled a strand straight from his throat, waiting for the exact moment we had eye contact. "Eew!" but I never failed to look. Just as I never failed to be impressed with his feats, like the time he was ticketed for speeding on his 10-speed bike, or making wine in his closet from a can of orange-juice concentrate. As adults we loved to reminisce about our childhood, especially times at our grandpar-

ents' in small-town Alberta. As many recollections as I had, he had more. Losing him meant losing all his memories, too.

I look through old family albums and am reminded how much he was loved, and in that, how much I was loved, too, and I need to know this. It helps me accept that his later life was his (un)doing, his nature versus our nurture. When his birthday comes around, I take my family out for ribs, my brother's favourite, and we share Uncle Glyn stories, retell his horse-walked-into-a-bar jokes, remember how he loved becoming a grandpa. As much as my brother and I were different, we're the same, too. What we find funny, how we can talk to anyone, how we made our mom's tomato soup exactly the same way.

We also procrastinate, so I'm determined to unbox those LPs, play them, share them with my kids and friends. I don't know what surprises I'll find, but I'll listen and envision him in the Golden Days of the den-garage, leaning back in an office chair no doubt with a broken spring, sipping something smoky, his music etching the night. I doubt I'll move my car out and an old recliner in to listen the way he did, but you never know.

Donna Elaine Williams lives in Calgary.

First Person is a daily personal piece submitted by readers. Have a story to tell? See our guidelines at [tgam.ca/essayguide](https://www.theglobeandmail.com/first-person).

TODAY'S SUDOKU SOLUTION

4	7	9	2	8	1	6	3	5
8	1	2	5	6	3	9	7	4
3	5	6	4	9	7	8	2	1
1	8	3	7	2	4	5	9	6
5	9	4	3	1	6	2	8	7
6	2	7	9	5	8	4	1	3
2	6	1	8	7	5	3	4	9
7	3	8	6	4	9	1	5	2
9	4	5	1	3	2	7	6	8

TODAY'S KENKEN SOLUTION

5-	11+	6	5	12x	3	4	2
1	6	5	3	4	2		
6	2	4	5	3	1		
5	4	6	1	2	3		
6x	2	3	1	6	5	4	
7+	4	1	3	2	6	5	
3-	3	5	2	4	1	6	

WORLD FORECAST

	TODAY	TOMORROW	SATURDAY
AMSTERDAM	16/10 SH	17/12 SH	15/10 SH
ATHENS	25/18 S	25/19 S	26/19 T
BANGKOK	32/25 T	32/26 T	31/25 T
BEIJING	26/15 S	26/16 S	27/16 S
BERLIN	18/9 SH	14/10 PC	16/8 R
BRUSSELS	14/8 SH	15/10 SH	15/8 S
COPENHAGEN	14/10 R	13/11 C	15/10 SH
FRANKFURT	15/5 R	12/9 PC	12/7 SH
HONG KONG	27/25 PC	28/25 S	28/25 S
JERUSALEM	26/16 S	26/17 S	27/18 S
LAS VEGAS	36/24 S	36/23 S	32/21 S
LONDON	14/11 S	18/10 SH	15/9 SH
LOS ANGELES	34/21 S	31/20 S	29/22 PC
MADRID	21/8 S	20/10 S	21/12 S
MIAMI	31/25 T	32/26 T	31/27 T
MOSCOW	14/8 PC	17/9 C	12/7 C
NEW DELHI	34/26 SH	32/23 SH	33/22 T
NEW YORK	24/11 S	21/9 S	19/13 PC
NICE	25/15 SH	22/16 S	23/16 S
ORLANDO	27/23 T	29/24 T	30/25 T
PARIS	15/9 S	15/13 C	17/11 PC
PHOENIX	39/28 S	39/28 S	34/24 PC
ROME	25/17 T	21/13 SH	22/13 SH
SAN FRANCISCO	18/15 S	18/14 S	17/12 S
SEOUL	24/14 S	25/15 PC	26/17 S
SINGAPORE	31/25 T	31/25 SH	29/25 SH
SYDNEY	20/12 SH	19/16 S	30/18 SH
TOKYO	23/16 S	24/16 S	24/18 S
WASHINGTON	25/13 S	23/13 S	23/16 PC

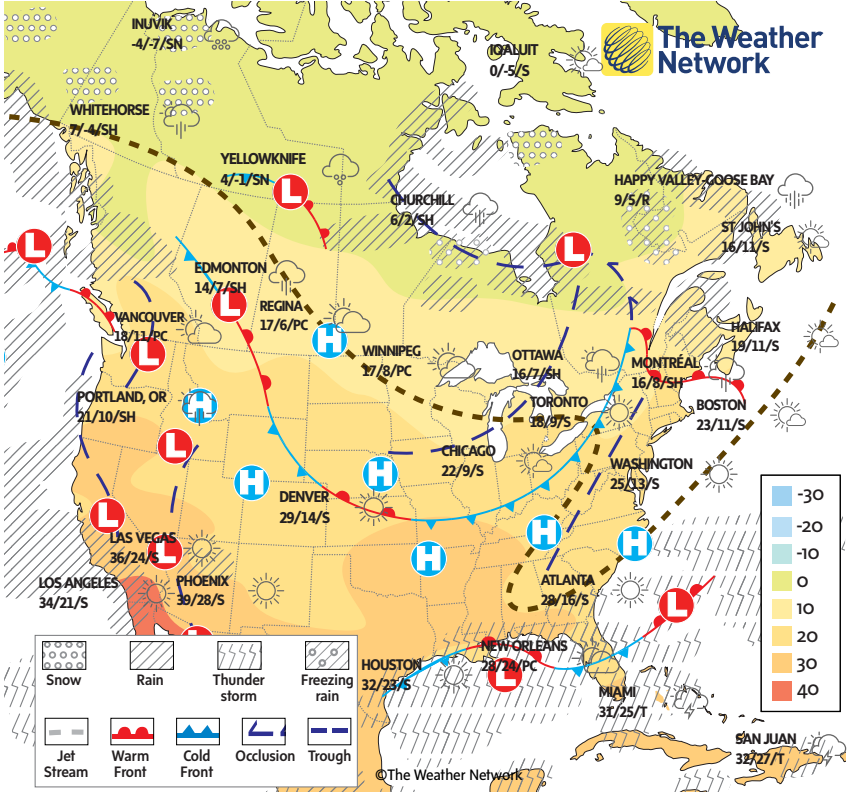
LEGEND

Daytime high, overnight low, and conditions

C CLOUDY	RS RAIN/SNOW
FG FOG	S SUN
FR FREEZING RAIN	SN SNOW
HZ HAZE	SF SNOW FLURRIES
NA NOT AVAILABLE	SH SHOWERS
PC PARTLY CLOUDY	T THUNDERSTORMS
R RAIN	W WINDY

NATIONAL FORECAST

	TODAY	TOMORROW	SATURDAY
BANFF	18/4 PC	14/0 SH	1/5 SN
BARRIE	14/7 SH	14/7 S	19/12 PC
BRANDON	15/5 PC	17/8 PC	15/5 PC
CALGARY	18/7 S	20/0 PC	2/4 SN
CHARLOTTETOWN	19/11 SH	16/7 S	10/5 PC
CHICOUTIMI	12/5 R	9/2 SH	9/4 PC
CHURCHILL	6/2 SH	5/2 SH	5/2 SH
CORNER BROOK	15/11 PC	14/7 SH	9/5 R
CORNWALL	16/7 SH	14/4 SH	15/11 S
EDMONTON	13/7 SH	11/1 R	3/2 SN
HALIFAX	19/11 S	18/8 SH	14/5 S
HAMILTON	18/6 S	17/6 S	20/15 S
HUNTSVILLE	15/5 SH	12/2 S	16/11 SH
ICALLUIT	0/5 S	1/6 PC	-1/5 PC
JASPER	17/5 R	11/-1 R	1/5 SN
KELOWNA	21/9 S	16/7 SH	9/1 R
KINGSTON	17/10 S	15/7 S	16/15 S
LONDON	18/5 S	18/7 S	20/15 S
MONTREAL	16/8 SH	14/5 S	14/10 S
NIAGARA FALLS	18/8 SH	17/8 S	20/16 S
NORTH BAY	13/4 PC	10/1 SH	14/12 PC
OTTAWA	16/7 SH	14/3 PC	15/9 S
PRINCE GEORGE	12/6 R	8/1 R	8/4 S
PETERBOROUGH	17/7 S	15/5 S	17/13 S
QUÉBEC	17/6 PC	12/2 SH	12/4 SH
REGINA	15/7 PC	20/7 SH	11/1 SH
SASKATOON	16/7 C	17/1 SH	3/1 RS
SAULT STE MARIE	15/7 SH	13/7 PC	20/16 SH
SAINT JOHN	16/9 R	16/6 S	13/5 S
SEPTÎLES	9/7 R	10/5 SH	10/4 S
ST JOHN'S	16/11 S	18/10 SH	13/6 SH
SUBURBY	15/3 S	12/0 PC	16/13 SH
THUNDER BAY	15/1 S	15/10 PC	24/16 PC
THOMPSON	7/2 PC	6/0 PC	2/0 SN
TORONTO	18/9 S	18/9 S	20/16 PC
VAL-D'OR	10/2 R	7/0 PC	12/8 C
VANCOUVER	18/11 PC	14/9 SH	16/7 PC
VICTORIA	18/11 PC	15/9 SH	14/10 SH
WHISTLER	20/9 PC	11/3 R	10/0 PC
WHITEHORSE	7/4 SH	5/3 S	8/0 S
WINNIPEG	17/6 PC	18/12 C	23/8 PC
YELLOWKNIFE	4/-1 SN	3/3 RS	3/1 PC



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More Songs. More Laughs.
More Dates!



MEMBERS OF THE COMPANY, GUYS AND DOLLS. PHOTO: DAVID HOU.

GUYS
AND DOLLS

★★★★
(out of 4)

“A jackpot
winner”

Toronto Star

CRITIC’S PICK
“A masterpiece”

The Globe and Mail

“A show you
can see again
and again!”

BroadwayWorld

SOMETHING
ROTTEN!

★★★★
(out of 4)

“A big-hit
musical”

Toronto Star

“Wildly funny”

Postmedia

CRITIC’S PICK
“Mind-blowing”

The Globe and Mail

STRATFORD
FESTIVAL

THE TEMPEST | GUYS AND DOLLS | SOMETHING ROTTEN! | DEATH OF A SALESMAN | THE HOBBIT
THE IMPORTANCE OF BEING EARNEST | SATURDAY, SUNDAY, MONDAY

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REPORT ON BUSINESS

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Cleveland-Cliffs boss dismisses idea of nationalizing Stelco

Lourenco Goncalves says Ottawa should pursue a ‘Fortress North America’ trade deal with U.S.

NIALL MCGEE
MINING REPORTER
TORONTO

Cleveland-Cliffs Inc. chief executive Lourenco Goncalves is dismissing the idea of nationalizing Stelco and firing back at what he calls a “walking eagle” Canadian steel customer.

The U.S. steelmaker said last week it was planning to lay off as many as 500 steel workers at Stelco in Hamilton and Nanticoke, Ont., in large part because it can’t compete anymore in galvanized steel as a result of the trade war.

When the federal government approved Cliffs’s \$3.4-billion acquisition of Stelco Holdings Inc. in 2024, it imposed a series of

legally binding conditions, including maintaining at least the same number of unionized employees in Canada for five years, as well as the vast majority of non-unionized workers.

By announcing hundreds of layoffs in Canada, Ottawa alleges Cliffs is now in violation of that agreement.

On Monday, Industry Minister Mélanie Joly issued the Cleveland-based steelmaker an ultimatum to map out a plan within five business days for complying with its job guarantees under the Investment Canada Act or possibly face legal action.

But while Ottawa is pushing Cliffs to preserve those jobs in Canada, some have suggested the government could instead take over Stelco and save them.

Nicolas Lamp, an associate professor at

the Faculty of Law at Queen’s University, said in a recent editorial in The Globe and Mail that if Ottawa decides the steel industry is of strategic importance, and Stelco workers have indeed been “betrayed” by Cliffs, it could instead “nationalize the company and put Canadian management in charge.”

In an interview Wednesday, Mr. Goncalves poured cold water on the idea, pointing to the example of Venezuelan president Hugo Chávez nationalizing steel company Siderúrgica del Orinoco (SIDOR) in 2008. The takeover was widely seen as an economic disaster, with production plummeting in the aftermath.

“Is that what Canada really wants to do?” he said.

■ STELCO, B6

Weston family to purchase British retail chain Boots for \$8.9-billion

ANDREW WILLIS
SUSAN KRASHINSKY ROBERTSON

The Weston family is returning to British retailing by acquiring drug-store chain Boots for US\$8.9-billion, including assumed debt, with financial backing from Fairfax Financial Holdings Ltd.

The Toronto-based Weston family’s holding company, Wittington Investments Ltd., is buying the 1,800-store Boots chain from U.S. private equity fund Sycamore Partners, which acquired the British business as part of a US\$24-billion leveraged buyout of U.S. drug-store company Walgreens in 2025.

Wittington, which controls Shoppers Drug Mart, is also buying out another billionaire family, headed by former Boots chair Stefano Pessina, who acquired the chain in 2007. Mr. Pessina had retained an ownership stake when he sold the majority of the company to Sycamore.

Toronto-based asset manager Fairfax, led by value investor Prem Watsa, is backing Wittington’s investment by paying US\$2.3-billion for a 50-per-cent stake in Boots. Wittington will have operating control of the chain.

Galen Weston, chairman of Wittington and Loblaw, as well as chief executive officer of holding company George Weston Ltd., will become the chair of Boots after the acquisition closes.

In the United Kingdom, Boots is the market leader in pharmacies, with 51,000 employees, a strong brand and stores located close to 80 per cent of the population.

■ WESTON, B6

[ECONOMY]



The Globe set out to price a traditional, yet cost-conscious, dinner for six people at Loblaws, No Frills, Walmart and Real Canadian Superstore locations in midtown Toronto. FRED LUM/THE GLOBEANDMAIL

TALKING TURKEY

Should you shop around for a gobbler and sides?
We tested some old advice on a Thanksgiving feast ■ B3

Is bigger always better? The hazy strategy behind Emera’s tie-up with ATCO

TIM KILADZE
MATTHEW MCCLEARN
ANALYSIS

At the heart of the big Canadian merger between power companies Emera Inc. and Canadian Utilities Ltd., there is a simple question: Is bigger actually better?

So far, the answer’s pretty murky.

When the two companies announced the \$14.3-billion all-share marriage on Tuesday, their leaders justified it by wrapping themselves in the Canadian flag. Bringing two industry champions together was the right thing for the country, they said, because their merger would enable growth.

What exactly they meant by that wasn’t quite clear.

One argument is that, on their own, neither is large enough to pay for the massive infrastructure investments utilities face in the years ahead. If they combine, their cost of capital could fall, helping them compete with rivals like pension funds. The combined companies would have an enterprise value – their debt plus equity – of \$72-billion and would create one of the 20 largest

utilities in North America.

At the same time, U.S. companies are getting bigger by merging. If Halifax-based Emera and Calgary-based CU are left standing all alone, they might be minnows in a hyper-concentrated industry.

U.S. power mergers, though, are starting to face political backlash, which means they might not get approved, or major concessions might be needed to get the green light. And Emera and CU largely operate in very different places – Florida and Alberta. Merging will diversify their revenue mix, but there is little to no overlap between their operations, so they can’t learn all that much from one another or share resources.

Their geographies also complicate cost savings, something both companies were up front about. “Combinations like this really aren’t about synergies,” Emera chief executive Scott Balfour said on a conference call Tuesday.

What, then, should investors be excited about? Shareholders seem to be asking the same thing. Emera’s shares are down 4.3 per cent since the deal was announced, while CU’s are down 2.6 per cent. Not exactly panic, but no one is particularly enthused.

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Canada at risk of missing its emissions goals, climate report says

JOY SPEARCHIEF-MORRIS

Less-stringent climate policy and a push to develop carbon-intensive major projects could put Canada’s greenhouse-gas targets further out of reach, according to a co-author of a new report on the country’s emissions.

Canada emitted around 691 megatonnes of carbon-dioxide equivalent in 2025, about 1 per cent more than 2024 levels, according to the 440 Megatonnes project report conducted by the Canadian Climate Institute, a non-partisan climate change policy research organization.

With climate policy changes at federal and provincial levels and Ottawa’s focus on major infrastructure development to bolster the economy to deal with the U.S. trade war, Canada will need to take more direct action to achieve its goal of net-zero emissions by 2050.

“There’s no question at the federal and the provincial level, governments have backtracked on climate policies, and we expect that to lead to higher emissions. The government has acknowledged that openly,” said Ross Linden-Fraser, acting director of the 440 Megatonnes project at the Climate Institute.

Canada’s 2025 carbon emission levels were about 9.5 per cent below the 2005 baseline levels, and are well short of the goal of a 40- to 45-per-cent reduction target for 2030, a gap of about 200 megatonnes, according to the estimates in the early emissions report released on Thursday.

■ REPORT, B5

Investment regulator warns of added risks

Investors may encounter lower trading volumes, wider gaps between buying and selling, greater price volatility, CIRO notice says

MEERA RAMAN

As Canadian stock trading opens up beyond the traditional 6½-hour day, the country's investment regulator is warning investors that buying and selling stocks outside regular market hours can come with additional risks.

The Canadian Investment Regulatory Organization, or CIRO, issued guidance Thursday for investment dealers on extended-hours trading, and a notice for

investors that they may encounter lower trading volumes, wider gaps between buying and selling prices, and greater price volatility outside regular hours. CIRO is a self-regulatory organization that oversees all investment dealers and mutual fund dealers.

The guidance comes shortly after CIX Trading Inc. launched a new Canadian trading platform that allows investors to buy and sell domestic stocks from 8 a.m. to 5 p.m. ET. CIX plans to expand those hours to 7 a.m. to 8 p.m. ET later this year and eventually offer trading 23 hours a day from Monday to Friday. Stocks currently trade on Canadian exchanges between 9:30 a.m. and 4 p.m. ET each weekday.

Kevin McCoy, senior vice-president of market regulation at CIRO, said he expects uptake in the early days of extended-hours

trading to be “quite muted,” but that it could become more mainstream.

During regular trading hours, all Canadian equity marketplaces are open at the same time. Outside those hours, fewer marketplaces and investors may be active, meaning there can be fewer buyers and sellers for a particular security, Mr. McCoy said.

That can reduce liquidity and widen the bid-ask spread, the difference between the highest price a buyer is willing to pay and the lowest price a seller is willing to accept. Mr. McCoy said that investors may receive a less favourable price than they would during regular trading hours.

Investors may also see bigger price swings during extended hours, especially during company earnings, economic reports or breaking-news events when fewer

investors are trading.

Investors using market orders during extended-trading hours, which generally execute at the best price available at the time the order reaches the market, may also encounter issues. Mr. McCoy said they could end up with a price that they didn't want because of the wider bid-ask spread.

Mr. McCoy said that instead of a market order, investors trading in extended hours could use limit orders, which allow them to specify the maximum or minimum price at which they are willing to buy or sell. While the trade may not be completed if that price is unavailable, the order gives investors more control over the price at which their trade is executed, he said.

Extended-hours trading may not make sense for every investor, Mr. McCoy said. Longer-term

investors, for example, may have less reason to react immediately to developments outside regular trading hours, while other investors may value the flexibility to trade following an earnings announcement or other market-moving events.

The introduction of longer trading hours does not come with a separate regulatory regime, Mr. McCoy said. Investment dealers will be subject to the same CIRO rules, marketplace rules and securities laws during extended-trading sessions as they do during regular trading hours.

The push toward longer trading hours is not limited to Canada. The London Stock Exchange Group announced in July that it plans to launch LSE 24, which would eventually allow near-continuous trading of London-listed securities from Monday to Friday.



Wars in Iran and Ukraine have damaged refineries such as the Total Energies Dongs oil refinery, pictured here in western France in 2023. This has turned fuel into a major political and economic concern worldwide. LOIC VENANCE/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

IEA agree to accelerate strategic reserve release totalling about 100 million barrels

KATE ABNETT
HOLGER HANSEN BRUSSELS

The International Energy Agency agreed on Wednesday to accelerate the release of oil stocks and to prioritize diesel supplies under a plan launched in March, as governments seek to tackle record fuel prices and supply disruptions caused by the Iran war.

Wars in Iran and Ukraine have damaged refineries and disrupted tanker traffic, helping drive diesel prices to record highs in many markets and turning the fuel into a major political and economic concern worldwide.

The IEA said completing previously announced releases as quickly as possible could bring around 100 million barrels to market, although analysts and some governments said the figure did not necessarily represent a fresh intervention of that size.

The statement from the IEA, which

advises industrialized countries, followed an agreement by G7 countries on Friday to release 100 million barrels of crude and diesel, which raised expectations of additional oil stock releases. The G7 move came after President Donald Trump warned he might ban U.S. diesel exports if they did not put more of the fuel into the market.

The IEA, which co-ordinates emergency oil stockpiles among industrialized countries, launched a 400-million-barrel release program in March to counter shortages and rising prices caused by the Iran war, although not all of those volumes have yet reached the market.

“Member governments expressed support for accelerating the oil stock releases announced in the Collective Action of March 2026 with a view to completing them as soon as possible,” IEA executive director Fatih Birol said in the statement.

“IEA members also supported the prioritization of the release of diesel stocks, to the extent possible, given the current

tightness in diesel markets.”

The IEA said about 100 million barrels pledged under the March initiative have yet to reach the market.

The IEA did not specify how much diesel and how much crude oil will be released.

In reaction to the IEA comment, the European Union member states agreed the planned oil releases must be done within the amount approved in March, a spokesperson for the European Commission said on Wednesday. IEA members are scheduled to assess and review the plans at a board meeting next week, the statement said. The G7 includes EU members France, Germany and Italy along with the US, U.K., Japan and Canada.

Before the IEA statement, JPMorgan analysts said Friday's announcement appeared largely to accelerate deliveries already pledged under the March program rather than signal a fresh intervention.

REUTERS

Lululemon overhauls leadership team with two new roles

SUSAN KRASHINSKY ROBERTSON
RETAILING REPORTER

One month into her new job as chief executive at Lululemon Athletica Inc., Heidi O'Neill has begun an overhaul of the leadership ranks, as she seeks to turn around the struggling activewear retailer.

The Vancouver-based company announced a new structure for its leadership team on Wednesday, with the creation of two new roles – a president and chief product officer, and a chief operating officer – as well as two high-profile departures.

Ms. O'Neill joined Lululemon on Sept. 8, after more than two decades in leadership positions with Nike Inc. She has been tasked with revitalizing a brand that helped to build a lucrative industry for fashionable workout clothes, but now faces stiff competition from newer, hotter athleisure brands, as well as cheaper “dupes” offering similar styles.

The new president and chief product officer, Maggie Gauger, was most recently president and CEO of Athleta, a Gap Inc.-owned athleisure brand that is among Lululemon's competitors.

The company's news release touted Ms. Gauger's advancement of Athleta's “transformation strategy,” which included introducing new products and reshaping the brand. But Athleta has also been struggling, with comparable sales declining

consistently for the past year-and-a-half.

Before that, Ms. Gauger also spent more than two decades at Nike, including leading its women's business in North America.

The new chief operating officer, Joseph Godsey, comes to Lululemon from Walmart Canada, where he was chief growth officer and led the company's e-commerce business. Prior to that, Mr. Godsey held leadership positions at Sam's Club and Adidas AG.

Both executives will join the company on Oct. 26.

At the same time, Lululemon announced the departures of chief brand and product activation officer Nikki Neuburger, and chief supply chain officer Ted Dagnese.

The company is seeking to hire for three additional leadership roles: a chief brand officer to replace Ms. Neuburger, a chief communications officer and a chief technology officer.

Chief financial officer Meghan Frank will take on expanded responsibilities overseeing brand and technology roles until the new hires are found.

“Lululemon is a rare, extraordinary brand, but we have work to do to build a stronger and more competitive company,” Ms. O'Neill wrote in Wednesday's press release.

Lululemon has been struggling as North American customers, its largest market,

have been wooed away to other brands. Last month, the company lowered its forecasts for the second time in just three months, after reporting its second-quarter revenue fell by 5 per cent on a constant-currency basis to US\$2.4-billion.

The company has been working to bring new products to its stores faster, to better keep pace with trendier rivals, and to revive its brand in the minds of shoppers who grew tired of its offerings.

To bolster that effort, Lululemon has been ramping up spending on advertising and community events, while also finding ways to cut costs in the business.

The new leadership team will “work in a more coordinated manner” around its turnaround strategy, Ms. O'Neill wrote in Wednesday's release.

“That starts with putting product, design, and innovation at the center of how we operate, with the focus and accountability to create a stronger pipeline of differentiated product to raise the bar for our guests across every touchpoint, in stores and online.”

Lululemon's stock price has declined more than 50 per cent year to date.

Investors' enthusiasm is unlikely to improve “until more clarity is achieved on the strategy” of the new CEO, as well as how soon that strategy will yield “tangible results,” William Blair analyst Sharon Zackfia wrote in a research note on Wednesday.

Michigan's Mike Rogers calls for end to U.S.-Canada tariff fight

NATHAN LAYNE

Michigan Republican Mike Rogers, locked in one of the nation's most competitive Senate races, called on Wednesday for an end to the U.S.-Canada tariff dispute, breaking with President Donald Trump on a second major issue ahead of next month's election.

Mr. Rogers, who has largely backed Mr. Trump's tariffs, including those on Canada, said in an ad posted on X that the trade fight with Michigan's northern neighbor should end immediately to ease costs for businesses and consumers.

“Here in Michigan, we know that Canada is not our enemy,” Mr. Rogers says in the ad, seated at a neighbourhood bar with his hand wrapped around a bottle of Labatt Blue, a Canadian beer brand popular in Michigan, as he underscores the state's close ties to Canada.

“We need to end this tariff war now.”

Mr. Rogers, who is running neck-and-neck with Democrat Abdul El-Sayed in public polling, reiterated an argument that he could leverage his ties to Mr. Trump to resolve the dispute. “As Michigan Senator, I'll bring both parties together to lower your prices. That's job number one,” Mr. Rogers said in the ad.

The current dispute dates to July, when Mr. Trump unveiled new tariffs on Canadian imports that took effect the following month, prompting retaliatory measures from Canada. The issue is especially sensitive in Michigan, where automakers depend on integrated cross-border supply chains and industry leaders have warned that a prolonged trade war could threaten jobs.

Republican candidates in northern border states hit hardest by the tariffs, including Mr. Rogers, have sought to balance appeals to Mr. Trump's loyal base with efforts to win over independent voters, who polls show have grown increasingly critical of his handling of the economy and trade relations with Canada.

As recently as last month, Mr. Rogers had praised Mr. Trump's tariffs as part of the President's America First agenda, calling them “necessary” while cautioning that they were “not a one-size-fits-all solution.”

In response, Mr. El-Sayed said Mr. Rogers' shift on tariffs reflected concern about his standing in the race, which the nonpartisan election forecaster Cook Political Report rates a “toss-up.”

“You cheered this tariff war from the beginning and you're flip-flopping now because your poll numbers are in free fall,” Mr. El-Sayed said in a statement.

The call for an immediate end to the tariffs came just two weeks after Mr. Rogers similarly reversed course on the war with Iran, which he had previously supported, urging an immediate end to the conflict as a way to lower gasoline and grocery prices.

The shifts reflect growing concerns among Republicans ahead of the November midterms, which will determine whether the party can hold onto its narrow House and Senate majorities.

REUTERS

‘Shop around and save’ theory put to the test for Thanksgiving

Is it possible to make your special dinner for less than \$40? It depends on exactly what you’re making

BIANCA THOMPSON

Global food prices reached their highest level in nearly four years last month, bad news for Canadians headed into holiday entertaining. Large gatherings such as Thanksgiving and Christmas can add another layer of pressure for households trying to keep grocery costs down.

A study from Dalhousie University’s Agri-Food Analytics Lab found that a Thanksgiving dinner for four will cost \$35.72 this year, up 10 per cent from \$32.48 in 2025. But that estimate included a seven-pound turkey and basic side dishes, only factoring in the cost of potatoes, carrots, stuffing, gravy, cranberries, dinner rolls and a pumpkin pie.

So what’s the cost of a more typical spread? The Globe set out to price a traditional, yet cost-conscious, dinner for six people at Loblaws, No Frills, Walmart and Real Canadian Superstore in mid-town Toronto.

For this experiment, the goal was to get a sense of what it costs to put Thanksgiving dinner on the table for six, with a larger turkey, familiar sides and a couple of desserts, while testing whether shopping around to save is worth the extra effort.

These stores were selected based on proximity and price, with Loblaws, No Frills and Walmart being the closest options, and Real Canadian Superstore added as another major grocer expected to offer competitive deals. Other brands were considered, but were noticeably more expensive. (All shopping was completed by Oct. 5. Prices may vary as Thanksgiving approaches and grocery stores adjust promotions and availability.)

The basket included a 16-pound (seven-to-nine kilogram) turkey, potatoes, green beans, carrots, corn on the cob, stuffing, cranberry sauce, gravy, dinner rolls, butter, milk, onions, garlic, rosemary, thyme, an apple pie, a pumpkin pie, Cool Whip and vanilla ice cream.

Households making dishes from scratch, serving alcohol or planning a more elaborate spread could see different totals.

Adam Chapman, a certified financial planner at Yes Money in London, Ont., recommends making a grocery list and estimating the total before heading to the store, so shoppers have a sense of what they are about to spend and aren’t surprised at the checkout.

He says the goal isn’t to be overly frugal during a special occasion but to decide what is worth spending more on.

“Pick that one thing that really matters, splurge on that, and then if you’re trying to cut back, cut back on everything else that’s maybe a little bit less important to the experience.”

THE TURKEY CAN MAKE OR BREAK THE BUDGET

After comparing all four stores, No Frills had the cheapest one-stop cart at \$105.20 before tax. The same basket came to \$124.15 at Loblaws, \$131.09 at Walmart and \$133.93 at Real Canadian Superstore, a difference of \$28.73 between the cheapest and most expensive options.

This gap ultimately came down to the cost of the bird.

A seven-to-nine kilogram frozen turkey cost \$30 at No Frills



A study from Dalhousie University’s Agri-Food Analytics Lab found that a Thanksgiving dinner for four will cost \$35.72 this year, up 10 per cent from \$32.48 in 2025. CHRIS YOUNG/THE CANADIAN PRESS

Thanksgiving grocery cart cost comparison

Winner(s) in each food category				
INGREDIENT	NO FRILLS	LOBLAWS	WALMART	REAL CANADIAN SUPERSTORE
Turkey	\$30.00	\$32.05	\$57.00	\$53.00
Potatoes	\$1.99	\$6.00	\$5.94	\$6.00
Fresh green beans	\$7.98	\$7.98	\$5.90	\$8.98
Carrots	\$3.99	\$3.00	\$4.88	\$6.00
Corn	\$5.00	\$5.00	\$0.94	\$5.00
Stuffing	\$6.49	\$6.99	\$6.96	\$6.99
Cranberry sauce	\$3.00	\$6.00	\$3.14	\$3.00
Gravy	\$2.37	\$3.00	\$2.37	\$3.87
Dinner rolls	\$2.00	\$4.00	\$3.97	\$2.00
Butter	\$6.00	\$5.99	\$4.97	\$4.97
Milk	\$3.65	\$3.64	\$3.64	\$3.64
Fresh thyme	\$2.50	\$3.00	\$3.08	\$2.50
Fresh rosemary	\$2.50	\$3.00	\$3.08	\$2.50
Onions	\$3.49	\$3.00	\$3.94	\$3.00
Garlic	\$0.99	\$1.00	\$0.98	\$1.00
Apple pie	\$7.00	\$11.00	\$5.94	\$6.00
Pumpkin pie	\$7.00	\$11.00	\$5.94	\$6.00
Cool Whip	\$4.75	\$4.50	\$5.48	\$4.99
Vanilla ice cream	\$4.50	\$4.00	\$2.94	\$4.49
Total	\$105.20	\$124.15	\$131.09	\$133.93

THE GLOBE AND MAIL

and \$32.05 at Loblaws. A similarly sized turkey was \$53 at Real Canadian Superstore and \$57 at Walmart.

Choosing the cheapest turkey alone could save as much as \$27. Sides varied too, with a 10-pound bag of yellow potatoes costing \$1.99 at No Frills, versus \$5.94 at Walmart and \$6 at both Loblaws and Real Canadian Superstore.

“There’s a cost to effort. ... If that includes shopping all over the place, you’re almost kind of ruining your own experience of Thanksgiving because you’re so exhausted by the time you get to the meal.”

ADAM CHAPMAN
CERTIFIED FINANCIAL PLANNER
AT YES MONEY

IS CHASING EVERY SALE WORTH THE EXTRA EFFORT?

The Globe picked the cheapest version of each item across the four stores to build a “deal-hunter” basket and determine whether shopping around was actually worth it.

For items sold by weight, the same amount was compared at each store. For example, two pounds of green beans cost about

\$5.90 at Walmart, compared with \$7.98 at No Frills. Walmart’s corn was also cheaper, with a four-pack of corn on the cob costing just 94 cents, compared with \$5 at No Frills.

The final deal-hunter basket came to \$92.60 before tax, \$12.60 less than buying everything at No Frills, the cheapest one-stop shop.

Compared with Loblaws, the savings grew to \$31.55. Compared with Walmart, they grew to \$38.49 and more than \$40 compared with Real Canadian Superstore. But getting the lowest bill comes with a trade-off: time.

“There’s a cost to effort,” Mr. Chapman said. “If that includes shopping all over the place, you’re almost kind of ruining your own experience of Thanksgiving because you’re so exhausted by the time you get to the meal.”

On a Sunday morning in mid-town Toronto, hitting several stores added up to more than 40 minutes of driving before factoring in time for parking, shopping and lineups. There are also costs for gas, transit or Uber to consider.

For anyone trying to keep holiday spending down, Chapman suggests hosting a potluck. The host can provide a main dish, while guests bring sides, desserts or drinks.

The best deal, he suggests, is not always the cheapest but the one that saves money without costing excess time or energy.

Special to The Globe and Mail

U.S. Fed officials expect another rate hike this year, minutes show

CHRISTOPHER RUGABER WASHINGTON

Most U.S. Federal Reserve officials expect that another interest-rate increase will likely be needed this year to combat inflation, according to minutes released Wednesday from the central bank’s most recent meeting.

The officials unanimously agreed that inflation was still elevated and had not made much progress toward their 2-per-cent target in recent months, the minutes said. The Fed increased its key interest rate at the Sept. 15-16 meeting by a quarter-point to about 3.9 per cent, its first increase in three years.

The increase defied U.S. President Donald Trump’s repeated calls for the Fed to cut rates and prompted the President to criticize the Fed’s rate-setting committee, though he still expressed support for chairman Kevin Warsh, whom he appointed earlier this year. The rate increase comes as Americans are already struggling with high costs for groceries, gas and housing, and as affordability has taken on a leading role in the upcoming midterm elections, just seven weeks away.

Longer-term interest rates for mortgages and other borrowing have also jumped in the past few months for a range of reasons, including rising government debt, heavy borrowing by tech firms to finance data-centre construction, climbing oil and gas prices, and signs that growth and inflation remain elevated. The Fed’s rate hike has likely played only a limited role in the increase.

Still, key policy makers have said since the meeting that the Fed can take some time to monitor the economy and the impact of last month’s rate hike before making another move. Wall Street investors now forecast the Fed will keep its rate unchanged at its next meeting on Oct. 28-29, according to futures pricing, and raise it when they meet in December.

Philip Jefferson, vice-chair of the Fed’s board of governors, said last week that policy makers “will need to come to our own judgment, which may take more time.”

Inflation, according to the Fed’s preferred measure, came in lower than many economists expected in August but remained elevated. Overall prices rose 3.4 per cent compared with a year earlier, while core prices – which exclude volatile food and energy categories – increased 3 per cent.

On a monthly basis, prices rose 0.3 per cent from July to August, and core prices just 0.2 per cent. According to the minutes, even with the rise in longer-term rates, many officials said that financial conditions – which includes rising stock prices – “appeared to be supportive of economic growth,” a sign that more rate hikes may be needed to cool the economy.

Several policy makers said that they saw the Fed’s rate as too low to restrain the economy, or only acting as a mild restraint. That suggests they would support multiple rate hikes to rein in inflation. Higher oil and gas prices stemming from the Iran war and the lingering effects of tariffs have lifted costs in recent months. But even excluding those trends, many Fed officials believe inflation is stuck between 2.5 per cent and 3 per cent, above its target. Spiking prices for semi-conductors, computer equipment, and electrical components owing to the rapid surge in data-centre construction have also played a big role in accelerating inflation.

The Fed lifted its key interest rate to about 3.9 per cent at its Sept. 15-16 meeting, its first increase in three years. Higher rates are intended to slow borrowing and spending, cool the economy and bring down inflation.

Mr. Warsh emphasized after the announcement that the economy has shown signs of gathering speed since the central bank decided to keep rates unchanged in late July. “The plain fact is that inflation is too high and has been for too long,” Mr. Warsh said at a news conference after last month’s meeting. “We must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective clearly and at sufficient speed. Today the FOMC decided that this standard has not been satisfied,” he added, referring to the policy-setting Federal Open Market Committee, an arm of the Fed.

Mr. Trump criticized the committee for voting to raise rates, calling them “very political,” but he did not single out Mr. Warsh.

“They’re raising rates to make Trump do as bad as they can possibly do,” the President said.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



Wall Street investors now forecast the Fed will keep its rate unchanged at its next meeting on Oct. 28-29 and raise it when they meet in December. JOSE LUIS MAGANA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

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OPINION & ANALYSIS

Private airport concession need not be sinister

Government's overtures with private airport managers can produce meaningful benefits

JORDAN EIZENGA
TIM MURPHY

OPINION

Jordan Eizenga is the national infrastructure leader at Deloitte Canada.

Tim Murphy is executive vice-president at Aecon.

Good infrastructure delivers services to Canadians efficiently and effectively. The government's recent changes to allow private concessions in our major airports will help to serve workers, passengers and the community better.

In the 1990s, Ottawa transferred its largest airports to non-profit airport authorities operating under long-term ground lease

es with Transport Canada. It made sense at the time and let airports borrow from private markets to expand their terminals and runways without needing taxpayer support.

But the past three decades have exposed the model's limits. While airport authorities are financially independent, they do not have the financial flexibility, pricing discipline or accountability to government that continued infrastructure investment will require. By many metrics, Canadian airports are among the most expensive in the developed world and need significant continuing upgrades to their infrastructure.

Passenger demand at Toronto Pearson, for example, is expected to grow over the next 10 years, which will require additional infrastructure, baggage systems and other ancillary technology to accommodate.

These issues have been recognized before. The 2016 Canada Transportation Act Review recommended potentially moving the largest airports to private investors under a regulated model.

Airport reform is long overdue.

The government's decision to retain ownership of airport land while allowing long-term concessions with private airport managers can produce several meaningful benefits to workers and passengers.

It introduces an airport manager the government can hold to account. Currently, airport authorities operate public infrastructure, but the government has almost no way to influence how airports set prices, manage relationships with workers or ensure proper service and capital investment levels. When the government transferred the airports almost 30 years ago, it did not build in any mechanism to do so. That was a mistake that the government can rectify now.

A concession with a private operator replaces that lack of public control with a binding agreement that establishes rules for airport fees, union wage requirements, service and capital upgrade obligations. If a private concessionaire fails to meet these contractual obligations, the government

will ordinarily have specific ways to rectify the situation.

Such an arrangement is not less public involvement or protection of workers and consumers. It is a more direct, accountable and enforceable model for regulating the performance of our largest airports in a way that can benefit everyone.

Airports in London, Sydney, Melbourne, Auckland, Brussels and Copenhagen, for example, all operate with private investment using contracts that govern pricing, performance standards and capital upgrade requirements. Not all of these have been perfect, but we can take the best of each of these contract models and apply those lessons appropriately to our largest airports.

A further benefit of a concession is that it can free up limited government resources. Our current airport model has kept the federal government's capital tied up in assets in which the private sector would gladly invest. A better approach would be to redeploy public capital from these assets to things the private sector

will not fund and that we sorely need, such as affordable housing and transit.

Opponents often look to Ontario's Highway 407 ETR concession as an example where government sold concession rights to a public infrastructure asset at a value that, with hindsight, proved significantly too low. We have learned a lot in the nearly three decades since that concession about contract design, revenue-sharing requirements and regulation that protect the public interest.

Canadians would be well served by focusing less on who owns the airport and more on how it is managed, contracted and regulated to ensure enforceable obligations and proper oversight of the fees citizens pay. That can happen with a private manager. By applying the best aspects of models used elsewhere, Canada is well positioned to improve our airports, unlock the immense amount of federal capital tied up in these airport assets and redirect it to much-needed public goods.

Canada won the AI talent race, but we're losing the infrastructure one

SAMI KIBRIA
ABDULLAH SNOBAR

OPINION

Sami Kibria is co-founder of flexgrid.cloud.

Abdullah Snobar is the executive director of DMZ and chief executive of DMZ Ventures.

Meta's recent \$13-billion data centre investment in Alberta is a genuine testament to Canada as a global player on the artificial-intelligence stage, with the country leading in research, education institutions and talent. The investments have also pushed AI infrastructure into public discourse, which is long overdue.

While large investments into data centres to create more AI capacity should be celebrated, Canada needs to look at how our entrepreneurs, researchers, businesses and institutions will actually be able to use said infrastructure to build the next generation of AI companies right here at home.

Canada had a fully funded national AI strategy in 2017, before any other country in the world did. These investments built Vector Institute, Amii and MILA into research institutions that are renowned globally. We're seeing payoffs in the numbers, such as Canada officially outpacing the United States when it comes to the rate of growth of AI talent.

With Prime Minister Mark Carney's pledge to create 250,000 AI jobs by 2031, it's clear our government is serious about having AI at the centre of Canada's economic



Albertans protest a proposed Meta data centre in Morinville, Alta., in August. The \$13-billion data centre will support Meta's AI work, but it won't expand the compute power for Canadian businesses.

AMANDA MAY ERICKSON/THE CANADIAN PRESS

agenda.

Employment targets, strong talent pools and research isn't enough without access to compute – processing power – and the federal government's sovereign AI strategy recognized a massive problem back in 2024 that we can't keep ignoring. Without enough access to AI compute, Canadian innovation will be built here but scaled elsewhere because the infrastructure to do it at home doesn't exist.

Our default response to growing AI demand has been simply to build bigger data centres, and we all know the adage: Bigger doesn't

necessarily mean better. Canada needs more capacity, but capacity is not the only factor that decides who leads the AI economy – access is.

Take Meta's investment in Alberta, it's a major vote of confidence in Canada, but there's an important distinction to appreciate. The data centre will serve Meta's AI work, but it won't expand the compute power for Canadian businesses, researchers and entrepreneurs to develop their own AI projects.

Anthropic is reportedly eyeing Alberta for a data centre too, based on a handful of recent roles

they're hiring for in Canada. Whether it's Meta or Anthropic setting up shop in Alberta, it's not a given that any Calgary-based startup close by will get to access its capabilities.

That difference matters because the easier it is for Canadians to get their hands on compute, the more our research turns into companies, jobs (both direct and indirect) and economic growth. The federal government's new Responsible Data Centre Development Principles announced by AI Minister Evan Solomon recognizes this distinction by calling for data centre projects in the coun-

try to provide tangible benefits to Canadians, including access to compute and jobs, but we still have more to do.

Foreign investment undeniably has a place in Canada's AI strategy and encouraging these players to share more of the upside is undoubtedly progress, but it can't be our standalone solution.

Every economic era had a defining infrastructure from railroads, electricity and then the cloud. None of them were revolutionary until ordinary businesses and people could access them.

AI asks far more of our computers today than it did even a year ago. We're feeding it more complex tasks, expecting faster responses and more users are hitting the system at once.

Compute is the thing you need to compete, and access to it is the bottleneck. The countries that make that access easy are the ones that turn AI research into real outputs such as companies and jobs.

Distributed AI infrastructure, meaning a mesh of compute across multiple locations instead of packed into one mega facility, is how you can solve for access.

It brings compute closer to the people and businesses actually using it, which makes the system harder to knock over and allows businesses more visibility over their workloads.

The countries that will lead the AI economy will be the ones to make it easiest for their own entrepreneurs to build and access sovereign compute. Canada has spent well over the last decade building one of the strongest AI ecosystems and now we must give them the infrastructure to lead it.

Spiralling chaos from the bond market will shake the world economy

DAVID MacNICOL

OPINION

President and portfolio manager at MacNicol & Associates Asset Management

The recent synchronized rise in global yields is not simply a U.S. fiscal or monetary story.

Investors are reassessing global debt levels, persistent inflation and a changing world order marked by geopolitical conflicts and trade disputes. These concerns have increased bond market volatility and have begun affecting many balanced-oriented portfolios.

As yields and bond prices move in inverse directions, sharp increases in yields have produced losses for many fixed-income investors, and that will likely continue.

Long-duration government yields have jumped to multidecade highs globally, especially across the developed world, with the U.S. 10-year treasury yield moving above 5.6 per cent, Japan's 10-year yield near 3 per cent, and the British 30-year yield above 6 per cent. Global long-

term yields are signalling something beyond the typical response to central bank interest-rate increases: a lack of confidence from investors in the fiscal and monetary situation around the world.

Central banks now face a difficult task – balancing fragile economic growth with elevated inflation. They are expected to be overly hawkish during this cycle after getting it wrong during the last inflationary cycle, postpandemic.

These central banks do not want to be wrong twice and will be fighting more than inflation; they will be fighting the recent memory of having misread the situation and investor confidence. However, keeping rates high for too long could produce severe economic damage. If central banks maintain their hawkish stance, the bond sell-off could continue and expose deeper fiscal vulnerabilities across the developed world.

Governments are feeling the effect and consequences of higher yields. The U.S. Treasury recently tripled its bond buyback program from US\$2-billion to US\$6-billion. The Treasury claimed its decision was aimed at increasing liquidity in the Treasury

market. However, many investors are questioning the timing of the decision and have concluded the program is intended to minimize the increase in interest rates.

These central banks do not want to be wrong twice and will be fighting more than inflation; they will be fighting the recent memory of having misread the situation and investor confidence.

The Treasury has also received political backlash for intervening in bond markets just a few weeks before U.S. midterm elections, as higher borrowing costs and affordability remain key issues for voters. Higher yields don't only affect consumers, but they also affect governments that are servicing massive deficits.

As we have seen, this move by the Treasury has not decreased interest rates; it has increased long-term rates and led to many investors questioning the independence of the Treasury and its motives. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has faced criticism, in-

cluding from his former mentor Stanley Druckenmiller, over his handling of this situation. Druckenmiller, who famously shorted the British pound and "broke the Bank of England" in the 1990s, warned in an opinion piece last month that governments who defend prices against fundamentals always lose, and the variable is how much they spend before conceding.

Meanwhile, the U.S. Federal Reserve's interest-rate policy has had rippling effects across global markets through currency movements, capital flows and imported inflation. Higher U.S. interest rates attract capital, support the U.S. dollar and place pressure on other currencies.

Central banks worldwide are feeling these pressures and are attempting to protect domestic currency purchasing power, while avoiding further economic pressure from higher interest rates. Japan's move away from ultralow interest rates and consistent inflation worries in Europe could intensify global volatility in bond markets and could lead to further weakness.

For investors and consumers, higher benchmark rates mean higher borrowing costs and lower bond prices. Many balanced port-

folios that rely on fixed income to cushion equity drawdowns have instead seen both asset classes fall, a repeat of 2022. The recent rise of yields has pushed bond prices down, affected investor sentiment and triggered credit-fund outflows.

Higher yields are not fundamentally negative: they can improve income for investors and normalize bond market pricing after years of near-zero yields. The danger today is not simply the level of yields, but the volatility and speed of bond-price adjustments, which are being intensified by fiscal vulnerabilities that adversely affect consumers, investors and governments.

Ultimately, global bond-market performance may not be entirely determined by monetary policy, and will likely be ascertained by investor sentiment toward inflation cyclicality and their belief in policy makers' control over it. Fiscal policy is expected to be a driver of bond-market performance, as investors want governments to show their actions are sustainable and not volatile.

Global bond markets may remain unusually volatile as numerous parties navigate an uncertain economic environment.

Financial regulator considering firmer guardrails on banks

STEFANIE MAROTTA
BANKING REPORTER

Canada’s banking regulator is planning to implement tighter guidelines on artificial intelligence as threats from AI agents and Anthropic’s powerful Claude Mythos model escalate risks among the country’s lenders.

As the pace of AI development surges, banks have been accelerating their use of the technology aimed at cutting costs and generating financial returns. Office of the Superintendent of Financial Institutions superintendent Peter Routledge has tasked his team to work on creating a “safety code” to improve cybersecurity and mitigate risks, he said during a conference Wednesday held by the Global Risk Institute.

The regulator is still working on the details, but Mr. Routledge said the safety code could consist of broad, high-level standards that provide a basic level of safety and protection for the financial system, while also establishing a “wide perimeter for innovation.”

Rather than implement a regulatory framework prior to now, OSFI has guided banks to “do no harm,” Mr. Routledge said. In 2023, the regulator and the GRI published a report on the implications of AI on financial services institutions. OSFI has also previously listed AI in its annual risk outlook.

The introduction of Mythos, which Anthropic has restricted the use of because it is capable of finding and exploiting weak spots in software that could open companies to cyberattacks, was the catalyst that spurred OSFI to consider firmer guardrails on the banking industry’s use of the technology.

“That was an event that signifies the advancing capabilities of frontier AI models, which could be turned for illicit purposes and attack the financial institutions. That constituted a major increase in cyber risk,” Mr. Routledge told reporters during a media scrum on Wednesday.

“And then the more recent stories we’re reading about how agents are interpreting their task authorizations liberally and potentially posing dangers to institutions – that’s frightening, and that is a risk that is front and centre for us.”

Canadian banks have been accelerating AI research and implementation. On Tuesday, AI benchmarking platform Evident ranked all of Canada’s five biggest banks in the top 30 of a list of 50 global financial institutions on AI adoption.

Mr. Routledge said he is generally satisfied with the level of preparedness of Canada’s banks, but “not all institutions across the system are equal on AI” as some are further ahead than others.

If an issue arose at one financial institution, it could spread through Canada’s banking system.

“What if one of your counterparties does something wrong?” Mr. Routledge said. “You’re connected to your counterparties, and if there’s poison at the counterparties, it’s flowing through to you as an institution. Our highest utility is to try and lessen the risk that some poison gets into one institution and scatters throughout the system.”

The federal government has been courting investment to build data centres that power the boom in AI demand. While Ottawa says it is attempting to secure Canada’s data sovereignty, the technology also poses significant risks, GRI chief executive officer Sonia Baxendale said. “We know the very technology required to strengthen our resilience also creates new threats to our institutions, to our national security, and to democracy itself,” she said.

“With trust in traditional institutions at historic lows, a small number of global technology firms now control the platforms that increasingly shape how we communicate, consume information and make decisions.”

Mr. Routledge also cited private credit and private equity as mounting risks, and said OSFI will highlight the issue in its risk outlook, set to be published Thursday. “We are not seeing sizable risk concentrations that give us heartburn in this sector, but the aggregate concentration is growing,” he said.

As Ottawa has urged institutions to help drive its nation-building efforts, OSFI has introduced measures aimed at making

more bank lending available. In June, the regulator lowered the size of the capital cushion the country’s biggest banks must hold, freeing up billions of dollars.

The regulator is also examining ways to even the playing field for smaller banks, Mr. Routledge said, with the intention of helping those institutions increase lending. Over the next six months, OSFI will be examining how its capital framework may disadvantage small- and medium-sized lenders.

He referred to this as a “competitive imbalance” between the smaller banks that follow a standardized approach and the larger banks that use internal ratings to manage capital.

Earlier in the day, federal Natural Resources Minister Tim Hodgson urged the room of financial institution leaders to help finance Ottawa’s nation-building projects – initiatives that banks have often been considered too risky for lending.

“When someone walks into a bank or an asset manager with a \$10-billion project, you don’t hand them the money without asking about the risks,” Mr. Hodgson said. “We understand the government cannot eliminate risk for opponents, and we understand these should not insulate investors with bad investment decisions. However, there are cases where governments can use its suite of tools to change the balance between expected risks and returns of strategically important investments.”

Ottawa is using a variety of measures to help make it easier for banks to lend to riskier businesses and projects, including loan guarantees and potential co-investments, Mr. Hodgson said.

As the U.S. wages its trade war with Canada, President Donald Trump has taken fresh aim at the Canadian banking sector. In September, he repeated his incorrect claim the U.S. banks are unable to operate in Canada.

But when mid-sized banks have been put on the auction block in recent years, there were no U.S. buyers, Mr. Routledge said.

“All the acquirers were Canadian, and they weren’t Canadian because we had any bias geographically,” he said. “They were who stood up with a bid, and any foreign bank could have stood up with a bid, and we would have looked at it exactly the same way as a Canadian bidder. We are geographically agnostic.”



Steam rises at Suncor’s oil sands facility near Fort McMurray, Alta. Oil and gas – Canada’s highest emitters – remained flat according to a new report on the country’s emissions. VICTOR R. CAIVANO/AP

Report: Top contributors to 2025 increase in greenhouse gases were from building sector

■ FBOM B1

The biggest contributors to the 2025 increase in greenhouse gases were from the building sector, where emissions jumped 6 per cent, and power generation, up 5 per cent compared with 2024.

“Our building sector is still really reliant on natural gas, so when the temperatures drop, and 2025 was a colder year than 2024, our gas use and our emissions go up significantly,” Mr. Linden-Fraser said.

In comparison, oil and gas – Canada’s highest emitters – remained essentially flat, while other sectors made scant progress at cutting carbon dioxide.

The November, 2025, memorandum of understanding announced by Prime Minister Mark Carney and Alberta Premier Danielle Smith envisions Ottawa backing Alberta’s proposal for a one-million-barrel-a-day pipeline to the Pacific Coast in exchange for dozens of provisions to lessen the environmental impact of the province’s energy sector.

The subsequent implementation agreement included changes to the industrial carbon pricing system, which is designed to incentivize industries to install electrified technologies. However, the changes did not fix existing issues, such as an oversupply of carbon credits and low demand, Mr. Linden-Fraser said.

“The result is that industries, which particularly in Alberta are the main source of emissions, will not have enough incentive to reduce their emissions,” he said.

Mr. Carney’s most recent policy moves with Bill C-39, the Building Canada Strong Act, would see a reduction in consultation and approval timeframes down to one year when fast-tracking major projects. However, Mr. Linden-Fraser said it is too soon to see how Mr.

Carney’s climate and economic policies will affect carbon emissions.

He added the institute has done projections suggesting the potential impacts of those policies on Canada’s emission goals “and it’s nowhere near enough to get us on track to net-zero emissions.”

Canada’s best chance of getting back on track, is through clean electrification, the report stated.

But that involves breaking “20 years of history in which we’ve barely electrified at all,” Mr. Linden-Fraser said.

Canada’s electricity generation has only risen 3 per cent since 2005.

In the same time period, natural gas use, not for power generation, has risen by 48 per cent.

Growth in non-emitting renewable energy generation has been negatively impacted by climate change with droughts reducing hydro production. Refurbishments to some nuclear power plants have also taken them offline.

As a result, the report found Canada’s electrical production “is less green than it was just five years ago,” down to 80 per cent of the total from 84 per cent in 2024.

Canada has made commitments to double its electrical generation by 2050 and recently announced a \$10-billion investment in upgrading Churchill Falls hydroelectrical plant in Labrador to increase clean electrical generation.

“But it’s when we look at the overall picture that we’re not seeing enough progress,” Mr. Linden-Fraser said.

The early emissions data reinforces 440 Méga-tonnes’ previous study from September, which found the country is 20 years behind its 2030 emissions target goals, part of Canada’s commitment to reach net-zero emissions by 2050 under the Paris Agreement.

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LEGALS

SCHEDULE “A”
NOTICE TO POTENTIAL PRIORITY CLAIMANTS
NOVA RIDGE (MANDERLEY) LIMITED PARTNERSHIP and
NOVA RIDGE (MANDERLEY) GP CORP.

RE: NOTICE OF CLAIMS PROCEDURE

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that this notice is being published pursuant to an Order of the Ontario Superior Court of Justice (Commercial List) made October 1, 2026 (the “**Priority Claims Procedure Order**”) in the receivership of Nova Ridge (Manderley) Limited Partnership (the “**Borrower**”) and Nova Ridge (Manderley) GP Corp. (the “**Borrower GP**” and collectively with the Borrower, the “**Debtors**”). Defined terms used here and not defined have the meanings given in the Priority Claims Procedure Order.

AlixPartners Restructuring, Inc., Court-appointed receiver (in such capacity, the “**Receiver**”) of the Debtors, is conducting a claims process to call for Priority Claims, including secured claims and claims ranking in priority to the Senior Secured Lenders’ Claim. **Unsecured Claims and Claims that Do Not have evidence and/or a basis to be a Priority Claim are not being called for in this Priority Claims Procedure. Such Claims will not be reviewed, considered or addressed in this Priority Claims Procedure.**

Post-Filing Claims will not be considered or addressed in this Priority Claims Procedure.

All Priority Claimants of the Debtors should receive a Claims Package from the Receiver. Priority Claimants may also obtain the Priority Claims Procedure Order and a Claims Package from the Receiver’s website at <https://cdncases.alixpartners.com/experience/case/manderley> or by contacting Nathalie El-Zakhem of the Receiver at nathalie.elzakhem@alixpartners.com.

Completed documents must be received by the Receiver by 5:00 p.m. (Toronto time) on November 5, 2026 (the “Claims Bar Date”). It is your responsibility to complete the appropriate documents and ensure that the Receiver receives your completed documents by the Claims Bar Date.

PRIORITY CLAIMS NOT RECEIVED BY THE CLAIMS BAR DATE WILL BE BARRED AND EXTINGUISHED FOREVER.

DATED at Toronto this 8th day of October, 2026

AlixPartners
ALIXPARTNERS RESTRUCTURING, INC.
LICENSED INSOLVENCY TRUSTEE
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Toronto, Ontario M5J 2W4

Weston: Prominent family controls publicly listed national grocery giant Loblaw

■ FROM B1

“As Canada builds stronger ties around the globe, we are delighted to welcome the UK’s most iconic pharmacy, health, and beauty business into our group of companies,” Mr. Weston said in an e-mail to The Globe and Mail.

In the fiscal year ended Aug. 31, 2025, Boots’ revenue grew by 3.2 per cent to £7.5-billion (\$14.1-billion), according to the most recent filing available from the British government’s Companies House. The retailer’s operating profit rose by nearly 30 per cent that year, to £355-million.

But while Boots has a significant presence across Britain, some of its store network has been in need of a refresh. The retailer has closed more than 300 underperforming locations in recent years, and has been investing in updating others. In fiscal year 2025 alone, the company renovated 40 stores and 180 of its in-store cosmetics sections known as “beauty halls.”

Wittington expects to close the Boots acquisition in the first quarter of 2027.

“Once complete, we look forward to Boots both benefiting from, and contributing to our collective expertise in retail, beauty, and the growing role of pharmacists who are making care more accessible in our communities,” Mr. Weston wrote.

Through Wittington, the Weston family controls publicly listed Canadian grocery giant Loblaw Cos. Ltd., parent to Shoppers Drug Mart, and privately holds luxury retailer Holt Renfrew.

Fairfax’s Mr. Watsa said in a news release: “For many years, the Westons have grown and developed some of the most successful retail brands in Canada, including pharmacy and beauty, and we are confident Wittington will be an excellent steward of the Boots business.”

In Canada, Fairfax owns retailers Sporting Life Group and Sleep Country as part of a \$110-billion investment portfolio.

In addition to owning Canada’s largest pharmacy chain, the Weston family has long had a strategic focus on health care businesses. Wittington’s venture



Boots was founded in 1849 in Nottingham, in central England, as an herbalist store, selling alternatives to traditional medicines. Boots, like Shoppers, has a massive customer loyalty program with 17 million members. IAN FORSYTH/GETTY IMAGES

capital unit has invested in a number of startups in the space.

Shoppers Drug Mart has also invested in building more on-site clinics offering health services such as treatments for minor conditions, travel vaccinations and cholesterol screening.

One area where the Westons’ experience could benefit Boots is around its loyalty strategy, where the new owners are planning to invest.

Boots, like Shoppers, has a massive customer loyalty program with 17 million members. Loblaw’s PC Optimum has 18 million members and is considered Canada’s strongest rewards program.

Loblaw has become very sophisticated in using PC Optimum to drive traffic to its stores, both through promotions that offer bonus points for purchasing on

certain days, or that multiply the value of points on redemption.

Because many high-priced prestige cosmetics brands are price-protected, meaning retailers do not have as much flexibility to offer discounts, those redemption events can be a proxy for putting those items on promotion, explained Uwe Stueckmann, a former long-time Loblaw executive.

“That has cemented the prestige business for Shoppers,” Mr. Stueckmann said in an interview with The Globe. “Back in the day, when the department stores were still around, they just didn’t have those kinds of mechanisms and tactics to compete with Shoppers.”

Shoppers Drug Mart has had considerable success expanding the “Beauty Boutique” sections of its stores. That product

category brings in higher profit margins than other parts of the stores, and will likely be a priority for the Boots business to find growth.

Loblaw’s loyalty strategy also includes a strong app and digital platform, as well as a partnership with Esso and Mobil that encourages customers to utilize the PC Optimum rewards program more frequently, increasing its value.

“I think many of those principles could be highly relevant to Boots and Advantage Card,” Jim Noteboom, another former executive with Loblaw and Shoppers Drug Mart, wrote in an e-mail to The Globe, referring to the British chain’s loyalty program.

Boots chief executive officer Alex Baldock said in a news release the company plans to deepen its customer relationships under its new owners.

“For all of our social impact and commercial success to-date, the opportunity ahead is even greater,” Mr. Baldock said. “I look forward to making the most of that opportunity and building a world-class Boots.”

Boots owns one of Britain’s leading beauty brands, the No7 Beauty Company, and will continue to invest in building its stable of products.

In 2022, Wittington sold British department store chain Selfridges for approximately \$6.9-billion after successfully turning around the business.

Boots was founded in 1849 in Nottingham, in central England, as an herbalist store, selling alternatives to traditional medicines.

The founder, John Boot, turned over control to his son, who built a retailer that dominates high streets across Britain.



The Stelco Hamilton Works steel mill is seen in September. CARLOS OSORIO/REUTERS

Stelco: Ottawa approved Cliffs’s \$3.4-billion acquisition of Hamilton steelmaker in 2024

■ FROM B1

When asked if he would entertain an offer from Ottawa to buy Stelco, he replied that “the only thing that makes sense for us as a business” is the Canadian government signing a “Fortress North America” trade deal with the U.S.

Alison Reilander, a spokesperson with Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada, said in an e-mail that the government is focusing on working with the union and the Ontario government to get workers back on the job.

The Cliffs boss on Wednesday also fired back at a Stelco customer who has doubted his rationale for pulling out of the galvanized steel market in Canada.

Mr. Goncalves maintains that the 50-per-cent tariff U.S. President Donald Trump imposed on Canada last year has closed off that key market for the company and the Canadian government isn’t doing enough to keep cheap imports out of the country.

Jim Ritchie, the owner of steel distribution company Cascadia Metals Ltd., called that explanation “a joke.”

He said the price of coated steel has rocketed higher this year in Canada and “it’s never been a better time to make galvanized steel in Canada.”

Mr. Ritchie said he is a big buyer of galvanized steel from Stelco and with the company no longer producing the product, it has left Cascadia in a jam, forced to import from overseas

markets to fill the void.

In response, Mr. Goncalves called Mr. Ritchie a “walking eagle,” meaning a bird that can’t fly because it is full of excrement.

He challenged the notion that Cascadia is a major customer of Stelco, saying it isn’t even among the top 20 and represents less than 1 per cent of its business by revenue.

Mr. Goncalves also said Mr. Ritchie is “part of the problem” because Cascadia imports a considerable amount of steel from overseas, which drives down the price of the product in Canada.

“Clients like Cascadia are the reason I am shutting down,” he said.

Mr. Ritchie said that while he finds the “walking eagle” comment “pretty funny,” he said he wasn’t prepared to engage in “a war of words” with Mr. Goncalves.

He admits that he imports steel from overseas but says he has been doing his best to pivot to Canadian suppliers.

“We were trying to switch from offshore to domestic and we were trying to give them more and more business. We were really ramping up the business we were giving him when they stopped selling to us,” Mr. Ritchie said.

“If we didn’t import, we wouldn’t have a business. That’s because Canadian steel producers can’t supply the entire Western Canadian market. There isn’t enough steel in Canada.”

Emera

■ FROM B1

For both companies, the timing matters. Governments and think tanks talk extensively about the need for new power generation plants to meet growing demand, particularly from data centres, and they urge extensive new transmission and distribution infrastructure to get that power to end users.

The existing grid also needs to be modernized to enhance remote monitoring and allow bidirectional electricity flows. And billions of dollars of upgrades will be needed just to maintain aging existing infrastructure and harden it in anticipation of more extreme weather events. Mr. Balfour addressed this when justifying the deal. “This transaction creates a stronger company positioned to invest in the infrastructure needed to support electrification, industrial development, energy security, data centres, and the growing demand of customers across North America,” he said.

The problem is that language like this was used repeatedly, with few tangible examples of how exactly the combined size will help the two companies. When they were provided, they weren’t so clear cut.

Emera, for instance, said the transaction will “improve credit rating thresholds, providing greater financial flexibility,” but after the conference call the outlook was a bit more mixed. Rating agency Moody’s Investors Service said the deal was at least neutral for Emera’s credit rating, but Fitch Ratings said it might actually be a slight negative for CU, which has the more favourable rating of the two companies.

And on the same scale front, the threat of losing out to U.S. rivals that are getting bigger by merging, including NextEra Energy, Inc. and Dominion Energy, Inc., who are pursuing a US\$67-billion combination, may not hold up. U.S. mergers are starting to face political backlash, and Virginia’s governor make seek concessions, such as measures to keep bills down and promises to pursue clean energy development, the Financial Times reported this week.

The core issue, though, seems to be the geographic distance. Emera expanded into Florida in 2016 by acquiring Tampa-based TECO Energy Inc., and 72 per cent

of its adjusted net income now comes from the Sunshine State. Investors have been enthused by the potential for data-centre growth there.

CU, meanwhile, is heavily exposed to Alberta, and as TD Securities analyst John Mould wrote in a note to clients, the province authorizes lower utility returns than Florida, which can hinder profits. (Utilities are highly regulated and are often only allowed to make a certain level of return, which prevents them from price gouging.)

“We believe that reduced relative exposure to Florida (a high quality jurisdiction for utilities) will be a disappointment for some investors,” he wrote.

Couple that with Emera and CU’s acknowledgment that cost synergies are unlikely, and it can feel like two second-cousins are being made to look like siblings.

The reality: There likely are some benefits, they were simply glossed over in the big deal announcement. Florida and Alberta have two uncorrelated economies, which might give rating agencies more comfort when it comes to the combined company’s debt. That could lower the combined company’s cost of capital, and help it compete on government contracts against giants like Berkshire Hathaway.

And for Emera investors, Alberta isn’t some backwater. The province’s population growth rate was higher than Florida’s over the last five years, and Alberta wants to encourage data centre construction, as well as expand its natural gas distribution network. The province also permits elevated returns over and above the approved returns if they are shared with customers.

The issue may be that none of this was telegraphed to investors beforehand. Companies tend to give their shareholders some guidance on where they’re looking to expand, but neither Emera nor CU had floated the potential. In Emera’s case, investors were just getting comfortable with the company again after it spent years selling assets to pay down debt, and they were finally getting excited about the potential in Florida.

If it is true that some benefits have been overlooked, it’s on the companies to simply explain themselves, because their first stab at it this week wasn’t all that encouraging.

Modernizing Canadian finance

Thursday, October 8, 2026

Produced by Randall Anthony Communications. The Globe's Editorial Department was not involved.

Addressing Canada's lagging productivity

Why a competitive financing system is needed to direct more investment capital to small and medium-sized enterprises

Compared to other OECD nations, Canada's small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) face significant barriers in accessing financing for the tools and equipment they need to compete and grow.

A recent paper from the C.D. Howe Institute (*Canada's Investment Crisis: Shrinking Capital Undermines Competitiveness and Wages*, December 2025) highlighted the impacts of this lack of investment capital. "Business investment in Canada is so weak that capital per worker is declining, eroding productivity, competitiveness and living standards," the report said. It noted that Canadian workers were projected to receive only 70 cents of new capital for every dollar received by their counterparts in the OECD as a whole and 55 cents for every dollar received by U.S. workers.

The Canadian Finance & Leasing Association (CFLA), which represents Canada's asset-backed financing, vehicle and equipment leasing industry, has put forward a blueprint for injecting energy and more competition into the financial sector so that it can better serve the needs of SMEs.

NEED TO EXPAND LENDER DIVERSITY

In its report, *Canada's Economic Rocket Fuel: How a Switch in Canada's Financing Paradigm Could Help Solve its Productivity Problem*, the CFLA calls for a number of reforms to broaden the mix of lenders in the country's financial sector to provide more options to smaller firms whose higher risk profile isn't suitable for a loan from a larger financial institution.

"Our financial ecosystem needs to support the success of more independent finance and leasing companies," says Michael Rothe, president and CEO of the CFLA.

“It's frustrating when some of our members need to be funded by U.S. investors. Where does that money go when they make a profit? It goes south of the border rather than staying here to help grow the economy.”

Michael Rothe
President and CEO, Canadian Finance & Leasing Association



“We have customers who already are dealing with a federally regulated bank and have met all their anti-money laundering requirements and are required to repeat all that work when they're trying to finance a tractor or a photocopier.”

Hugh Swandel
President, Meridian OneCap Credit Corp.



Leasing industry experts are calling for system reforms to address financing barriers that often make it challenging for smaller Canadian businesses to meet their capital investment needs. GRAEMENICHOLSON VIA GETTY IMAGES

"With their specialized expertise and existing relationships with smaller businesses, these lenders complement the large banks and fill the market gap in capital access for Canadian SMEs."

The 2008 financial crisis drove consolidation in Canada's financial sector, which squeezed out a number of mid-sized financial firms that traditionally provided capital to emerging firms. The CFLA calls for a new approach to allow independent finance and leasing firms to thrive and contribute their unique capacity to the system.

"The leasing industry has closer relationships with small and medium-sized enterprises," says Hugh Swandel, president of Meridian OneCap Credit Corp. and chair of the CFLA.

"We understand their capacity for repayment and the future value of the equipment they are borrowing against. These relationships allow us to quickly assess the right terms for a loan that are good for both parties. Our industry's speed to market and our ability to push money into the economy is unique."

In addition, independent finance

and leasing companies often face complex regulations, administrative burdens and challenges in securing capital. This means they can end up turning to U.S. investors for funding.

"With new tariff pressures from the U.S., we are looking for made-in-Canada solutions more than ever," Mr. Rothe says. "It's frustrating when some of our members need to be funded by U.S. investors. Where does that money go when they make a profit? It goes south of the border rather than staying here to help grow the economy."

HIGH COST OF BORROWING FOR SMES

One of the obstacles to capital access for smaller firms is the higher cost of borrowing. Canada has one of the highest interest rate spreads in the OECD between large and small borrowers, with rates for smaller firms 2.28 per cent higher, compared to a differential of 0.28 per cent in the U.S.

"As a result, the U.S. are leapfrogging ahead of us in supporting entrepreneurs while our levels are flatlining," says Mr. Rothe.

The CFLA is also calling for greater flexibility in certain regulatory

requirements. One example is new anti-money laundering regulations. The CFLA understands their importance; however, the way they're applied is often counterproductive. "We have customers who already are dealing with a federally regulated bank and have met all their anti-money laundering requirements and are required to repeat all that work when they're trying to finance a tractor or a photocopier," Mr. Swandel says.

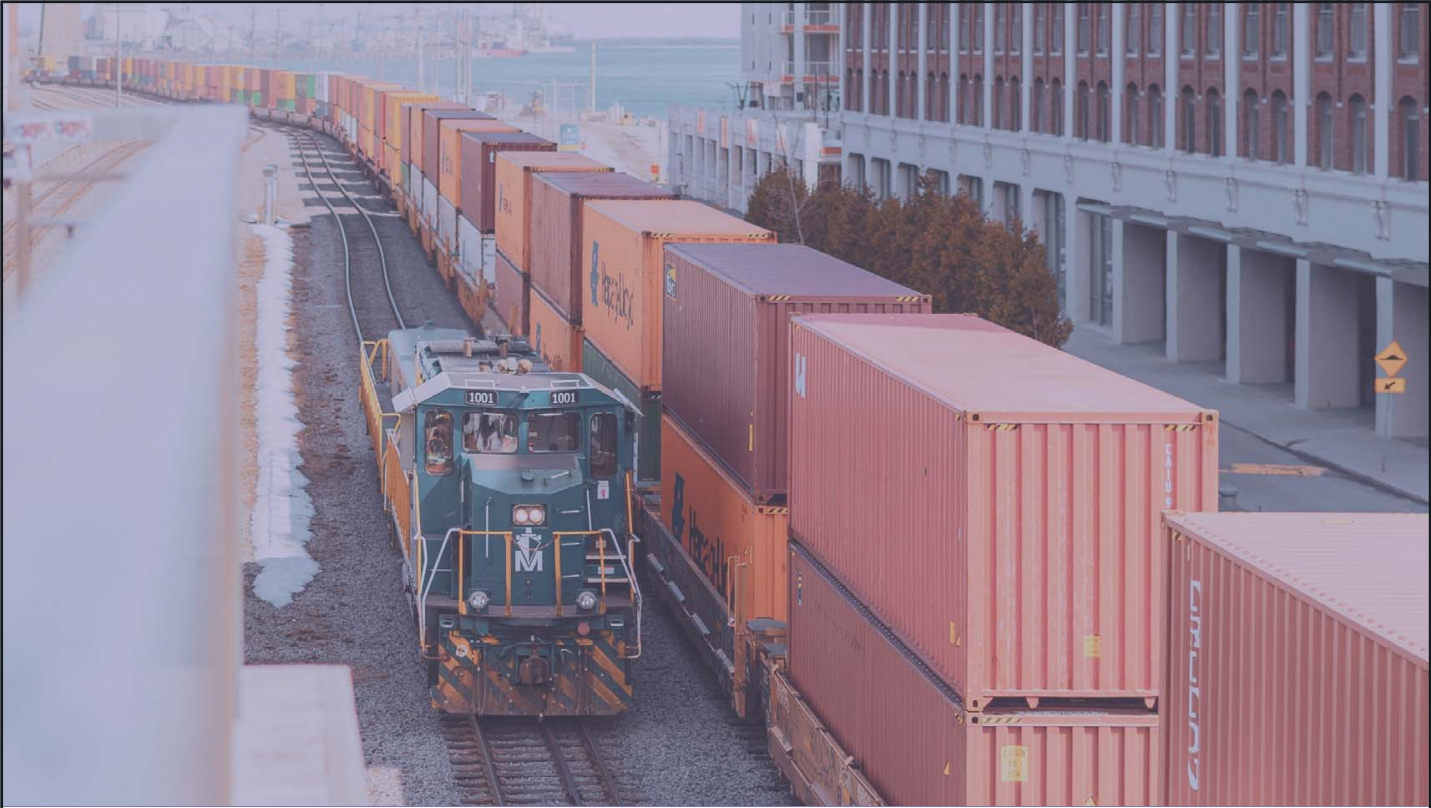
A PARTNERSHIP BETWEEN THE GOVERNMENT AND PRIVATE SECTOR

The CFLA urges Canada to draw from international best practices, particularly the British Business Bank's ENABLE program, which has expanded the British economy's ability to lend to SMEs. The British Business Bank partners with independent financing and leasing companies, working with them as intermediaries to finance smaller companies, an indirect lending approach.

The ENABLE program uses securitization to package smaller microfinance loans into one portfolio. This has allowed private finance companies to profitably invest in small business loans they would deem too small or too risky individually.

"We are proposing that the Business Development Bank of Canada emulate the successful elements of the British model," says Mr. Swandel. "By working with our sector in alignment with our distribution systems, we can share the risks and rewards and drive more money to smaller businesses."

"Adapting indirect lending in the Canadian financial market can give SMEs the strong and reliable access to capital they need to scale up their capacity and improve their productivity," he adds.



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Gen Z is obsessed with dividends. But at what cost?

The idea of living off your dividends sounds great, but every investing decision comes with trade-offs

BRYCE LEUNG

OPINION

Kristy Shen and Bryce Leung retired in their 30s and are authors of the book *Parent Like a Millionaire (Without Being One)*

There's a hot new Gen Z investing trend, and it's all about dividends. With its own ecosystem of influencers on Youtube like Dividendology and a dividend investing subreddit with 911,000 followers, the trend is sometimes called dividend maxxng, yield maxxng or my personal favourite, "dividends and chill."

Here's how it works: You buy stocks or exchange-traded funds (ETFs) that pay dividends, collect those dividends as passive income and reinvest those dividends so your holdings grow over time. Once your passive income replaces your expenses, you retire.

So, what is the problem here? Isn't that the model that the Financial Independence, Retire Early (FIRE) movement follows?

In many ways, yes. Investing your money in passive-income producing investments and using that to retire is a core principle of the FIRE movement. The big difference is that this approach heavily favours dividends, while FIRE is more agnostic: interest, dividends and capital gains all count.

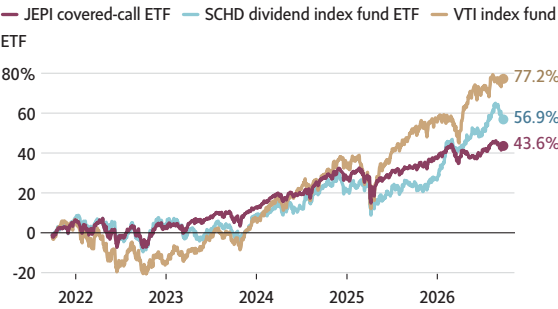
This is reflected in the different ETFs we use. The FIRE movement uses low-cost index funds like Vanguard's US Total Stock Market ETF (VTI) or iShares Core S&P/TSX Capped Composite Index ETF (XIC) to build our portfolios, while dividend investors often use the Schwab US Dividend Equity ETF (SCHD).

Because these investors want steady dividends, this strategy tends to concentrate on large, stable companies like banks, health care and consumer staples. This underweights growth sectors like the tech sector, which reduces volatility but means they miss out on the sectors' long-term capital gains.

Dividend investing is a perfect-

Performance of dividend and index fund ETFs if all dividends are reinvested

Percentage growth, indexed so that 0 = Sept. 27, 2021



THE GLOBE AND MAIL, SOURCE: YAHOO FINANCE; AUTHOR'S CALCULATIONS

ly reasonable strategy that has existed long before Gen Z discovered it. Where it starts to get alarming, however, is when investors get impatient.

The SCHD fund currently has a dividend yield of 3 per cent, which is miles better than VTI's yield of just 1 per cent. But it also means that if you need \$60,000 to retire, you would need approximately \$2,000,000 worth of SCHD to retire on it.

What if you wanted to retire on a smaller portfolio? The FIRE approach would be to reduce your living expenses. If you want to retire with half as much money, you need to spend half as much a year. In other words, FIRE advocates for changing your lifestyle – not your investments.

Dividend Maxxers do the opposite. Rather than cut costs, they search for funds paying higher yields. After all, if your investments were yielding 6 per cent rather than 3 per cent, you would only need \$1-million. If your investments were yielding 12 per cent, you would only need \$500,000.

That math is seductive, and that's when this strategy becomes dangerous.

The perceived safety of dividend investing is that you don't have to sell any shares to fund your living expenses. You simply buy, hold and live off the dividends. But yield is not the same as dividends. Just because a fund advertises a certain yield every month doesn't mean it's sustainable.

Covered-call ETFs are one example.

They are popular among dividend investors because they advertise a much higher yield, but most of that yield is not being

funded by dividends. Instead, the funds use a strategy involving call options, which creates income from a basket of stocks by collecting option premiums and redistributing them to fund investors. But it works best when the stock market is relatively flat or rising modestly. When the market spikes higher, these call options can work against you because the fund can be forced to sell off shares if those options get called, or the options themselves can lose value.

That's not a passive buy-and-hold strategy, although it feels like it because the fund holder is sitting there and collecting their monthly payments. But underneath the hood, someone is actively trading on your behalf.

Let's look at the long-term performance of three funds. An index fund like VTI yields about 1 per cent, a dividend index fund like SCHD yields 3 per cent, and a covered-call ETF covering the S&P 500, such as JEPI, yields almost 8 per cent.

Someone chasing dividends would be highly tempted to pick JEPI because a nearly 8-per-cent yield is better than 3 per cent or 1 per cent. But let's look at how these funds performed over the past five years if an investor reinvested all dividends produced.

As you can see, that yield isn't free. The higher current income you want, the lower the long-term performance of that fund tends to be.

There's a lot to like about dividend investing, and the idea of living off your dividends while never touching the principal sounds great. But every investing decision comes with trade-offs, and it's important to understand them.

With fall in the air, investors can start year-end tax planning with these strategies

TIM CESTNICK

OPINION



FCPA, FCA, CPA (IL), CFP, TEP, an author and co-founder and CEO of Our Family Office Inc

‘Tis the season to be thinking about saving taxes for 2026. If you're an investor, think about the following strategies.

■ **Defer capital gains.** If you're planning to sell a personal investment with an accrued gain, ask yourself whether the sale really has to happen before Dec. 31. Waiting until January can push the taxable gain into 2027 and can delay any tax bill by a year. Selling now may still make sense if you have losses available, expect a higher tax rate next year, or simply think it's time to sell the investment for other reasons.

■ **Harvest capital losses.** If you've realized capital gains in 2026, look for investments in your portfolio with accrued losses. Selling them before year-end can create capital losses to offset gains this year. Unused net capital losses can generally be carried back three years or forward indefinitely. Just watch the superficial loss rules, which can deny a loss if you, your spouse or an affiliated entity buy the same or identical property in the period that is 30 days before or after your sale.

■ **Check your bare trusts.** Do you hold legal title to an investment, bank account or real estate for someone else? Starting with taxation years ending on or after Dec. 31, 2026, certain "reportable bare trusts" can have a T3 return and Schedule 15 filing obligation. There are exceptions, particularly for accounts holding \$50,000 or less, so don't assume every joint account is caught. Year-end is a good time to figure out if you have any joint accounts or other arrangements that are caught under these reporting rules.

■ **Watch the 21-year clock.** Many family trusts are deemed to dispose of their assets – that is, capital property – every 21 years at fair market value, which can trigger a tax hit even though nothing was sold. If a trust you're involved with is coming up to its 21st anniversary, get advice now. In some cases, assets can be distributed to beneficiaries on a tax-deferred basis before the anniversary to avoid taxes, or there may be other options to side-step that tax hit, so speak to a tax pro.

■ **Revisit private-company dividends.** Dividends from a private corporation can run into the tax on split income, or TOSI, rules when they're paid to family members. When TOSI applies, the income is generally taxed at the top marginal rate, which can wipe out any income-splitting benefit. Before declaring year-end dividends from a corporation, confirm whether the recipient fits within an exclusion that avoids TOSI.

■ **Check your AMT exposure.** The alternative minimum tax, or AMT, can surprise investors because it uses a separate tax calculation and limits the benefit of certain deductions, credits and preferentially taxed items. Large capital gains, loss carryforwards, interest deductions and other carrying charges, and donations can all contribute to AMT. If 2026 has been an unusually big year for gains, donations or deductions, have your tax preparer calculate your AMT exposure before year-end. Any AMT balance can be claimed as a credit in the following seven years – so it may not be a permanent loss of dollars.

■ **Make interest deductible.** Review your debts before year-end. Interest is normally deductible when you borrow money to earn income from business or property, while interest on personal borrowing isn't. So, consider paying down nondeductible personal debt first and borrowing, if it makes sense, for investing instead. Keep a clean paper trail showing how borrowed funds were used because the taxman will trace the funds to their end use.

■ **Donate appreciated securities.** If you're planning to give to charity, consider donating publicly traded securities with accrued gains rather than selling them and donating cash. When you donate qualifying securities the capital gain is eliminated and you'll still receive a donation tax credit based on fair market value to boot. This will save you more than donating cash. Just remember that a large donation can also create AMT.

■ **Plan your giving vehicle.** If charitable giving is part of your investment plan, don't just focus on what to donate; think about how to donate. A direct gift can be simplest, but a family foundation – either a donor-advised fund or a private foundation in some cases – can provide flexibility by separating the timing of your donation tax credits and when the charity gets the money. The right structure depends on cost, control and your objectives. Decide early enough to complete year-end gifts before the new year arrives.

■ **Consider a holding company.** In some provinces, investors with sizable non-registered portfolios could benefit from holding investments through a corporation rather than personally. The answer depends on income earned, your province, your personal tax rate and what you plan to do with the money later. A corporation doesn't always leave you better off, but if you have a larger taxable portfolio you should at least run the numbers.

How ‘behind-the-meter’ power pushed one stock up more than 200% in a year

SCOTT BARLOW

OPINION



Data centre expansion is stretching a U.S. power grid that was already struggling to meet demand and behind-the-meter (BTM) power – generators on sites that are not connected to the grid – is the sweeping new trend, one with clear winners and clear investment opportunities.

The rapid build-out of data centres is not a new story but a change within that trend is less understood. AI providers are now finding it necessary to build

smaller facilities close to end markets instead of connecting all cities to massive centres in faraway locations. (Large centres are used to train AI agents and smaller centres for actual use of the agents). This requires local power supplies and this is increasingly provided by BTM equipment.

Morgan Stanley analysts estimate a US\$240-billion opportunity in BTM power (or roughly 120 gigawatts, the equivalent of powering 100 million average homes). They see three big winners from the trend – Bloom Energy Corp., BorgWarner Inc. and FTAI Aviation Ltd..

Bloom Energy provides solid oxide fuel cells that are ideal for BTM power because of DC cur-

rent output, low noise and emissions. The stock is up 239 per cent over the past 12 months (that's not a typo). The trailing price to earnings ratio is really high at 251 times but earnings are more than doubling every year.

BorgWarner produces turbine generators that are also prevalent in local AI infrastructure. The stock is far more reasonably valued at 11.5 times trailing earnings and has climbed 47 per cent over the past year.

FTAI sells jet engine-based gas turbines, a thing I didn't know existed before now. The trailing price earnings ratio is 36 and the stock has returned an uninspiring 1.6 per cent for the past 12 months.

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– Som Seif

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How owning or renting plays into retirement

‘Housing is the single line most likely to make or break a Canadian retirement,’ expert says

BARBARA BALFOUR

ANALYSIS

For decades, a central assumption of retirement planning was to pay off the mortgage before leaving the work force, eliminating one of the largest monthly expenses. But for a growing number of Canadians, that no longer applies. Older renters can face housing costs that rise throughout retirement, while homeowners entering their later years with mortgages, lines of credit, condo fees or expensive repairs are discovering that owning a property doesn’t necessarily mean inexpensive housing. Advisers say that means treating housing as a central part of retirement planning rather than an expense that will eventually take care of itself. “Housing is the single line most likely to make or break a Canadian retirement, and it’s the one most standard plans treat as an afterthought,” says Stefanie Ricchio, an independent chartered professional accountant and financial coach in Bolton, Ont. The divide is no longer simply between people who own and those who rent, she says. It’s between retirees whose housing costs and assets have been realis-



PIXELONESTOCKER/GETTY IMAGES

tically incorporated into their financial plans and those relying on assumptions inherited from a different housing market. “Security now comes from flexibility and liquidity, not tenure,” Ms. Ricchio says. “Owners need to stop treating a paid-off home as ‘free’ and start treating equity as a plannable asset.” Ms. Ricchio recalls a retired client whose long-time rent fit comfortably within her budget until she had to leave her unit. When she looked for another apartment in the same area, rents had risen so substantially that her Canada Pension Plan and Old Age Security benefits could no longer support remaining in the city without drawing considerably more from her registered retirement income fund. “The discussion became more about how to make her savings last until the end of her life versus trying to force herself to stay in the city she could no longer afford to be in,” Ms. Ricchio says.

John Panago, a financial planner in Vancouver, has seen the same arithmetic. One client considering a move from an older, rent-protected apartment charging about \$1,600 a month discovered a newer unit would cost \$2,250 a month, an increase of \$7,800 annually. “This adds to the monthly retirement expense, which can take away from vacations and entertainment budgets,” Mr. Panago says. To address those possibilities, Ms. Ricchio builds her clients’ retirement plans differently from the outset. A lifelong renter may need a larger liquid portfolio, an explicit assumption for annual rent increases and greater attention to guaranteed income, she says. She might also use a more conservative withdrawal rate and preserve tax-free savings account assets as a buffer against higher housing expenses later in life. Meanwhile, a mortgage-free

homeowner possesses something the renter doesn’t: an asset that can potentially be sold, downsized or borrowed against. Ms. Ricchio describes two 66-year-old clients with similar careers and roughly \$400,000 each in savings. One owned a paid-off house and was able to downsize, releasing six figures of equity into the retirement plan. The other paid \$2,400 a month in rent. “Same savings, completely different sustainability,” she says. “The owner’s home was a second, hidden pension.” That doesn’t mean home ownership automatically leads to a safer retirement. Case in point: Fazaad Bacchus, a financial adviser with Desjardins Financial Security Independent Network in Mississauga, worked with a retired condo owner who was unexpectedly handed a roughly \$40,000 special assessment for replacement windows, payable over five years. She had to increase withdrawals from her retirement savings to cover it. Another client had retired from her full-time career as a massage therapist and continued working part-time. She and her spouse had borrowed against their home to renovate when interest rates were low. As interest rates increased, their interest costs almost doubled. “As a result, she was forced to return to full-time work to help meet the increased monthly payments, delaying the retirement lifestyle she had originally planned,” Mr. Bacchus says. Homeowners still need to budget for property taxes, insurance, maintenance, condo or strata

fees and major repairs, says Vicki Chatterley, senior wealth adviser with Inspire Wealth Management at Raymond James Ltd. in Delta, B.C. As clients age, they may also have to pay for cleaning, yard work, transportation and home maintenance. “The key consideration is cash flow, not simply whether someone rents, has a mortgage or owns a mortgage-free home,” Ms. Chatterley says. Selling a home and becoming a renter can sometimes improve a retiree’s position. She points to two clients: one who remained in a mortgaged home while the other sold, invested the proceeds and rented. The homeowner benefited from appreciation but continued paying ownership expenses. The renter benefited from investment growth and used some of the proceeds for travel and other retirement goals. “By converting home equity earlier, the renter gained greater liquidity and lifestyle flexibility,” she says. Housing decisions can become particularly consequential after divorce or the death of a spouse, when expenses that were previously supported by two incomes suddenly fall on one person. Ms. Chatterley encourages clients to begin thinking about housing well before circumstances force their hand. Planning a move before the age of 80 can be a useful benchmark, she says, because waiting for a health or mobility crisis can reduce the choices drastically.

Special to The Globe and Mail

Can stocks stay hot while bonds burn?

JAMIE MCGEEVER ORLANDO

OPINION

There is a conundrum at the heart of U.S. financial markets right now, it seems. Bond market fears are reaching fever pitch, catapulting Treasury yields to their highest levels in at least 20 years, yet the Nasdaq and S&P 500 are hitting record peaks. What gives? Investors could be forgiven for doing a double take. Boosted by the frenzied optimism around the AI-driven corporate profit outlook, the S&P 500 is up around 15 per cent and the Nasdaq is up almost 20 per cent this calendar year, even though the benchmark 10-year yield has spiked 120 basis points and the yield on ultralong U.S. bonds is at a 24-year high. Soaring borrowing costs and a higher discount rate are typically red flags for stocks. Indeed, history shows that the rising cost of money almost always plays a significant role in severe economic and financial downturns, recessions, and market crashes. So equity investors have reason to be very cautious, especially given the market’s historic concentration in a handful of artificial intelligence and tech stocks. But it’s important to ask why bond yields are spiking. The last time yields moved this much was in 2022 when the Federal Reserve cranked up interest rates aggressively to tackle the postlockdown inflation whoosh

that was then amplified by Russia’s invasion of Ukraine. The 10-year yield leaped an eye-popping 235 basis points that year, and the S&P 500 slumped 20 per cent. Back then, sky-high inflation was the big concern. That doesn’t appear to be the case this time around, although inflation is still above target. If Treasuries were being trounced primarily because of inflation indignation or even fiscal fears, one might expect to see a steeper yield curve and a spike in market-based inflation expectations. Neither has materialized. Break-even inflation rates on five- and 10-year Treasury Inflation-Protected Securities (TIPS) are comfortably below their peaks from May, and the difference between short- and longer-dated yields has shrunk across most parts of the curve this year. Instead, the primary driver of the rise in bond yields appears to be inflation-adjusted “real” yields, a sign that investors are pricing in strong real growth. As Cullen Roche, founder and CIO at Discipline Funds, put it, “The bond vigilantes keep showing up expecting a funeral, but it turns out they walked into a growth party.” And if bond yields continue to remain elevated because of robust growth projections and not spiking inflation expectations or other risks, Wall Street could keep on dancing. The divergence between Wall Street and Treasuries is so extreme that many fund managers say it is time to buy bonds. Ac-

cording to Bank of America, the 10-year rolling return for Treasuries with a maturity of 15 years or more fell to negative 2 per cent last month. That’s the worst return in more than a century. And right now, investors can lock in real, inflation-adjusted yields of nearly 3 per cent over the next decade, and 3.5 per cent over the next three decades. These are generationally high, essentially guaranteed rates of return. Will this pull capital away from equities? Perhaps, but investors seeking to build a more balanced portfolio may not have better opportunities to do so. One major threat remains for both bonds and stocks: the term premium. That’s the amorphous degree of extra risk compensation bond buyers demand for buying longer-term debt instead of short-term paper. Sharp, upward spikes in the term premium suggest factors other than growth and inflation, such as doubts around central bank credibility or debt debasement fears, are driving yields higher. The 10-year U.S. term premium this week has snapped to a new 12-year high of 96 basis points, according to the New York Fed’s closely watched Adrian, Crump, and Moench (ACM) model. It’s never clear what is driving the term premium at any particular time, or the ripple effect it will have across markets. But if it continues rising, Wall Street’s party could soon be over.

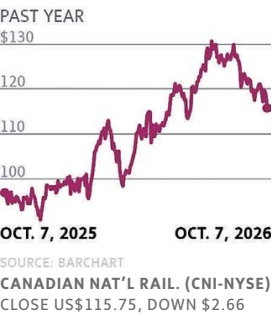
REUTERS

TSX posts steepest decline in four months

Canada’s benchmark stock index fell the most in four months on Wednesday as investors weighed elevated bond yields and trade uncertainty, with financial and metal mining shares leading declines. The S&P/TSX Composite Index ended down 607.65 points, or 1.7 per cent, at 35,041.86, its steepest decline since June 5 and the lowest closing level in two-and-a-half months. Wall Street also closed lower after both the S&P 500 and Nasdaq reached record highs on Tuesday. The U.S. 10-year benchmark, a global benchmark for long-term borrowing costs, touched a fresh 24-year high before clawing back some of their increase on a strong auction of new bonds. By late afternoon, yields on both the U.S. 10-year and the Canada 10-year bond were up a modest 1 to 2 basis points. The TSX materials sector declined 2.9 per cent as gold dropped to a two-month low. A stronger U.S. dollar, along with elevated U.S. Treasury yields, reduced the appeal of the non-yielding metal. Heavily weighted financials were down 2.3 per cent as major bank stocks posted declines. It included a 3.3-per-cent drop for the shares of Toronto-Dominion Bank. U.S. President Donald Trump said Wednesday that Canada has been difficult to deal with as his administration seeks to reach a new trade agreement with Ottawa. “As this tariff uncertainty continues, you’re going to see more and more downward pressure materialize for consumers and businesses and that’s going to weigh down on financials,” said Michael Dehal, a senior portfolio manager at Dehal Investment Partners at Raymond James. Industrials lost 1.65 per cent and energy ended 0.75 per cent lower. US crude oil futures settled down 1.3 per cent at US\$88.28 a barrel after the International Energy Agency agreed to speed up a release of oil stocks and prioritize diesel in a bid to curb record-high fuel prices as the Iran war squeezes global supplies. Iran war-related supply concerns have led to soaring oil prices, which in turn have revived inflation worries and raised the chances of a prolonged central bank rate hiking cycle. Those concerns, combined with mounting corporate and sovereign debt levels, have caused a global bond selloff.

REUTERS, GLOBE STAFF

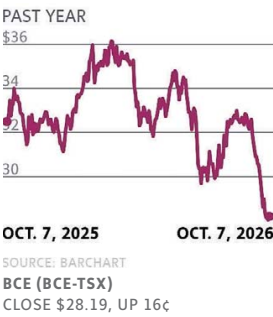
EYE ON EQUITIES DAVID LEEDER



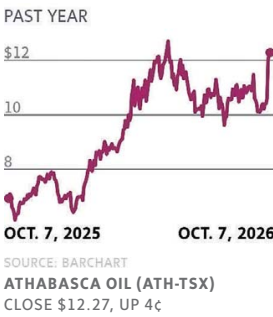
Citi analyst Ariel Rosa thinks recent share price declines across North America’s transportation industry have “created a more favorable risk-reward set-up” heading into third-quarter earnings season. While he warns macro risks, including higher fuel prices and rising interest rates, will likely “keep many investors cautious,” he emphasizes companies across his coverage have “sounded generally positive.” **Target:** Mr. Rosa lowered his **Canadian National Railway Co.** target to US\$143 from US\$151 with a “buy” rating. Consensus is US\$138.68.



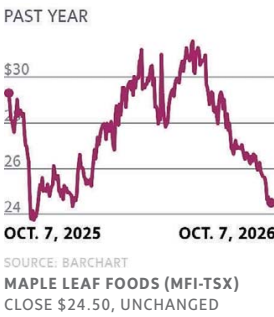
TD Cowen analyst John Mould thinks **Canadian Utilities Ltd.’s** \$14.3-billion combination with **Emera Inc.** provides its shareholders with “ownership in a larger, more diversified utility platform with meaningful exposure to both Florida and Alberta, which are amongst North America’s most attractive utility jurisdictions.” **Target:** He moved his rating for Canadian Utilities to “buy” from “hold” previously with a \$57 target, up from \$52. Consensus is \$54.33.



Desjardins Securities analyst Jerome Dubreuil expects third-quarter results from Canadian telecommunications companies to “reflect the continued impact from low population growth, strong competitive intensity and slight pressure on activation fees due to a CRTC decision” **Target:** Calling **BCE Inc.** “a catalyst-rich data centre story,” Mr. Dubreuil trimmed his target for its shares to \$41 from \$43, keeping a “buy” rating. Consensus is \$37.30.



National Bank Financial analyst Dan Payne sees **Athabasca Oil Corp.’s** \$5.7-billion cash and stock deal to be acquired by Cenovus Energy Inc. as a “a strong culmination of value creation by the ATH team, with solid metrics and premium, a reflection of the significance of execution throughout the cycle in establishing a large, scalable resource with upside.” **Target:** He moved Athabasca to “tender” from “outperform” and reduced his target to \$12 from \$13.75. Consensus is \$12.81.



Desjardins Securities analyst Chris Li thinks the 11-per-cent drop in share price endured by **Maple Leaf Foods Inc.** since the release of its second-quarter results in mid-August “is too punitive,” expecting it “to carve a path to delivering a strong end to the year as volumes begin to recover in Prepared Foods.” **Target:** Reaffirming his “buy” rating, Mr. Li trimmed his target to \$36 from \$39. Consensus is \$35.90.

S&P/TSX COMPOSITE INDEX



S&P 500



DOW JONES INDUSTRIAL AVERAGE



S&P GLOBAL 100 INDEX



TSX INDEXES AND SUB INDEXES

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
TSX COMPOSITE IND	35041.86	-607.65	-1.70	250729	10.50
TSX 60 INDEX	2064.92	-34.14	-1.63	119740	11.02
TSX COMPLETION I	2255.14	-46.56	-2.02	130988	8.44
TSX SMALLCAP INDE	1401.46	-26.07	-1.81	92024	17.96
TSX VENTURE COMPO	877.17	-12.95	-1.45	51548	-11.19
TSX CONSUMER DISC	381.01	-1.81	-0.47	3692	-0.42
TSX CONSUMER STAP	1226.52	8.79	0.72	5121	-0.94
TSX FINANCIALS CA	442.67	-3.34	-0.75	50946	47.35
TSX HEALTH CARE C	717.81	-16.89	-2.30	39061	14.39
TSX INDUSTRIALS C	21.92	0.21	0.97	2284	0.09
TSX REAL ESTATE C	484.35	-8.15	-1.65	16573	3.72
TSX INFORMATION T	347.10	-4.34	-1.23	10364	6.28
TSX MATERIALS CAP	289.54	-1.66	-0.57	7147	-8.48
TSX GLOBAL GOLD I	863.91	-26.53	-2.98	118842	5.73
TSX GLOBAL MINING	239.06	-6.72	-2.73	311996	14.05
TSX INFO TRUST	227.89	0.12	0.05	8313	3.48
TSX PREFERRED SHA	699.14	2.47	0.35	1836	0.42
TSX COMMUNICATION	134.84	0.76	0.57	18153	-14.04
TSX UTILITIES CAP	381.86	-1.01	-0.26	18488	8.39

TSX VOLUME

TOP 20 FOR STOCKS \$1 OR MORE

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
TD TORONTO-DOMINI	162.43	-5.63	-3.35	12696	25.56
ATH ATHABASCA OIL	12.27	0.04	0.33	11754	74.54
T TELUS CORPORATI	11.34	0.15	1.34	9439	-37.31
XIU ISHARES SP TS	52.19	-0.85	-1.60	7783	11.07
CVE CENOVUS ENERG	43.67	-0.79	-1.78	7224	88.07
CNQ CDN NATURAL R	67.80	-0.68	-0.99	7193	45.84
MFC MANULIFE FIN	59.51	-1.53	-2.51	6067	19.40
BB BLACKBERRY LIM	12.51	-1.14	-8.35	5092	141.51
BCE BCE INC	28.19	0.16	0.57	5057	-13.90
BTE BAYTEX ENERGY	6.54	-0.14	-2.10	4879	47.30
WCP WHITECAP RESO	18.08	-0.14	-0.77	4647	57.22
ENB ENBRIDGE INC	65.43	-0.77	-1.16	4351	-0.38
HNU BETAPRO NAT G	9.08	0.50	5.83	4105	-44.29
TRP TC ENERGY COR	84.00	-1.57	-1.83	4091	11.14
EMA EMERA INCORPO	65.36	-0.95	-1.43	3942	-3.37
IVN IVANHOF MINES	11.61	-0.30	-2.52	3761	-25.62
BNS BANK OF NOVA	12.29	-3.95	-3.08	3555	22.78
K KINROSS GOLD CO	33.04	-0.84	-2.48	3399	-14.54
DMJ DENISON MINES	3.66	-0.21	-5.43	3287	0.55
AQN ALGONQUIN POW	7.23	0.02	0.28	3030	-14.34

TSX 52-WEEK HIGHS

STOCKS \$1 OR MORE

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
ABBV ABBVIE CDR (	37.70	0.67	1.81	2	16.36
ALC ALGOMA CENTRA	26.33	2.43	10.17	57	39.31
ANET ARISTA NETWO	38.60	0.00	0.00	15	61.44
BCE-PR-K BCE INC	22.81	-0.03	-0.13	22	14.05
HWO HIGH ARCTIC E	1.17	0.00	0.00	9	39.29

TSX 52-WEEK LOWS

STOCKS \$1 OR MORE

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
INCM-U ACCELERATE	8.79	-0.26	-2.87		-19.14
ATS ATS CORPORATI	25.37	-0.59	-2.27	266	-32.90
BYD BOYD GROUP SE	109.70	0.09	0.08	108	-49.82
BGI-UN BROOKFIELD	5.52	-0.15	-2.65	22	-30.57
HOM-U BSR REAL ES	10.77	0.07	0.65	6	-14.18
BTB-UN BTB REIT U	3.58	-0.01	-0.28	99	-12.32
BNK BUNKER HILL	3.55	-0.22	-6.16	35	-59.78
CADY CADILLAC MIN	5.35	-0.38	-6.63	312	-24.44
CGI COLLIERIES INT	122.44	-2.17	-1.74	201	-39.31
YCM-PR-A COMMERCE	5.14	-0.03	-0.58	9	-0.96
EFN ELEMENT FLEET	21.65	-0.49	-2.21	1636	-39.94
EFR ENERGY FUELS	14.65	-1.32	-8.27	1243	-26.31
FSZ FIERA CAPITAL	4.06	-0.07	-1.69	225	-34.52
FC FIRM CAPITAL M	10.63	-0.32	-2.92	175	-9.30
ASME HARVEST ASML	12.33	-0.26	-2.07	3	-0.96
INTE HARVEST INTE	11.79	-0.40	-3.34	1	-6.13
MUHE HARVEST MICR	12.60	0.60	5.00	50	0.64
HIMS HERMES CDR (	14.41	-0.14	-0.96	-40	-58.34
LI LABRADOR IRON	22.30	-1.03	-4.41	340	-25.58
LAC LITHIUM AMERI	3.43	-0.17	-4.72	1334	-42.55

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
MGFI MIDDLEFIELD	10.19	0.17	1.70	3	1.70
PLTU SAVVYLONG 2X	37.60	0.44	1.18	6	58.12
TWM TIDEWATER MID	25.26	0.96	3.95	163	380.23
VLE VALEURA ENERG	16.02	0.72	4.71	753	95.84

TSX GAINERS

TOP 20 FOR STOCKS \$1 OR MORE

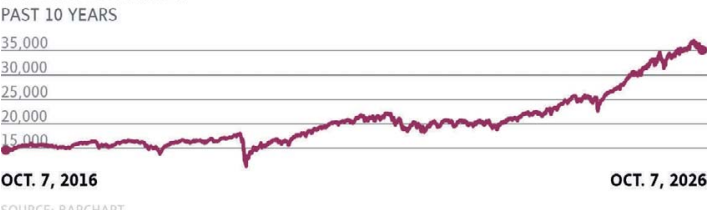
	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
COID SAVVYSHORT -	4.15	0.54	14.96	5	-72.80
DSND SAVVYSHORT -	1.95	0.24	14.04	52	-90.99
DMD DYE AND DURHA	1.32	0.13	10.92	59	-68.35
ALC ALGOMA CENTRA	26.33	2.43	10.17	57	39.31
RUA RUA GOLD INC	1.45	0.12	9.02	71	16.00
CGMD MEGASHORT -3	6.19	0.48	8.41	15	-70.10
MUJ SAVVYLONG 2X	18.99	1.40	7.96	472	-15.60
CMCK-B CI GALAXY	18.21	1.31	7.75	1	15.11
RM ROXMORE RESOUR	5.35	0.35	7.00	539	148.84
GDXD BETAPRO CDN	8.97	0.53	6.28	407	-45.10
SIVD BETAPRO SILV	36.03	2.11	6.22	41	-47.39
GSU SAVVYLONG GE	6.35	0.35	5.83	12	-43.05
TSX INFORMATION T	9.08	0.50	5.83	4105	-44.29
GIAI GUARDIAN B	24.48	1.33	5.75	6	26.32
CSGI COSCIENS BIO	9.18	0.48	5.52	1	7.75
ECO ECOSYNTHETIX	1.86	0.09	5.08	11	-53.50
MUHE HARVEST MICR	12.60	0.60	5.00	50	0.64
KITS KITS EYECARE	17.50	0.80	4.79	187	-4.53
VLE VALEURA ENERG	16.02	0.72	4.71	753	95.84
CFOD BETAPRO SP T	12.26	0.53	4.52	31	-28.01

TSX LOSERS

TOP 20 FOR STOCKS \$1 OR MORE

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
MSU SAVVYLONG 2X	39.60	-6.14	-13.42	242	-52.63
XNDU XANADU QUANT	6.41	-0.80	-11.01	1077	-60.01
CBCX CI GALAXY BL	43.11	-4.74	-9.91		3.88
CGMU MEGALONG 3X	7.87	-0.82	-9.44	295	-47.20
VGC VALOR GOLD CO	2.72	-0.28	-9.33	220	-63.24
WJX WAJAX CORPORA	35.98	-3.62	-9.14	129	32.09
FUJ FORTUNA MININ	14.44	-1.44	-9.07	1711	7.36
COIU SAVVYLONG 2X	23.79	-2.29	-8.78	1	-63.51
NDM NORTHERN DYNA	1.69	-0.16	-8.65	872	-37.41
BB BLACKBERRY LIM	12.51	-1.14	-8.35	5092	141.51
BNKU MEGALONG 3X	18.83	-1.70	-8.28	25	67.38
EFR ENERGY FUELS	14.65	-1.32	-8.27	1243	-26.31
CCOU SAVVYLONG 2X	16.14	-1.45	-8.24	7	-24.15
IAU I 80 GOLD COR	2.12	-0.18	-7.83	1313	4.95
MAJ MINING AMERIC	5.00	-0.39	-7.24	425	-5.66
HSTR	2.32	-0.18	-7.20	599	
HSIV HIGHLANDER S	6.86	-0.52	-7.05	877	29.19
GRA NANOXPLOR IN	1.33	-0.10	-6.99	326	-48.05
EDT SPECTRAL MEDI	1.08	-0.08	-6.90	59	-25.00
MSTR STRATEGY CDR	10.42	-0.77	-6.88	331	-1.51

TSX COMPOSITE INDEX



S&P/TSX COMPOSITE INDEX STOCKS

LARGEST STOCKS BY MARKET CAPITALIZATION

	CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG		CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG		CLOSE	NET CHG	% CHG	VOL 000s	YTD %CHG
VNP 5N PLUS INC.	31.57	-0.85	-2.62	477	78.16	CEU CES ENERGY SO	18.05	-0.19	-1.04	391	47.11	JWL JAMIESON WEL	45.45	0.00	0.00	139	35.07
ABRA ABRASILVER R	11.47	-0.52	-4.34	1190	7.40	CSH-UN CHARTWELL	19.44	0.00	0.00	517	-3.28	SIA SIENNA SENIOR	19.33	-0.10	-0.51	534	-5.38
AAV ADVANTAGE ENE	10.31	-0.21	-2.00	730	-12.18	CIP-UN CHOICE PRO	14.65	0.02	0.14	459	-1.08	SVM SILVERCORP ME	14.34	-0.59	-3.95	393	24.91
AER AECON GROUP I	54.11	-3.34	-5.81	652	72.99	CGX COGECO COMMUN	52.50	0.68	1.31	335	-21.02	SKE SKEENA RESOUR	43.48	-1.14	-2.55	373	33.37
AEM AGNICO EAGLE	257.21	-7.39	-2.79	620	10.50	CIGI COLLIERIES INT	122.44	-2.17	-1.74	201	-39.31	SRL-UN SMARTCENTR	26.19	-0.13	-0.49	212	1.71
AC AIR CANADA	25.00	-0.78	-3.03	2773	29.60	CSST CONSTELLATION	2901.98	-48.66	-1.65	38	-12.10	SGD SNOWLINE GOLD	15.10	-1.10	-6.79	345	-13.02
AGI ALAMOS GOLD I	44.94	-1.65	-3.54	618	-15.21	CRUN CROMBIE RE	15.63	-0.05	-0.32	190	2.36	SOBO SOUTH BOW CO	47.58	-0.10	-0.20	342	26.04
AQN ALGONQUIN POW	7.23	0.02	0.28	3030	-14.34	CURA CURALEAF HOL	14.06	-0.16	-1.13	257	37.44	SKGC SOUTHERN CRO	10.64	-0.36	-3.27	389	0.47
ATD ALIMENTATION	7.11	-0.05	-0.06	1156	2.87	DFV DEFINITY FINA	66.27	-0.50	-0.75	197	-12.72	SLF SPARTAN DELTA	13.35	-0.02	-0.15	548	84.14
AAUC ALLIED GOLD	27.93	-0.81	-2.82	678	-11.19	DMJ DENISON MINES	3.66	-0.21	-5.43	3287	0.55	SLP SPROIT INC	164.03	-1.96	-3.51	22	22.01
AP-UN ALLIED PROP	6.10	-0.03	-0.49	1128	-54.38	DSV DESCARTES SYS	114.07	2.28	2.04	257	-5.27	SSRM STR MINING I	46.71	-1.97	-4.05	216	55.23
ALTA ALTAGAS LTD.	54.40	-0.12	-0.22	856	29.99	DSV DISCOVERY MIN	11.41	-0.41	-3.47	2870	36.16	STN STANTEC INC	95.18	-0.91	-0.95	556	-26.51
ALS ALTIUS MINERA	64.97	-1.02	-1.55	179	59.08	DOL DOLLARAMA INC	185.37	-0.66	-0.35	636	-9.64	SJ STELLA JONES I	64.26	-0.62	-0.96	206	-24.52
AIF ALTUS GROUP L	44.90	0.26	0.58	106	-20.83	DPM DPM METALS IN	52.00	-2.51	-4.60	1352	25.58	SCR STRATHCONA RE	39.90	-0.30	-0.75	573	40.84
USA AMERICAS GOLD	5.94	-0.42	-6.60	1684	-15.62	DRUN DREAM INDU	12.71	0.06	0.47	1045	1.03	SLF SUN LIFE FINA	30.21	-2.27	-2.05	1372	26.30
ARIS ARIS MINING	24.28	-0.82	-3.27	460	9.07	EQB EQB INC	118.82	-2.93	-2.41	71	14.37	SP SUNCOR ENERGY	97.26	0.21	0.22	2309	59.65
ATZ ARTIZIA INC	123.28	2.04	1.68	776	5.05	EFR ENERGY FUELS	14.65	-1.32	-8.27	1243	-26.31	SRP SUPERIOR PLUS	7.00	-0.12	-1.69	458	-0.57
ACO-X ATCO LTD. C	81.91	0.89	1.10	1012	45.28	EQX EQUINOX GOLD	15.58	-0.56	-3.47	2247	-19.23	TRP TC ENERGY COR	84.00	-1.57	-1.83	4091	11.14
ATH ATHABASCA OIL	12.27	0.04	0.33	11754	74.54	ERD ELEMENT FLEET	21.65	-0.49	-2.21	1636	-39.94	TX TMX GROUP LIMIT	51.70	-0.73	-1.39	384	-1.01
ATRL ATKINSRLES	85.38	-2.01	-2.30	543	-3.63	EMA EMERA INCORPO	65.36	-0.95	-1.43	3942	-3.37	TVE TAMEXAC VALL	13.31	0.00	0.00	2045	66.79
ATS ATS CORPORATI	25.37	-0.59	-2.27	266	-32.90	EMP-A EMPIRE COMP	48.87	0.57	1.18	513	2.41	TECK-B TECK RESOU	93.26	-2.12	-2.22	966	41.93
AVM AVINO SILVER	7.62	-0.29	-3.67	449	-10.77	ENB ENBRIDGE INC	65.43	-0.77	-1.16	4351	-0.38	T ELUS CORPORATI	11.34	0.15	1.34	9439	-37.31
AYA AYVA GOLD	37.32	-1.73	-4.43	919	90.02	ENR ENDEAVOUR SIL	11.86	-0.45	-3.66	1123	-8.13	TVI TERRAVEST IND	110.87	-0.63	-0.57	40	-32.61
						EFF ENERFLEX LTD	33.82	-0.84	-2.42	456	59.83	THI TPI INTERNAT	160.32	-1.48	-0.91	514	13.30
BTO B2GOLD CORP.	7.12	-0.27	-3.65	2875	15.21	EFF ENERGY FUELS	14.65	-1.32	-8.27	1243	-26.31	NWC THE NORTH WES	54.79	0.26	0.48	136	11.20
BCE BCE INC.	28.19	0.16	0.57	5057	-13.90	EQX EQUINOX GOLD	15.58	-0.56	-3.47	2247	-19.23	TRX TOREX ENERGY	141.76	2.28	1.63	488	-21.74
BDGI BADGER INFRA	93.15	-0.36	-3.88	108	27.38	ERO ERO COPPER CO	52.38	-1.52	-2.82	357	34.90	TPZ TOPAZ ENERGY	28.11	-0.39	-1.37	368	2.07
BMO BANK OF MONTB	230.72	-5.48	-2.32	1669	29.48	EIF EXCHANGE INCO	117.02	-1.71	-1.44	118	42.78	TH THOMSON REUTE	51.39	-2.11	-2.88	672	8.56
BNS BANK OF NOVA	124.29	-3.95	-3.08	3555	22.78	EIX EXTENDICARE I	27.79	1.11	4.16	556	30.16	TH TOROMONT IND	217.00	-5.13	-5.71	379	30.68
ABX BARRICK MININ	55.84	-2.11	-3.64	2057	-6.61							TO TORONTO-DOMINI	162.43	-5.63	-3.33	12696	25.56
BHC BAUSCH HEALTH	8.79	0.23	2.69	418	-7.76	FFH FAIRFAX FINAN	2199.92	-12.21	-0.55	41	-15.90	TOU TOUTALMINE OI	62.56	-0.35	-0.56	1597	1.61
BTE BAYTEX ENERGY	6.54	-0.14	-2.10	4879	47.50	FTI FINNING INTL	106.67	-5.33	-4.76	395	43.43	TA TRANSALTA CORP	18.36	-0.27	-1.45	1364	5.76
BRB BRICHLIFF EN	6.61	-0.09	-1.34	1167	-11.31	FCR-UN FIRST CAPR	22.96	0.08	0.35	190	21.48	TKO TREKOR METALS	12.15	-0.38	-3.03	1031	-56.37
BDT BIRD CONSTRUC	82.17	-0.84	-1.05	355	188.11	FA FIRST MAJESTIC	23.75	-1.21	-4.85	1911	3.71	TFM TRIPLE FLAG	42.96	-0.68	-1.56	107	5.81
BLK BLACKBERRY LIM	12.51	-1.14	-9.35	4614	141.51	FM FIRST QUANTUM	38.52	-1.43	-3.58	2993	4.67	TSU TRISURA GROUP	40.57	-0.37	-0.90	40	-4.03
BEI-UN BOARDWALK	60.38	-0.75	-1.23	38	-6.36	FV FIRSTSERVICE	19.95	-2.17	-19.91	91	-15.23						
BBB-B BOMBARDIER	299.60	-4.67	-1.53	136	23.31	FVS FORTIS INC	75.66	0.41	0.54	2091	6.03	OR OR ROYALITES I	48.32	-0.68	-1.39	150	-0.62
BYD-B BOYD GROUP SE	109.70	0.09	0.08	108	-49.82	FTI FORTUNA MININ	14.44	-1.44	-9.07	171	7.36	OCG OCEANAGOLD I	37.68	-0.40	-1.05	614	-3.14
BAM BROOKFIELD AS	63.51	-0.78	-1.21	1198	-11.67	FVU FRESCO-NEVADA	339.13	-7.71	-2.22	293	19.20	ONEX ONEX CORPORA	103.39	-1.57	-1.50	85	-8.47
BBC BROOKFIELD B	37.03	-0.09	-0.24	67	-24.51	FRN FREEDHOLD RLY	16.58	-0.06	-0.36	454	9.15	OTEX OPEN TEXT CO	33.00	0.70	2.17	862	-26.17
BN BROOKFIELD COR	52.71	-0.27	-0.51	2609	-16.36							PAAS PAN AMERICAN	63.22	-2.12	-3.24	626	-11.16
BIP-UN BROOKFIELD	53.44	-0.32	-0.60	561	12.01	GMIN G MINING VEN	48.32	-1.30	-2.62	651	16.46	POU PARAMOUNT RES	31.46	-0.22	-0.70	276	30.05
BEP-UN BROOKFIELD	42.04	0.28	0.67	486	13.35	GFL GFL ENVIRONME	59.95	-0.55	-0.91	767	1.68	PXT PEARSE RESOURC	27.42	-0.09	-0.33	359	48.62
DOO BRP INC	79.32	-0.49	-0.61	287	-18.27	GIG GIBSON ENERGY	31.45	-0.37	-1.16	444	25.20	PEM PEMBLA PIPEL	65.58	-0.79	-1.19	1900	25.42
						GIL GILDAN ACTIVE	58.81	-0.46	-0.78	656	-31.45	PPA PERPETUA RES	28.47	-0.86	-2.93	62	-14.32
CAR-UN CDN APARTM	31.07	-0.35	-1.11	510	-15.73	GRT-UN GRANITE RE	83.01	-0.31	-1.55	131	1.59	PEY PEYTO EXPLORA	23.82	-0.01	-0.04	594	4.89
CNQ CDN NATURAL R	67.80	-0.68	-0.99	7193	45.84	GWO GREAT-WEAT L	87.56	-1.51	-1.70	724	29.37	POW POWER CORPORA	87.69	-1.55	-1.74	1571	20.21
GIB-A CGI INC	98.29	-0.66	-0.67	607	-22.47							PSK PRAIRIESKY RO	33.16	-0.15	-0.45	327	22.80
CRT-UN CRT REAL ES	17.01	0.05	0.29	133	4.55	HPS-A HAMMOND POW	293.28	-4.72	-1.58	38	83.90	PBH PREMIUM BRAND	70.38	-0.13	-0.18	217	-30.68
CAE CAE INC	33.01	-0.68	-2.02	728	-20.92	HWX HEADWATER EXP	13.52	0.06	0.45	421	44.29	PMZ-UN PRIMARIS R	21.75	0.06	0.28	401	39.51
CCO CAMECO CORP	126.96	-5.31	-4.01	1145	1.00	HRN HR REAL EST	9.26	0.03	0.33	1164	-9.48	QBR-B QUEBECOR IN	64.41	-0.40	-0.62	916	24.58
CM CANADIAN IMPER	154.57	-0.48	-2.57	2023	24.22	HMU HUDBAY MINERA	36.87	-1.51	-3.93	1925	35.30						
CNR CANADIAN NATI	164.99	-3.35	-1.99	1317	21.54	H HYDRO ONE LIMIT	50.83	-0.43	-0.84	1331	-6.97	RBA RB GLOBAL INC	114.69	-0.39	-0.34	233	-18.84
CP CANADIAN PACIF	119.18	-2.26	-1.86	1467	17.94							QSR RESTAURANT BR	99.07	-0.85	-0.85	539	5.78
CTCA CANADIAN TIT	190.11	-0.48	-0.77	162	9.30	IAU I 80 GOLD CORP	2.12	-1.08	-7.83	1313	4.95	RCH RICHELIEU HAR	34.68	-0.69	-1.95	98	-12.34
CP CANADIAN UTILI	49.85	-0.35	-0.70	1313	16.66	IGAG IA GOLD FINAN	201.99	-1.94	-0.95	317	13.59	REI-UN RIOCAN REA	20.39	0.01	0.05	887	9.04
CPK CAPITAL POWER	64.29	-0.20	-0.31	500	9.80	IMG IAMGOLD CORP	25.73	-0.67	-2.54	1135	13.60	RCH-R ROGERS COMM	43.77	0.39	0.90	2404	-15.52
CS CAPSTONE CORPE	13.42	-0.44	-3.06	1025	1.16	IGM IGM FINANCIAL	82.03	-0.63	-0.75	127	4.25	RY ROYAL BANK OF	272.82	-6.37	-2.28	2204	16.59
CRJ CARQUEST INC	86.26	-1.32	-1.51	109	2.76	IMO IMPERIAL OIL	10.57	-0.53	-2.03	901	43.68	RUS RUSSEL METALS	88.27	-2.24	-2.47	302	101.53
CCL-B CCL INDUSTR	93.25	-0.78	-0.83	304	7.55	IFC INTACT FINAN	238.72	-0.61	-0.25	493	-16.45						
CLS CELESTICA INC	530.01	-21.78	-3.95	336	30.54	IPCO INTERNATIONAL	34.87	0.03	0.09	81	40.43	SAP SAPUTO INC.	38.51	0.68	1.80	590	-6.78
CVE CENOVUS ENERGY	43.67	-0.79	-1.78	7224	88.07	IVN IVANHOE MINES	11.61	-0.30	-2.52	3761	-25.62	SEA SEABRIDGE GOL	38.00	-1.07	-2.74	62	-6.61
CG CENTERRA GOLD	30.14	-0.75	-2.43	38	52.53							SHO SHOPIFY INC	23.59	2.86	1.27	1969	7.05

[DODGERS VS. BRAVES]



Dodgers cruise into the NLCS

Los Angeles Dodgers outfielder Andy Pages reacts after hitting a two-run single against the Atlanta Braves during Game 4 of the National League Division Series at Truist Park on Wednesday in Atlanta. The Dodgers won 4-1 to clinch the series 3-1 and advance to the NLCS. For more MLB playoff coverage, go to ■ GLOBESPORTS.COM

KEVIN C. COX/GETTY IMAGES

Marsch can get Canadian soccer fans riled up, but can he close his team's talent gap with the U.S.?

CATHAL KELLY



OPINION

The most remarkable thing about Canada's 1-0 soccer loss to the United States on Tuesday night was that it was in any way remarkable.

Ten years ago, a friendly between these two men's teams would have been the equivalent of a solar flare – a blowout so far off everyone's radar that nobody sees it.

Now such encounters are an ongoing measure of our national fighting capacity. Can we avoid being embarrassed by America at a sport they don't care about? Great news – we can. For now.

A friendly match more than three years distant from the next World Cup is about as good a guide post to soccer quality as rolling chicken bones across the floor, but there has to be some fight in the group. Canada fought. Mostly, it was the head coach doing the swinging.

Once again, Jesse Marsch had the spotlight on him and – what a coincidence – he happened to have his top hat and cane handy. Speaking to The Guardian before-



Jesse Marsch, Canada's head coach, reacts to the referee's call during his team's international friendly match against the United States on Tuesday in St. Paul, Minn. STEPHEN MATUREN/GETTY IMAGES

hand, Marsch lit into the United States' behaviour at our recent shared sporting endeavour.

Speaking of U.S. President Donald Trump's role in overturning a red card to Folarin Balogun during the World Cup, Marsch said, "[T]his is why everybody around the world hates America."

Elsewhere: "We, as Americans, have been inundated with propaganda since we were young."

On the one hand, he's right. On the other, has this guy ever en-

countered any sort of attention he didn't feel a powerful need to elbow his way into the centre of?

I'm not suggesting he stop. Please, please, continue. But in order for this to land properly, your team needs to win a couple of big ones. To this point under Marsch, Canada's punching at a welterweight level.

Like Sister Marian used to tell us after we were sent to the office for fighting, it takes two to tango. A real scrap required the co-

operation of the USA's Argentine head coach, Mauricio Pochettino. Someone gave him the opportunity by asking about Marsch's approach.

"I celebrate that we have coaches like Jesse that have pure emotion. I like this," said Pochettino. "In some moments, I was similar. Now I am more mature."

That insult should be studied at The School of Insult Technology. And we haven't even talked about Pochettino's pretend surprise a moment later when he asked the room, "I don't know if I am older than Jesse ... I am younger?"

The subsequent game didn't decide much, but I think we have settled the issue of who, between North and South Americans, is better at insults.

Marsch gets credit for locating the most reliable lever to excite Canada's part-time soccer fans. If he can turn Canada-USA into a larger canvas version of Oilers-Flames, he's onto something.

Pochettino deserves the same credit for deflecting the attempt. It does him no good to be seen volunteering America for a slang-ing match with America Jr.

However, we can now see how the next little while will play out. The Canadian soccer set-up will not attempt to become world class in some abstract way. With Marsch acting as spokesperson, it will have one very focused goal – be at least as good as and hopefully better than the U.S. Meanwhile, America will attempt to shake Canada off its pant leg.

It's a good plan because it's ambitious, but that's not the same thing as saying it can work.

The current Canadian roster remains essentially the same as the one that reached the World Cup round of 16 in July. Some light redecorating, new wallpaper in the locker room, but nothing close to full renos. Because why bother? Getting as far as they did was hailed back home as a generational triumph.

Right after getting hammered by Morocco, Marsch was already working to sell the impression that there is a plan and that it is working. In another example of that pure emotion Pochettino spoke of, he claimed that, "I'd rather be us than them."

As well as World Cup semi-finalists, Morocco are the reigning under-20 world champions. So, I'm not sure what Marsch meant there, and I don't think Marsch did either. But it sounded encouraging.

■ KELLY, B13

Nova Scotia hockey players to learn about consent, hazing

TORI FITZPATRICK HALIFAX

The head of a provincial body that governs organized hockey in Nova Scotia is touting a new educational program that targets players after a series of hazing incidents and assaults have rocked the sport.

"There's been several incidents in hockey over the years and it's been an area of need," said Michael Field, the executive director of Hockey Nova Scotia in an interview.

The organization has teamed up with a local non-profit that provides services to survivors of sexual assault to create the pro-

gram. It aims to teach 13- and 14-year-old players about how to engage in healthy team bonding exercises and how to avoid crossing the line.

"We feel there's a need to educate players on team culture," Field said. "Some teams do a great job at it and some team sports don't. We just want to do all we can to ensure that ... team culture is being built in a healthy manner."

Field said more than 2,000 minor hockey players of all genders will participate in the mandatory program.

It emerged as families and coaches reacted to news reports last February about a hazing incident and sexual assault involving a junior hockey team in Nova Scotia.

A number of them sent e-mails expressing their concerns about the issue to Avalon, the non-profit that is now working with the hockey association, explained Kailee Wakeman, the director of operations at the centre.

Two under-15 minor hockey players in Colchester County, northeast of Halifax, were charged with sexual assault following the incident during a team sleepover last fall.

One of the accused players changed his plea to guilty last month, while the other pleaded not guilty in May.

Wakeman said Avalon hosted a webinar in February to teach parents and coaches how to discuss consent and hazing with young players.

Field said his association then reached out to Avalon to see if it could develop a version of the webinar for players.

Wakeman said the new program aims to teach players how to recognize discrimination, harassment, pressure, hazing and coercion.

"We're hoping ... that we can help change team cultures because sports cultures can often include hazing in ways that people think it strengthens a team and there's so much research that shows that it doesn't," Wakeman said in an interview Wednesday.

The players will participate in two sessions, said Wakeman. The first will teach them about bodily autonomy, respecting boundaries and consent, while the second will teach them how to respond to situations that may cause harm to their teammates.

"So many people call that bystander intervention, but we're going to frame it through the lens of a caring team environment," she said. "Looking out for one another rather than placing each other in harmful situations."

■ CONSENT, B13

Adell and Ramírez keep the Guardians’ season alive

White Sox pack 40,590 into Rate Field for the franchise’s first home playoff game since 2021

JAY COHEN CHICAGO

Jo Adell and José Ramírez powered Cleveland with a pair of two-out triples, and the Guardians avoided an AL Division Series sweep by cooling off the Chicago White Sox with a 9-3 victory in Game 3 on Wednesday.

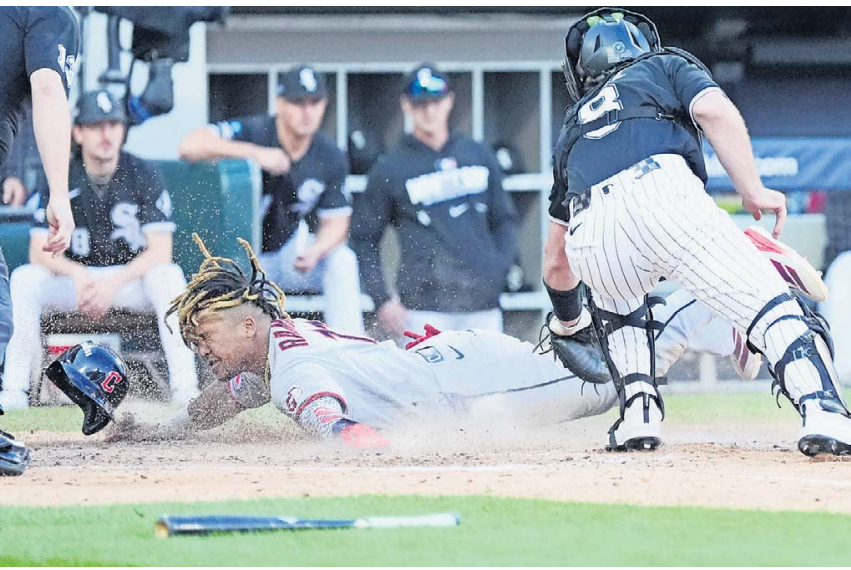
Adell’s three-run triple gave Cleveland a 4-1 lead in the third inning. Ramírez’s three-bagger drove in Travis Bazzana and Patrick Bailey for a 7-3 advantage in the eighth.

“We continued to pile on,” Cleveland manager Stephen Vogt said. “I think that’s been the difference of the first couple games to today was Game 2, we were able to get a couple runs but weren’t able to add on. But really good job by our guys today.”

The Guardians hit two triples in a postseason game for the first time in franchise history. They became the first major league team to accomplish the feat since the Los Angeles Dodgers in Game 1 of the 2024 World Series against the New York Yankees.

Adell, Ramírez, Bailey and Brayan Rocchio each had two of the team’s 11 hits – a complete turnaround for the AL Central champions after they managed just three runs and seven hits in the first two games of the series combined.

Game 4 is Thursday in Chicago, with the White Sox leading 2-1 in the best-of-five matchup. Once again, they’ll try to clinch a postseason series at home for the first time since the 1906 World Series against the



Guardians third baseman José Ramírez scores under the tag of White Sox catcher Kyle Teel during fifth-inning play in Game 3 of the ALDS in the 2026 MLB playoffs at Rate Field in Chicago on Wednesday. Going into Game 4, the White Sox are leading 2-1 in the best-of-five matchup.
DAVID BANKS/REUTERS

Chicago Cubs.

“Today has nothing to do with tomorrow. Nothing,” White Sox catcher Kyle Teel said. “We come ready to go like we always do tomorrow.”

Chicago won its first four games in a surprising postseason appearance after going 60-102 last year. It was backed by a frenzied crowd of 40,590 for the franchise’s first home playoff game since 2021, but there wasn’t much for the fans to cheer in the final innings.

The White Sox struck out 19 times and went 2 for 11 with runners in position. Their bullpen faltered after coming up big in their last postseason start.

“I think there was some stuff we could have played better, but they played good, too,” left-hander Hagen Smith said. “It’s a good team, and we’ll come back tomorrow and fight.”

Chicago jumped in front on Kyle Teel’s RBI double off Daniel Espino with one out in the first. But Espino fanned Chase Meidroth before Foster Griffin struck out Tristan Peters looking, stranding runners on second and third.

Griffin set a franchise record for a reliever with seven strikeouts in 2½ innings. The left-hander allowed one run and two hits in his first appearance since Sept. 23.

“Once we got the momentum going on our side, it was tough to stop it,” said Griffin, who came over in a trade with Washington in August.

Cleveland rallied in the third against Bryan Hudson, who entered after Sean Newcomb pitched two scoreless innings.

Bazzana walked and scored on Steven Kwan’s one-out single to left. Facing Smith with two down

and the bases loaded, Adell grounded a high fastball down the first-base line for a 4-1 lead.

Adell, acquired in an August trade with the Los Angeles Angels, also hit an RBI triple during Cleveland’s 4-3 loss in Game 2. He hit one triple during the regular season in each of the last two years.

“It was huge,” Adell said. “Really just proud of how I kind of cleaned that at-bat up.”

Playing in his 48th postseason game – all with Cleveland – Ramírez manufactured an insurance run for the Guardians in the fifth. He doubled, stole third and scored on Chase DeLauter’s grounder to second, beating Teel’s tag with a headfirst slide.

Ramírez’s savvy baserunning gave the Guardians a 5-2 lead. The seven-time all-star went 0 for 6 with two walks in the first two games of the series.

The 34-year-old Ramírez also made a diving stop on Miguel Vargas’s bases-loaded smash in the sixth, preserving Cleveland’s 5-3 advantage.

“I felt it was a significant shift in momentum in the game when we were able to make that play,” Ramírez said through a translator. “I felt like this is going to be our game.”

UP NEXT

Parker Messick starts for Cleveland in Game 4. Messick permitted two runs and four hits over 4½ innings in the series opener. The left-hander went 12-9 with a 2.56 ERA in 32 starts during the regular season.

Chicago did not announce its pitching plans before the game. Smith started Game 1 for the White Sox, striking out four in 2½ hitless innings.

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

MLB PLAYOFFS

DIVISION SERIES

(Best-of-5. All Times Eastern)

AMERICAN LEAGUE

TAMPA BAY (1) VS. N.Y. YANKEES (4)
(Tampa Bay leads series 2-0)
Wednesday
Tampa Bay at N.Y. Yankees
Thursday
x-Tampa Bay at N.Y. Yankees, 8 p.m.

CLEVELAND (2) VS. CHI. WHITE SOX (6)
(Chicago White Sox lead series 2-0)
Wednesday
Cleveland 9 Chicago White Sox 3
Thursday
Cleveland at Chicago White Sox, 5 p.m.

NATIONAL LEAGUE

MILWAUKEE (1) VS. SAN DIEGO (4)
(Milwaukee leads series 2-1)
Wednesday
Milwaukee at San Diego
Tuesday
San Diego 4 Milwaukee 3
Friday
x-San Diego at Milwaukee, 4:30 p.m.

L.A. DODGERS (2) VS. ATLANTA (3)
(L.A. Dodgers wins series 3-1)
Wednesday
L.A. Dodgers 4 Atlanta 1
Tuesday
L.A. Dodgers 3 Atlanta 1
x—played only if necessary

WNBA PLAYOFF

SEMIFINALS

(Best-of-5. All Times Eastern)
GOLDEN STATE (2) VS. LAS VEGAS (3)
(Golden State leads series 1-0)
Wednesday
Las Vegas at Golden State
Friday
Golden State at Las Vegas, 9:30 p.m.
Sunday, October 11
x-Golden State at Las Vegas, TBA

ATLANTA (4) VS. NEW YORK (8)
(Atlanta leads series 1-0)
Wednesday
New York at Atlanta
Friday
Atlanta at New York, 7:30 p.m.
Sunday, October 11
x-Atlanta at New York, TBA
x—played only if necessary

WNBA PLAYOFF SCORING LEADERS						
Following Sunday's Games						
	GP	FG	FT	Pts	Avg	
A. Wilson, LV	4	39	38	120	30.0	
G. Williams, GS	4	35	15	100	25.0	
S. Citron, Wash	2	14	16	50	25.0	
A. Ognbale, Dal	3	24	27	84	28.3	
B. Stewart, NY	3	23	25	74	24.7	
J. Young, LV	4	24	21	81	20.3	
K. Mitchell, Ind	3	18	18	60	20.3	
C. Clark, Ind	3	21	6	60	20.0	
A. Boston, Ind	3	24	3	59	19.7	

NFL

AMERICAN CONFERENCE

EAST										
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA				
Buffalo	3	1	0	.750	127	107				
New England	2	2	0	.500	65	77				
N.Y. Jets	1	3	0	.250	76	84				
Miami	0	4	0	.000	46	101				
SOUTH										
Jacksonville	3	1	0	.750	104	53				
Indianapolis	2	2	0	.500	102	104				
Tennessee	0	4	0	.000	55	83				
Houston	0	4	0	.000	84	109				
NORTH										
Cleveland	3	1	0	.750	81	95				
Baltimore	3	1	0	.750	116	96				
Pittsburgh	2	2	0	.500	77	87				
Cincinnati	2	2	0	.500	97	85				
WEST										
Kansas City	4	0	0	1.000	118	77				
Las Vegas	3	1	0	.750	115	84				
Denver	2	2	0	.500	74	94				
L.A. Chargers	0	4	0	.000	67	106				

NATIONAL CONFERENCE

EAST										
	W	L	T	Pct	PF	PA				
N.Y. Giants	3	1	0	.750	82	79				
Philadelphia	2	2	0	.500	75	93				
Dallas	2	2	0	.500	122	112				
Washington	1	3	0	.250	88	122				
SOUTH										
Carolina	2	2	0	.500	121	109				
Aflanta	2	2	0	.500	96	92				
New Orleans	1	3	0	.250	105	128				
Tampa Bay	0	4	0	.000	76	96				
NORTH										
Minnesota	4	0	0	1.000	86	51				
Chicago	3	1	0	.750	112	65				
Detroit	2	2	0	.500	119	127				
Green Bay	2	2	0	.500	73	105				
WEST										
San Francisco	4	0	0	1.000	122	64				
Seattle	3	1	0	.750	105	73				
L.A. Rams	2	2	0	.500	85	83				
Arizona	1	3	0	.250	87	117				

WEEK FIVE

Byes: Kansas City, Carolina
Thursday
All Times Eastern

Tampa Bay at Dallas, 8:15 p.m.

Sunday
Philadelphia vs Jacksonville at London, GBR, 9:30 a.m.
Chicago at Green Bay, 1 p.m.
Cincinnati at Miami, 1 p.m.
Cleveland at N.Y. Jets, 1 p.m.
Houston at Tennessee, 1 p.m.
Indianapolis at Pittsburgh, 1 p.m.
Las Vegas at New England, 1 p.m.
Minnesota at New Orleans, 1 p.m.
N.Y. Giants at Washington, 1 p.m.
Denver at L.A. Chargers, 4:05 p.m.
Detroit at Arizona, 4:25 p.m.
San Francisco at Seattle, 4:25 p.m.
Baltimore at Atlanta, 8:20 p.m.

Monday, Oct. 12
Buffalo at L.A. Rams, 8:15 p.m.

RESULTS AS OF WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7, 9:25 P.M.

CFL

EAST DIVISION

	GP	W	L	PF	PA	Pt
y-Montreal	15	12	3	535	420	24
x-Toronto	16	9	7	462	455	18
Hamilton	16	5	11	396	474	10
Ottawa	15	0	15	355	558	0

WEST DIVISION

	GP	W	L	PF	PA	Pt
x-Edmonton	15	11	4	470	382	22
British Columbia	15	9	6	452	398	18
Saskatchewan	15	8	7	430	408	16
Calgary	16	8	8	572	541	16
Winnipeg	15	7	8	383	419	14

x — clinched playoff berth.

Bye: Toronto
Friday
All Times Eastern
Edmonton at Hamilton, 7 p.m.
Ottawa at British Columbia, 10 p.m.

Saturday
Calgary at Winnipeg, 7 p.m.

Monday, Oct. 12
Saskatchewan at Montreal, 1 p.m.

U SPORTS FOOTBALL

WEEK SEVEN

Friday
All Times Eastern
Toronto at McMaster, 12 p.m.

NBA

PRESEASON

Wednesday
Indiana 123 Minnesota 112
Milwaukee at Oklahoma City
Orlando at Memphis
Phoenix at Chicago
Golden State at Portland

Tuesday
Brooklyn 124, Charlotte 90
New Orleans 116, Oklahoma City 110
Golden State 124, L.A. Lakers 98
Denver 117, Utah 106

Thursday
All Times Eastern
Boston at Cleveland, 7 p.m.
New Orleans at Miami, 7:30 p.m.
Philadelphia at Brooklyn, 7:30 p.m.
Washington at New York, 7:30 p.m.
Atlanta at San Antonio, 8 p.m.
Sacramento at L.A. Lakers, 10:30 p.m.

AHL

Friday — All Times Eastern
Hartford at Providence, 7:05 p.m.
Syracuse at Rochester, 7:05 p.m.
Abbotsford at Colorado, 9:05 p.m.
Manitoba at Grand Rapids, 7 p.m.
Toronto at Hamilton, 7 p.m.
Rockford at Iowa, 8 p.m.
Bakersfield at Calgary, 9 p.m.
San Diego at Coachella Valley, 10 p.m.
Tucson at San Jose, 10 p.m.

MLS

EASTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	L	T	GF	GA	Pt
x-Nashville	27	18	3	6	55	21	60
New England	27	14	9	4	45	36	46
Miami	27	12	5	10	64	50	46
Chicago	27	13	8	6	49	39	45
Charlotte	27	12	8	7	47	38	43
Philadelphia	27	11	10	6	54	44	39
Orlando	27	10	13	4	48	64	34
Cincinnati	26	8	9	9	55	64	33
N.Y. Red Bulls	27	9	12	6	34	51	33
N.Y. City F.C.	27	8	10	9	41	36	33
D.C.	26	6	8	12	34	42	30
Columbus	27	8	14	5	39	43	29
Toronto	27	6	10	11	39	51	29
Atlanta	27	7	14	6	32	45	27
Montreal	26	6	15	6	34	54	24

WESTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	L	T	GF	GA	Pt
Vancouver	27	15	7	5	60	29	50
St. Louis	27	13	6	8	48	36	47
Dallas	27	13	6	8	50	42	47
San Jose	27	13	8	6	49	39	45
Houston	27	13	9	5	34	32	44
L.A. F.C.	28	11	9	8	43	30	41
Seattle	27	10	9	8	35	35	38
Colorado	27	11	13	3	38	38	36
L.A. Galaxy	28	9	10	9	37	44	36
Portland	27	9	13	5	48	51	32
Salt Lake City	27	9	13	5	40	44	32
San Diego	27	8	11	8	47	47	32
Austin	27	7	10	10	35	47	31
Minnesota	27	7	12	8	40	49	29
Kansas City	27	6	18	3	32	65	21

x — clinched playoff berth

Tuesday
Chicago 3 Vancouver 1

NSL

	GP	W	L	T	GF	GA	Pt
x-Montreal	23	11	4	8	40	25	41
x-Toronto	23	11	5	7	38	22	40
x-Ottawa	23	11	8	4	44	41	37
Halifax	23	7	10	6	21	21	27
Vancouver	23	8	12	3	42	49	27
Calgary	23	4	13	6	25	52	18

x — clinched playoff berth; Note: Three points awarded for a win, one for a tie.

Saturday, Oct. 17
Montreal at Halifax, 2 p.m.

Sunday, Oct. 18
Calgary at Toronto, 1 p.m.
Vancouver at Ottawa, 4 p.m.

CPL

	GP	W	L	T	GF	GA	Pt
x-Calgary	25	16	4	5	51	19	53
x-Hamilton	25	15	4	6	41	20	51
x-Ottawa	25	12	9	4	38	41	40
Vancouver	25	9	10	6	35	33	33
Quebec	25	9	12	4	38	45	31
Halifax	25	7	12	6	38	42	27
Toronto	25	6	10	9	40	56	27
Victoria	25	2	15	8	30	55	14

x — clinched playoff berth

Wednesday
Quebec 2 Toronto 1
Hamilton 3 Victoria 0

Saturday, Oct. 10
Vancouver at Quebec, 4 p.m.

NHL

Canada’s Hunter ‘just scratching the surface’

Eighteen-year-old striker from Calgary has been dominant with NSL’s AFC Toronto

DANIEL RAINBIRD MONTREAL

Janine Sonis has spent more than a decade in Canadian women’s national team camps, and she believes teenage phenom Kaylee Hunter has the tools to go as far as she wants.

“She’s got everything,” Sonis said. “The physical ability, the speed, the soccer IQ, the technical ability ... there’s no ceiling to what she can do in the game.”

Hunter was called into Canada’s senior camp for a pair of upcoming friendlies against Denmark after a standout showing at the under-20 World Cup, where she scored a sensational hat trick in Canada’s round-of-16 victory over France.

The 18-year-old striker from Calgary has been turning heads since last year as the leading scorer for the Northern Super League’s AFC Toronto.

After finishing second in goals with 16 in 25 games during the NSL’s inaugural season, Hunter has scored nine times across 18 league contests so far this year.

Sonis sees a player who could carry the women’s national team program for years to come.

“It’s incredible. I’m a huge fan of hers,” Sonis said after training Wednesday at Montreal’s Stade Saputo. “The talent and desire that she has as such a young player is something that is going to drive this team forward for a long, long time.”

“She had a wonderful U-20 World Cup, and I think it’s just a taste of what she can do. She’s just scratching the surface.”

Hunter is one of several players to break into the national team since the long-sought Canadian women’s professional league kicked off less than two years ago. She says her rise has come faster than she ever imagined, thanks largely to the NSL.

“Honestly, it feels like yesterday was my first time putting on



Canada’s Kaylee Hunter dribbles during the SheBelieves Cup match against Argentina in Harrison, N.J., in March. Hunter finished second in goals in the NSL’s inaugural season. ANGELA WEISS/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

EUSTÁQUIO’S INJURY NOT SERIOUS, CANADA SOCCER SAYS

Canada Soccer says the injury Stephen Eustáquio sustained in Tuesday’s 1-0 friendly loss to the United States does not appear to be serious after the Swansea midfielder underwent an X-ray.

Eustáquio fell hard to the turf following a challenge by Gio Reyna in the 40th minute at Allianz Field.

Canada’s vice-captain stayed in the game temporarily before coach Jesse Marsch replaced him with Mathieu Choinière at halftime.

Eustáquio, 29, had his shoulder examined Tuesday night in Minnesota before returning to Swansea, where he will undergo further assessment.

The Leamington, Ont., native joined camp late after getting married but played in all three matches during the international break, with Canada beating Chile and Peru on home soil before falling to the Americans.

Swansea plays its next match Saturday at home to Norwich City. THE CANADIAN PRESS

an AFC jersey and the national team jersey,” she said. “The NSL is huge and that’s kind of why the league was instituted, to feed the first team of our national team.”

“I give a lot of credit to the NSL, I probably wouldn’t be here because I’d still be playing youth or possibly going to university.”

Canada, which sits ninth in the FIFA rankings, hosts No. 12 Denmark on Friday in Montreal and Monday at Toronto’s BMO Field. The matchups are a measuring stick ahead of Canada’s quarter-final against Panama on Nov. 28 at

the CONCACAF W Championship, a qualifier for both the 2027 World Cup in Brazil and the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

Whether Hunter keeps a place in Canada coach Casey Stoney’s plans remains to be seen, but Stoney liked what she saw at the under-20 World Cup.

“There’s still areas of her game she needs to improve. She’s young, right? But I thought she was a standout,” Stoney said during her roster announcement press conference two weeks ago. “She’s very deserving of this call-

up, and I think she’s got a bright future ahead of her.”

Hunter, who played youth soccer for Calgary Blizzard SC and Whitecaps FC Girls Elite, knows she’ll have her work cut out for her but still dreams of wearing Canada’s kit in Brazil next summer.

At the club level, her goal is to play in Europe, though she’s in no rush.

“I’m still doing well with AFC and I enjoy it there, but obviously in the coming years I want to make a move to Europe,” said the

Chelsea supporter. “We just got to see if the timing’s right, and I don’t know when that will be, but looking forward to it.”

SCORING SONIS

Hunter isn’t the only national team player in form. Sonis, née Beckie, is enjoying a stellar season with Denver Summit FC of the National Women’s Soccer League, tallying 12 goals and six assists in 26 games as a left back. She scored her most recent goal Sunday with a tight-angled cross that fooled Chicago Stars FC goalkeeper Katie Atkinson and dropped into the back of the net.

A long-time forward, the 32-year-old said her speed and endurance are helping her excel at wingback.

“Just to get up and down the pitch to be able to execute in my defensive role and be able to add to our attack, I think it’s really hard to track a fullback for 90-plus minutes,” Sonis said. “That’s my intention when I play, is to make a winger’s job as hard as possible. And then I have that forward instinct in me from being a forward my whole life, so it’s a nice pair.”

Sonis also scored a hat trick in Canada’s most recent match, a 6-0 victory over Costa Rica on June 9.

CALLING UP COURTNALL

Canada added San Diego Wave FC defender Brooklyn Courttnall to the women’s national team roster ahead of the upcoming friendlies.

The 23-year-old from Los Angeles is the daughter of former Montreal Canadiens forward Russ Courttnall, who scored 82 goals over four seasons with the franchise.

Brooklyn Courttnall made her senior team debut at the SheBelieves Cup, coming on as a substitute for Vanessa Gilles in a 4-1 win over Colombia on March 1. She made her first start later in the tournament, playing 90 minutes in a penalty-kick win over Argentina on March 7.

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Permanent daylight time in Western Canada shakes up NHL schedules

DONNA SPENCER CALGARY

Alberta’s move to permanent daylight time will turn the Calgary Flames and their fans into night owls a few times this NHL season.

The puck drops at 9 p.m. on eight Flames games, including two at the Saddledome.

“Professional athletes got to do what we got to do to get ready,” said Flames captain Mikael Backlund. “There’s caffeine out there.”

Flames forward Ryan Strome, who has children ages 6, 5 and 2, may have time to help out with bath chores before he heads to the Saddledome for a late game.

“They always want to come to games, and the nine o’clock games they definitely can’t come to,” Strome said. “That’s probably the biggest adjustment, is that my tickets will be free those nights because my family can’t go.”

Alberta’s decision to stop moving clocks back an hour in November and ahead in March and stay on daylight time – a move also adopted by B.C. and Manitoba – threw a few wrinkles into an NHL schedule driven by broadcast rightsholders.

It’s injected variety into when the puck drops for the NHL’s teams in Western Canada, and when their fans turn on their screens to watch them.

“It’s out of our control,” Flames president and chief executive officer Robert Hayes said. “I’ve always said in my business career, ‘Let’s focus on the things we can control,’ and we can’t control that.”

“A decision was made by the province ... and decisions were made by others that this is the time we’re going to start hockey games.”

Only once before an Eastern road trip starting Dec. 10 do the Flames have back-to-back games starting at the same time.

“Looking at the calendar, looking at the schedule, it looks like it’s a big variety this year,” Backlund said.

Calgary does get eight afternoon games starting at 2:30 p.m. or earlier, compared to five in 2025-26.

“We’ve got more afternoon games. That’s going to be exciting for families,” Hayes said.

“And then the 9 o’clock games, hopefully that just means, and I’ll couch my words here, a greater party atmosphere, if you will, for a Saturday night 9 o’clock game that happens to be on.”

Calgary’s 9 p.m. starts at the Saddledome are Dec. 26 against the Vancouver Canucks and Jan. 16 against the Los Angeles Kings.

Edmonton has seven games starting at 9 p.m., including Nov. 7 against the Canucks and March 6 against the Chicago Blackhawks at Rogers Place.

“I don’t think I’ll notice as much as my family at home watching,” said Oilers defenceman Jake Walman, who is from Toronto. “They’ll probably be struggling to watch that one.”

His teammate Trent Frederic will adjust his sleep routine for late games at Rogers Place.

“Sounds weird, but I’ll try to go to bed a little bit later the night before, probably take a later nap, eat my lunch a little bit later than normal,” he said.

“The naps are big, or at least they are for myself. A lot of times after games, the later games, you’re going to bed late, you’re still wired, so it’s just important to kind of stick with getting the good naps.”

Manitoba declared Sept. 17, the same day players hit the ice for NHL training camps, that the province will stay on daylight time permanently.

The next day, the NHL issued changes to a dozen Winnipeg Jets home games, pushing them back an hour, but none later than 7:30 p.m. local time. Manitoba will be on the same time as Toronto on Nov. 1.

Winnipeg’s road schedule contains the odd nightcap for Jets fans, though, including a 10 p.m. game Feb. 13 against the Canucks and a 9:30 p.m. start Dec. 2 against the Utah Mammoth.

The Canucks on the West Coast also have some quirky start times on the road, including 4:45 p.m. and 7:40 p.m.

A seven-game road trip in late January contains five different start times ranging from noon to 6 p.m.

“One hundred per cent it’s going to be different,” Canucks winger Brendan Gallagher said. “It’s something that we’ve never really been through. Even having an 8 p.m. game to start the season, a little bit different, but we’ll get used to it.”

“We’ll have plans, and you probably tinker with [it] a little bit, but it’s not going to change too much. Once the puck drops, it’s still hockey and you’ve got a job to do. You try to stick to what your routine is as best you can.”

THE CANADIAN PRESS, with files from Gemma Karstens-Smith in Vancouver

Consent: Education program could address toxic culture in sports

■ FROM B11

Wakeman said educating the under-15 age group is an important place to start when trying to change behaviours that can lead to a toxic culture.

“We are hoping to reach athletes young enough that ... we can start to change the narrative early,” she said.

Dee Dooley, an education adviser with Dalhousie University’s sexual violence prevention program, is helping to facilitate the pilot program along with varsity hockey players in the province.

Dooley, who has also researched sexual violence prevention among varsity student-athletes, said culture in sport is often passed down between generations.

“The importance of peer influence and peer leadership can’t be overstated,” she said. “Culture is really created by the people within it.”

Hazing and sexual violence have plagued hockey in Canada for decades.

In 2023, a Quebec Major Junior Hockey

In 2023, a Quebec Major Junior Hockey League player filed an application for a class-action lawsuit against the league alleging he was abused during hazing rituals in the 1990s.

League player filed an application for a class-action lawsuit against the league alleging he was abused during hazing rituals in the 1990s.

The year prior, Hockey Canada came under fire after it was revealed that an undisclosed settlement had been paid to a woman who alleged she was sexually assaulted by members of Canada’s 2018 World Junior hockey team. Five players were charged with sexual assault in 2024 related to the incident and were acquitted of all charges last year.

Jaqueline Moore, a research assistant with the project and a former varsity athlete, said while educating players is an important part of changing hockey’s culture, everyone needs to play a role.

“We also need coaches involved, we need administration involved, we need parents involved,” she said. “It’s really going to take a community.”

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Kelly: Canada needs to find the next generation of soccer stars soon

■ FROM B11

The U.S. also reached the round of 16. In America, that was a mitigated disaster. The red white and blue? In 9th-16th place? That’d be something to celebrate if we were talking grade-school math scores, but in sports? Even the frou-frou ones? Unacceptable.

It was no sure thing that Pochettino would be re-signed, but he was. Now holding a deal that encompasses a full World Cup cycle, he’s begun an ambitious overhaul of the lineup. The current roster included eight teenagers.

What was an interesting experiment has, over the last week, become a blueprint. The U.S.A. had 12 goals in four games. Seven were scored by the aforementioned kids.

The best of those goals – by 17-year-old Cavan Sullivan – was scored in a romp over Mexico.

America’s been an arriving soccer power since the Depression, but maybe we’re finally looking at the real thing. Could that be the long tail of the NFL’s concussion unpleasantness during the

2010s? Perhaps some of the gifted children who had traditionally been funnelled into gridiron brain scramble chose the less crippling charms of the global game instead. Et voila.

Whatever the case, America now looks like the class of CONCACAF. Which is good. It’s helpful to have a rabbit to chase. That said, Canada’s not going to keep level for three years with the same bunch of guys who starred last summer.

Alphonso Davies is one two-step hop up the staircase from retirement. The rest of the current core will be 30-plus by the next World Cup.

Age and experience are wonderful, but only when they are built on top of overwhelming ability. Whatever Canada’s ability is, the World Cup proved that it falls within the whelming range.

So that means change. Big change. And change drawn from stores of talent that are not yet fully apparent. Incendiary interviews are fun – please, keep them coming – but locating that talent is Marsch’s actual job.

Playoff berths on the line for Stamps, Lions

Redblacks still searching for their first win of the season, on the road against B.C.

DAN RALPH

The task before the BC Lions and Calgary Stampeders this week is a very simple one. Both teams can clinch CFL playoff berths with victories. B.C. (9-6) hosts the Ottawa Redblacks (0-15) on Friday night while Calgary (8-8) visits the Winnipeg Blue Bombers (7-8) on Saturday. The Edmonton Elks (11-4) have already clinched a postseason berth but can gain some playoff clarity this weekend.

The Elks can cement a home playoff game with a win Friday night in Hamilton or a Saskatchewan loss Saturday in Montreal. Edmonton would clinch first in the West – and host the division final Nov. 7 – with a victory over the Ticats and Lions loss to Ottawa.

The Calgary-Winnipeg contest is an intriguing one given the series is tied 1-1 with each having won in the other's building. However, the two teams haven't played since the Stampeders' 52-30 victory in July. Calgary is 5-3 away from McMahon Stadium while Winnipeg is 4-5 at Princess Auto Stadium. They've both struggled within the West Division, with the Stampeders being 3-5 while the Bombers are 2-5.

Calgary comes off a 37-31 road win over Saskatchewan on Friday, its third straight victory overall.

Vernon Adams Jr. finished 22-of-29 passing for 242 yards and four touchdowns against Saskatchewan. Riders' veteran quarterback Trevor Harris had 463



Calgary Stampeders quarterback Vernon Adams Jr. threw for 242 yards and four touchdowns to lead his team to a 37-31 road win over the Saskatchewan on Friday. SAMMY KOGAN/THE CANADIAN PRESS

yards and four touchdowns as well through the air.

Adams has a CFL-high 34 TD passes with just five interceptions. Calgary's 40 red zone touchdowns is tied with Saskatchewan for second-best behind Montreal (43).

Winnipeg has dropped its past two games, including a 37-10 decision last week to Montreal, which clinched first in the East Division with its second straight victory.

Montreal starter Davis Alexander had 440 yards passing with a touchdown while Stevie Scott III ran for 83 yards and a TD on 14 carries. Winnipeg's Dru Brown completed 11-of-16 passes for 161 yards and a TD while CFL rushing leader Brady Oliveira (1,267 yards) had 44 yards on nine car-

ries as the Bombers accumulated just 182 net offensive yards and converted only two-of-12 second-down opportunities.

Winnipeg's offence is last overall in net yards (337.5 per game) and yards passing (254.1) but Calgary's defence is eighth in both offensive yards (419.6) and passing yards (328.1) allowed per game. The Stampeders are also eighth overall in offensive points surrendered (32.9 per game) but their offence is tops in points (33.4 per game) and TDs (57).

Pick: Calgary

EDMONTON ELKS VS. HAMILTON TIGER-CATS (FRIDAY NIGHT)

At Hamilton, the Ticats (5-11)

come off a 34-16 road win in Ottawa as quarterback Harrison Frost completed 28-of-35 passes for 342 yards with two TDs and an interception.

Larry Rountree III ran for 128 yards and Kenny Lawler registered six receptions for 132 yards and two scores. The defence held Ottawa to just seven-of-19 second-down chances.

Edmonton needed a CFL-record nine field goals from Vincent Blanchard on Sept. 26 for a 37-35 overtime home win the last time these teams met. The Elks' defence presents a formidable challenge as it's top-three in fewest offensive points, net offensive yards, passing and rushing yards allowed.

Pick: Edmonton

OTTAWA REDBLACKS VS. BC LIONS (FRIDAY NIGHT)

At Vancouver, winless Ottawa must travel cross-country to face a team that's won three straight and eight-of-nine overall. McLeod Bethel-Thompson started the Redblacks last two games but it's unclear who will be under centre this time. B.C. comes off a 24-17 road win in Toronto as kicker Sean Whyte booted a club-record eight field goals. The Lions' defence emphatically cemented the victory with a late goal-line stand. B.C. leads the CFL in net offensive yards (426.1) and rushing (119.8) per game. Zander Horvath had four TDs and 164 rushing yards in a 45-24 win in the Canadian capital in August.

Pick: B.C.

SASKATCHEWAN ROUGHRIDERS VS. MONTREAL ALOUETTES (MONDAY AFTERNOON)

At Montreal, the big question is how long the Alouettes starters play with the club having cemented home field for the East Division final. Last week against Winnipeg, Tyson Philpot set single-season records for a Canadian receiver with 119 catches and 1,735 yards. He's on pace for 2,082 yards, which would break Allen Pitts's all-time record (2,036). The Als are also 8-0 at home and 5-3 against the West.

The Riders (8-7) have lost three straight, falling to Winnipeg, B.C. and Calgary. They're 4-2 against East rivals but this marks their first meeting with Montreal since last year's Grey Cup victory.

Pick: Montreal

Last week: 2-2 Overall: 47-22

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Rams face Bills on Monday night in potential Super Bowl preview

ROB MAADDI

Josh Allen and the Buffalo Bills against Matthew Stafford and the Los Angeles Rams.

Sounds like a potential Super Bowl preview.

The Bills (3-1) visit the Rams (2-2) on Monday night fresh off a home loss to Drake Maye and the Patriots.

The Rams were a play or two away from a 1-3 start, but overcame a 10-point deficit at Philadelphia in the fourth quarter.

Buffalo must fix its turnover issues after seven giveaways in the past two games. It'll be a challenge for the Bills facing a tough Rams defence that's still missing Myles Garrett. Aaron Donald and cornerback Jaylen Watson could return for this one.

Puka Nacua was back last week and had a big day catching passes from Stafford.

The Rams are 2½-point favourites. They're just 4-6 against the spread in their past 10 games, but Pro Picks likes the home team in a close one.

Rams: 27-24

TAMPA BAY (0-4) AT DALLAS (2-2)

LINE: COWBOYS MINUS 8½

Undrafted rookie Jalon Daniels played well enough to win his first career start despite two picks that led to 10 points in a 17-14 loss. He needs more help from teammates. The Buccaneers haven't covered the spread in 13 straight games, the longest losing streak ATS in the Super Bowl era. Dak Prescott and the Cowboys scored 34 points against Houston's defence. Dallas' struggling defence has an opportunity to get on track against the league's 28th-ranked offence.

Cowboys: 26-19

PHILADELPHIA (2-2) VS. JACKSONVILLE (3-1), IN LONDON

LINE: JAGUARS MINUS 7½

Lane Johnson's abrupt retirement is a crushing blow for an offence dealing with injuries to Saquon Barkley, DeVonta Smith and other key players. The Eagles are 18-30 without their long-time, all-pro right tackle. The Jaguars are scoring 26 points a game and have allowed the second-fewest points in the league. Liam Coen's offence taking on Vic Fangio's defence is a matchup between two of the league's top minds.

Jaguars: 23-18

CLEVELAND (3-1) AT NEW YORK JETS (1-3)

LINE: JETS MINUS 1½

Deshaun Watson has led a game-winning drive in the fourth quarter in three straight games and the Browns are surprise division leaders under first-year coach Todd Monken. Jets coach Aaron Glenn is 4-17 and feeling the heat. The team is struggling yet is favoured to win this one. Geno Smith leads the NFL in completion percentage and hasn't thrown a pick after leading the league last season.

Jets: 20-17



Buffalo Bills quarterback Josh Allen runs with the ball during Sunday's game against the New England Patriots in Orchard Park, N.Y. ADRIAN KRAUS/THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

LAS VEGAS (3-1) AT NEW ENGLAND (2-2)

LINE: PATRIOTS MINUS 3½

The Raiders beat the Patriots to kick off the 2025 season and then everything went in opposite directions for both teams. Las Vegas ended up 3-14 and fired Pete Carroll. New England went to the Super Bowl. Klint Kubiak and Kirk Cousins have turned things around for the Raiders. Drake Maye was struggling until leading the Patriots to a big win at Buffalo last week.

Patriots: 24-20

CINCINNATI (2-2) AT MIAMI (0-4)

LINE: BENGALS MINUS 6½

The Bengals have lost two in a row while the Dolphins have yet to score 13 points in a game. Joe Burrow may not have both Ja'Marr Chase (concussion) and Tee Higgins (adductor) so they'll need the run game to get going. Miami's defence has allowed just one TD in the past 16 possessions.

Bengals: 24-16

HOUSTON (0-4) AT TENNESSEE (0-4)

LINE: TEXANS MINUS 7½

The Texans begin their quest to become the second team to make the playoffs after an 0-4 start. C.J. Stroud and the offence haven't been the problem. One of the league's best defences has underachieved. The Titans are playing better. They need to learn how to win. Houston has won three straight in the series, including a sweep last season.

Texans: 23-17

INDIANAPOLIS (2-2) AT PITTSBURGH (2-2)

LINE: STEELERS MINUS 2½

The Colts have won two in a row to even their record, but they've lost six in a row in Pittsburgh since their most recent win there in 2008. Daniel Jones has to protect

the ball better. Jonathan Taylor has been consistent. The Steelers had a mini-bye after a Thursday night loss to the Browns. Aaron Rodgers and the offence still aren't in sync. The secondary isn't getting Joey Porter Jr. back since he was traded to Dallas.

Steelers: 22-20

MINNESOTA (4-0) AT NEW ORLEANS (1-3)

LINE: VIKINGS MINUS 2½

The Vikings are winning behind a stifling defence and excellent special teams. Tyler Murray needs to get the offence going and can build off a strong finish last week. The Saints were humiliated by the Falcons in prime time on the 20th anniversary of the Superdome's reopening after Hurricane Katrina. They're trying to avoid losing three straight at home. The Tyler Shough-Chris Olave connection has been a bright spot and the Saints are 8-2 ATS in their past 10 games.

Upset special: Saints, 17-16

NEW YORK GIANTS (3-1) AT WASHINGTON (1-3)

LINE: COMMANDERS MINUS 3

Jameis Winston has led the Giants to a pair of wins that were secured by the defence making picks inside the five two weeks in a row. Winston makes it entertaining and keeps it interesting. The Commanders could have Jayden Daniels back and he'll be wearing a brace to protect his left elbow. Oddsmakers are expecting the version of Washington that beat Seattle to show up.

Best bet: Commanders, 26-20

CHICAGO (3-1) AT GREEN BAY (2-2)

LINE: BEARS MINUS 2½

Case Keenum and Tyson Bagent are 2-0 filling in for Caleb Williams and the Bears are rolling. The defence has improved since al-

lowing 37 points in Week 1. The Packers were not satisfied with a narrow win over Tampa Bay. They lost LB Edgerrin Cooper and still don't have Micah Parsons. Chicago won two of three meetings last season, including a playoff game.

Bears: 24-23

DENVER (2-2) AT LOS ANGELES CHARGERS (0-4)

LINE: BRONCOS MINUS 3½

Denver needs to find a way to start games better. Bo Nix seems to have to try to lead a comeback every week. The Broncos have some key injuries to CBs Pat Surtain II and Riley Moss and WR Pat Bryant. The Chargers are in crisis mode. Justin Herbert hasn't figured out Mike McDaniel's offence but maybe they can carry momentum from a strong fourth quarter. Denver is 6-4 ATS in the past 10 meetings.

Chargers: 23-20

DETROIT (2-2) AT ARIZONA (1-3)

LINE: LIONS MINUS 5½

The Lions have a potent offence. Problem is the defence is terrible, allowing the most yards and points in the league. Jared Goff and Co. should put up points against Arizona. Jacoby Brissett shouldn't have any trouble doing the same for the Cardinals. That's why the over/under 54½.

Lions: 31-27

SAN FRANCISCO (4-0) AT SEATTLE (3-1)

LINE: SEAHAWKS MINUS 3

The No. 1 seed in the NFC last season came down to these two teams meeting in Week 18. The Seahawks won and ended up Super Bowl champs. The 49ers are clicking despite numerous injuries. Brock Purdy hasn't been sacked and is playing at an MVP level through the first quarter of the season. The Seahawks have missed Kenneth Walker III but are finding ways to win. The defence has allowed 57 points over the past two games.

Seahawks: 26-22

BALTIMORE (3-1) AT ATLANTA (2-2)

LINE: FALCONS MINUS 3½

Lamar Jackson is dealing with an ankle injury, making it difficult to expect the Ravens to win. The Falcons, especially Bijan Robinson, have shined in the national spotlight and aim for three straight prime time wins. It would be a lot easier for Atlanta if Jackson is on the sideline.

Falcons: 23-20

Last week: Straight up: 11-5. Against spread: 11-4-1. Overall: Straight up: 40-24. Against spread: 31-31-2. Best bet: Straight up: 3-1. Against spread: 2-2. Upset special: Straight up: 2-2. Against spread: 2-2.

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

DEATHS



ELIZABETH HELBRONNER
(née Boysen)
February 28, 1931 – October 7, 2026

Elizabeth died peacefully at her Toronto home after a brief illness. She is survived by her beloved daughters, Caroline (Nicholas Brearton), Alison (Bruce McDonald), and Valerie (Gary Salewicz); her six grandchildren, Martin (Chloe), David (Whitney), Jack, Zoë, Amelia, and Ellen; and her great-grandson, James. She was predeceased by her husband of 68 years, Jacques "Jim" Helbronner; her parents, Charles and Irene Boysen; and her aunt, Leila Stevens.

Born in Madison, Wisconsin, Elizabeth grew up in Washington, D.C. She attended The Madeira School and Vassar College as a young woman. During her junior year abroad at the University of Geneva, she met Jim. Their courtship spanned two continents, and they were married in Washington in late 1954. Arriving at the border together in a green Chevy convertible in December of that year, Elizabeth and Jim set out on a long and fulfilling life in Canada. Their marriage began with supporting each other's careers and building a network of lifelong friends in Montreal and later in Toronto, where they raised three daughters. Elizabeth loved being the "mother bear" and nurtured her children with love, genuine interest and gentle guidance. They shared memorable family time at Caledon Ski Club and epic summer driving trips to the beach in Maryland with Elizabeth's mother and aunt.

She and Jim taught their daughters to be independent, ambitious and thoughtful, and she gracefully modelled those qualities while balancing her responsibilities as a wife and mother with a highly accomplished, long career as a real estate agent. Working with others brought Elizabeth great joy, and her business savvy, market instincts, and social skills made her a formidable ally for any client fortunate enough to engage her. While every deal was important, Elizabeth derived her greatest professional satisfaction when assisting family members with a real estate endeavour.

Elizabeth was a true lady, elegant, refined and exquisitely attired. She was also composed and confident, calmly advocating for herself from early in her career, when professional women often faced bias and injustice, and throughout the years that followed. She had many artistic interests, enjoying ballet, opera, and theatre. She adored bridge and was a skilled player. An avid reader, she could often be found relaxing with a new book in her garden.

As her family grew, Elizabeth generously extended her attention and regard to each newcomer. Her light shone on everyone, and her interest in her family members' daily lives never wavered. She delighted in her grandchildren's major milestones and lent a sympathetic and supportive ear during any tribulations. Her depth of experience, intelligence, and an evolving contemporary perspective created a wisdom that was widely sought and highly valued by young and old.

From her earliest days in Toronto, Elizabeth was intentional about establishing local roots. She valued traditions that brought people together, and her home was always warm and welcoming. She presided over family dinners, holiday gatherings, backyard parties, and neighbourhood mixers with thoughtfulness and care, recognizing that meaningful communication and connection were the drivers of unity, kinship and community.

Elizabeth and Jim were proud Canadians to their core, but they never lost their curiosity and appreciation for the wonders of different languages, cultures and histories. They lived abroad in Brussels during the latter stages of Jim's career and then travelled extensively in Europe, Africa, Asia and South America in their 70s and 80s. They modelled an admirable sense of adventure that remains instilled in their daughters and grandchildren.

After Jim's passing in 2023, Elizabeth settled in at The Dunfield, once again demonstrating a pragmatic and courageous approach to change and new circumstances that was a personal hallmark. She enthusiastically participated in events and activities at her new home, rekindling friendships and making many new ones.

Elizabeth will be remembered as a determined and remarkably self-sufficient woman, a loyal and interesting friend, and a kind, engaging and proud matriarch. She always made others feel appreciated and understood, and she will be deeply missed by all who knew her.

Elizabeth received attentive and thoughtful medical and home care, and the family is grateful to her longtime family physicians, Dr. Martin Schwartz and Dr. Jacqueline Schwartz; the staff at Home Instead; The Dunfield; and the doctors and nurses from Temmy Latner Centre for Palliative Care.

A visitation for family and friends will be held on Tuesday, October 13th, from 4:00 - 7:00 p.m. at The Dunfield Retirement Residence, 77 Dunfield Avenue, Toronto. In lieu of flowers, the family would be grateful for any donations in Elizabeth's memory to The Temmy Latner Centre for Palliative Care.

FUNERAL SERVICES



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WEDNESDAY
AGULNIK, Elaine - 10:00 Chapel.
BARRETT, Larry - 10:00 Pardes Chaim Cemetery.
KOPSTEIN, Rhoda - 11:00 Pardes Chaim Cemetery.
WEISMAN, Harvey - 12:00 Chapel.
BASMAN, Amanda - 3:00 Pardes Chaim Cemetery.

THURSDAY
KROL, Freda - See www.benjamins.ca for updates.

SHIVA
COHEN, Norman - 3080 Bayview Avenue.
BURKO, Eva - 44 Dundurn Crescent, Thornhill.
SOUDACK, Ilan - See benjamins.ca for information.
ZALDIN, Ryan Joshua - See benjamins.ca for information.
SCHWARTZ, Toby - 169 Ledbury Street, North York.
TENHOUSE, Sharron - 36 Brewsland Crescent, Thornhill.
AGULNIK, Elaine - 478 Hidden Trail.
WEISMAN, Harvey - 72 McMorran Crescent, Thornhill.
BASMAN, Amanda - 333 Clark Avenue West, #319, Vaughan.

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DEATHS



WILLIAM ROBERT
"BOB" MCMULLEN
October 13, 1946
October 4, 2026

Robert "Bob" McMullen passed away at St. Michael's Hospital, in Toronto, from complications of lymphoma and brain lesions, just days before his 80th birthday.

Bob was a man of many talents and a few contradictions: handsome, charismatic and always fun, yet deeply private. "Never-Miss" McMullen was a natural, multi-sport athlete who played with NHL Hall of Famers and led his university team in scoring as a defenseman. He had all the skills, just never the aggression.

Beyond sports, Bob was drawn to business. After a short but promising corporate career, he joined his father and brothers in the family business. Bob was the guiding force behind Summerhill Market, an award-winning Toronto grocery institution in business since 1954. Humble and understated, he never relented on his non-negotiables: exceptional service, innovative products and respect for everyone.

Bob is survived by his spouse, Joan; his children, Greg (Joanne), Christy (Geoffrey) and Brad (Candra); his stepsons, Michael and Andrew (Kasie); and his grandchildren, Bridget, Burke and Caleigh. He is also survived by his brother, Wayne (Sandy); sister, Glenda; and brother, Don; along with nieces, Jen (Patrick), Karen and Corry; and nephew, Cam. He was predeceased by his parents, Frank and June; and his brother, Barry.

Family and friends will fondly remember time at the cottage and on the golf course, and a vibrant gentleman who was always in motion. Mostly, we will miss Bob being "Baub."

The family is deeply grateful to the excellent staff at Southlake Hospital, St. Michael's Hospital and Huntsville District Memorial Hospital. Their care teams did their absolute best under challenging circumstances.

A private funeral service will be held for the immediate family. A Celebration of Life will take place on October 13, 2026, at Thornhill Country Club, located at 7994 Yonge St., in Thornhill, Ontario. An afternoon session is scheduled for 1:00 - 3:00 p.m., and an early evening session for 4:00 - 7:00 p.m. All who knew Bob are welcome to join the family in celebrating a life well lived.

DEATHS



ELIZABETH TORY

Elizabeth Emma Tory (nee Bacon) passed away peacefully at home in Toronto, with her family at her side on Saturday October 3, 2026, at the age of 94. Liz was strong until the end – as anyone who knew her would expect.

She was the beloved daughter of the late Howard and Helen Bacon and was predeceased by her sisters Anna and Rena-Mae and brother Ted.

Liz Tory came from modest beginnings to lead an extraordinary life of family and community contribution. Together with her husband John, her beloved partner of 58 years until his passing in 2011, she created and nurtured a family to whom they were deeply devoted and immensely proud.

Although Liz likely would have done anything (she sometimes said so and she was right!), she chose to dedicate herself to raising four loving, accomplished children – John, Jennifer, Jeffrey (Anik) and Michael. They, together with their spouses, produced many grandchildren - John (Melanie), Christopher (Sadie), Susan and George (Allie); Elizabeth Clare (David) and Alexandra Meschino (Conor); Jessica (Mike), Nicholas (Sydney), Annabel (John), Olivia (Mike) and Robin, Lily-Maude and Beatrice Nadeau; and Max, Adam, Felix (Dani) and Griffin.

And to her great joy, Liz had 15 great-grandchildren – with more on the way. Liz took great pleasure in all the children and, true to form, she would try to fill in any parenting gaps. They knew a visit with Nana was a loving challenge! She was every bit the matriarch of her large and dynamic family. Dad provided bedrock values and overflowing love; Mom was there for all of us, keeping us on our toes. She looked after our father with deep love and support and focused on the practicalities – which made life easier for all of us. Who we each became as adults celebrated the extraordinary influence of both our parents.

Beyond family, Liz made an incredible contribution as a community volunteer. She was widely recognized as one of the leading volunteers and charitable fundraisers of her generation. Organizations which she helped for decades include Sunnybrook Hospital, the Art Gallery of Ontario, the Toronto Symphony Orchestra, and the Junior League – just to name a few. She was fearless when it came to seeking contributions from others and she and Dad were very generous themselves. Her roots and her life experiences made her deeply mindful of both the satisfaction and the responsibility of giving back. She was at the top of the list when it came to serving in positions of volunteer community leadership – which she did well into her eighties.

Anyone who knew Liz Tory also knew how direct she was in her opinions. Mom had a huge heart and beyond her visible community work, she was as loyal a friend as you could ever find. She carried out countless small acts of kindness whenever she saw the need.

Mom was also a very accomplished golfer. She had six holes-in-one, and was a putter without peer, as Rosedale and Lost Tree golfers would know. She bravely took up skiing at age 40, so that we could enjoy that sport as a family. She loved her social life and made sure Dad embraced one, in Toronto and at their beloved Lost Tree Village, in Florida.

No one who ever met Liz Tory could forget her. Yes, in part that's because after spending a little time with her they felt perhaps it was time to buy some more elegant clothes or get a new haircut or do something meaningful. But it's mainly because of her personality. She was smart, she was funny and caring, and if she identified a problem, she would always help to solve it. Hers was a life well-lived and she was a role model for so many.

We would like to especially thank Mom's principal caregivers over the past 25 years: Joy and Cora, and her many friends who were so good to Mom. And also, very importantly our thanks to Dr. Jocelyn Charles, and Althea, Gemma, and Rosalie who all made such a difference to her care and the quality of her final months.

The family will welcome friends at the Humphrey Funeral Home-A.W. Miles Chapel, 1403 Bayview Avenue, Toronto, from 5:00 pm to 8:00 p.m. on Thursday, October 8, 2026. Funeral service will be held at Rosedale United Church on Friday, October 9th at 10:30 a.m. Private interment will be beside our father at Mt. Pleasant Cemetery.

If desired, in lieu of flowers, donations made to Sunnybrook Hospital Foundation, the AGO, the Toronto Symphony Orchestra or the Lost Tree Foundation would be appreciated. Condolences may be forwarded to www.humphreymiles.com.

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ACTOR, 102

STAR OF ON THE WATERFRONT, NORTH BY NORTHWEST HAD LONG CAREER

She won an Academy Award for her Hollywood debut playing the love interest of Marlon Brando’s tormented Terry Malloy

BOB THOMAS
JAKE COYLE LOS ANGELES

Eva Marie Saint, the pale, willowy actor who won an Academy Award for her first movie, *On the Waterfront*, and starred opposite Cary Grant in the Alfred Hitchcock thriller *North by Northwest*, has died. She was 102.

Ms. Saint, whose acting work lasted well into her 90s, died at her home in Los Angeles on Tuesday, confirmed family representative Jeff Sanderson.

Ms. Saint had one of the most spectacular debuts in Hollywood history, as the love interest of Marlon Brando’s tormented Terry Malloy in *On the Waterfront*, and her first trip to the Academy Awards was memorable too. Pregnant with her first child, Ms. Saint accepted her Oscar from Frank Sinatra and smilingly murmured a unique winner’s speech: “I think I may have the baby right here.” (Her son, Darrell, was born two days later.)

The award for the 1954 classic made her an instant star, but she soon astonished Hollywood with a firm independence that would mark her career. She refused offers of studio contracts and declined chances to follow up on her great success, explaining that she was taking time off to become acquainted with her new son. (A daughter, Laurette, was born in 1958.)

In her first decade in Hollywood, Ms. Saint appeared in a mere seven films. She declined such top-level productions as *The Man in the Gray Flannel Suit* with Gregory Peck, *Summer and Smoke* with Laurence Harvey and *The Rainmaker* with Burt Lancaster. She credited her husband, TV and stage director Jeffrey Hay-



Eva Marie Saint arrives at the 2018 Oscars in Los Angeles. Ms. Saint declined many top-level productions, but instead of being put off by her selectivity, studios continued offering her starring roles. JORDAN STRAUSS/AP

den, with persuading her to star in Mr. Hitchcock’s *North by Northwest*, the classic 1959 thriller in which Ms. Saint plays a spy who seduces Mr. Grant, but ends up falling for him.

“I vividly remember him saying, ‘Honey, I think you should find a quiet spot. I’ll take care of the children and I want you to really think about this and reread this script,’” she told *Vanity Fair* in 2014. “He was so right. And that’s what husbands are for.”

Instead of being put off by her selectivity, studios continued offering her starring roles in such films as *Exodus* (with Paul Newman), *Raintree County* (Elizabeth Taylor, Montgomery Clift) and *All Fall Down*, with Warren Beat-

She turned more to television in the 1970s and enjoyed renewed popularity in the 1980s as the mother of Cybill Shepherd in the hit sitcom *Moonlighting* and as Tom Hanks’s mother in the film comedy *Nothing in Common*. She won an Emmy for the 1990 miniseries *People Like Us*, and had roles in such 21st-century movies as *Because of Winn-Dixie*, *Superman Returns* and *Winter’s Tale*, adapted from Mark Hoppert’s novel of the same name. In 2021, she played Marisa Tomei’s aunt in the brief audio play *The Bus Ride*, part of *The Pack Podcast*.

Ms. Saint was married to Mr. Hayden for 65 years, until his death in 2016.

When Ms. Saint emerged in the public consciousness, many

believed her theatrical-sounding name must have been invented. She was born with it on July 4, 1924, in Newark, N.J. The family moved to Delmar, a small town near Albany, N.Y., where her father was a Goodrich Rubber Co. manager. Eva’s goal was to become a third-grade teacher like her mother, but at Bowling Green State University in Ohio she tried out for a play and won the leading role.

After graduation, she lived with her parents and began hunting for acting jobs in Manhattan. After a fruitless year, she landed a two-line role as a telephone operator on a radio drama and soon was working steadily on soap operas and nighttime dramas, appearing for two years

as Claudia on *One Man’s Family*. Network television was booming in the early 1950s, and her looks and dramatic sense made her a favourite with casting people and producers.

A critical turn in Ms. Saint’s career came when she auditioned before Elia Kazan and was accepted into the Actors Studio, which shaped a generation of method-actor stars. She credited acting coach Lee Strasberg with helping her overcome her shyness.

“Lee Strasberg, when he got to know me a little bit, gave me a scene to do where I had to cry in front of my peers,” she told *The Santa Barbara Independent* in 2009. “I worried about it, I worked on it, I tried to use what I was learning at the studio. I finally did the scene, and I cried, and my peers were crying with me. It was just an incredible moment for me.”

Ms. Saint was rejected for the single female role in the play *Mister Roberts*, but was hired to understudy the actor chosen, Jocelyn Brando, Marlon’s sister. In six frustrating months Ms. Saint never got to substitute for Ms. Brando. She finally made it to Broadway in *A Trip to Bountiful*, which she had played on television.

Mr. Kazan invited her to try out for the female lead in *On the Waterfront* by improvising a scene with Mr. Brando. She was told to try to stop a young man from entering her apartment.

She told the *Los Angeles Times* in 2001: “All I know is that Marlon got in the door and turned on the music. We started dancing. He flicked my skirt. Mr. Kazan saw the sparks fly, and that’s how I got the part.”

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BILJANA PLAVSIC

POLITICIAN, 96

Former Bosnian Serb leader was indicted by UN tribunal on charges of genocide, war crimes

BELGRADE, SERBIA

Former Bosnian Serb leader Biljana Plavsic, who pleaded guilty at a United Nations tribunal to persecution as a crime against humanity for her role in atrocities during the 1992-95 Bosnian war, died on Thursday in Serbia’s capital Belgrade, according to Bosnian Serb public media. She was 96.

Ms. Plavsic was one of the key Bosnian Serb high officials who implemented a peace agreement signed in Dayton, Ohio, while she was serving as a president of the Bosnian Serb political entity, Republika Srpska, just after the war ended. During the war, she served on the Bosnian Serb leadership council. Considered by Western officials as much more liberal than other Bosnian Serb leaders, she became a vocal opponent of wartime Bosnian Serb president Radovan Karadzic.

Nonetheless, she was indicted in 2000 by The Hague-based UN tribunal for the former Yugoslavia on charges of genocide, war crimes and crimes against humanity for her alleged role in the war-time campaign to carve out a separate Serb entity in Bosnia. She voluntarily surrendered to face justice in 2001, and later pleaded guilty to the crime against humanity of persecution during the war. Other charges were withdrawn.

“Mrs. Plavsic disregarded reports of widespread ethnic cleansing and publicly rationalized and justified it,” the UN court said after she was sentenced. “She was aware that the key leaders of the Serbian Republic of Bosnia and Herzegovina ignored these crimes despite the power to prevent and punish them.”

She was sentenced to 11 years imprisonment and was released in 2009 after serving two-thirds of her sentence.

The UN court said that Ms. Plavsic’s guilty plea and her acknowledgment of responsibility “should promote reconciliation in Bosnia and Herzegovina and the region as a whole.”



Biljana Plavsic. FRED ERNST/AP

Former U.S. Secretary of State Madeleine Albright told a sentencing hearing that Ms. Plavsic actively supported the Dayton peace agreement. She “stood up for that at times when it was very difficult, when there were those who wanted to destroy the Dayton Accords,” Ms. Albright said, according to a court statement.

Republika Srpska’s public broadcaster RTRS reported on Thursday that the Bosnian Serb leader Milorad Dodik had expressed his condolences at the news of Ms. Plavsic’s death, saying that she was his close associate and deserved full state honours.

“Unfortunately, she was unjustly held accountable before the Hague tribunal,” said Mr. Dodik, whom a Bosnian court barred from public office last year for his efforts to separate Republika Srpska from Bosnia. “But that was part of a trend in which anyone who held a position in Republika Srpska was held accountable, even if they had personally committed no crime.”

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FREDDIE JACKSON

MUSICIAN, 70

Grammy-nominated singer known for eighties hits such as You Are My Lady

MARIA SHERMAN

Grammy-nominated R&B singer Freddie Jackson, known for his smooth eighties hits *Rock Me Tonight (For Old Times Sake)* and *You Are My Lady*, has died. He was 70.

A statement shared by his family on his official Instagram account confirmed Mr. Jackson died Monday, three days after his 70th birthday. No cause of death was provided.

“Freddie was more than a legendary voice. He was a kind, generous soul who loved his fans, his family, his friends, and his music with everything he had. For decades, he gave us the songs that became the soundtrack to our love stories, our celebrations, and our most treasured memories. That gift will live on forever,” the statement read. “To everyone who ever sang along, danced, or felt something when Freddie took the stage: thank you. You were family to him, and he carried your love with him always,” it continued.

Details regarding arrangements will be announced in the coming days.

Mr. Jackson was born and raised in Harlem, where he learned all about soul music and sang gospel at White Rock Baptist Church. He started his career in the New York club scene, eventually making his way out West with the band Mystic Merlin in the late seventies. He soon returned to New York and released his debut album, *Rock Me Tonight*, in 1985. His distinctive voice proved to be his superpower: The album, which was quickly certified platinum by the Recording Industry Association of America, also led to his two career Grammy nominations. Those were for best new artist and best male R&B vocal performance for the single *You Are My Lady*.

Rock Me Tonight also created a new R&B superstar: Mr. Jackson became a mainstay of those Billboard charts and a fixture of contemporary urban radio play throughout the eighties and early nineties.

His sophomore album, 1987’s *Just*



Freddie Jackson. GREG ALLEN/AP

Like the First Time, was also certified platinum.

In 2024, Mr. Jackson revealed he had been diagnosed with kidney disease in a video shared to his social-media accounts.

“This journey has had its challenges but I’ve decided to face it with openness and resilience,” he said in the clip. “It’s important to me that I share this with you, not just as a part of my personal story, but as a way to make a positive difference.”

At the time, Mr. Jackson also revealed he had partnered with the National Kidney Foundation to raise awareness of the disease. According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, more than one in seven American adults has chronic kidney disease. As many as nine in ten don’t know they have it.

Chronic kidney disease is a condition where the kidneys are damaged and struggle to filter blood. As a result, excess waste and fluids remain and can lead to other health issues, such as heart disease.

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